RECURRENCE COEFFICIENTS OF DISCRETE MEASURES WITH POWER-LAW ATOMS AND SLOWLY VARYING WEIGHTS

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ABSTRACT. Let $\sigma = \sum_{k\ge1} k^{-s}\ell(k)\,\delta_{k^{-p}}$ with $p>0$, $s>1$ and ℓ slowly varying; its Jacobi matrix is a compact operator with eigenvalues k^{-p}. We prove that the recurrence coefficients satisfy $n^p b_n \to c(p)$ and $n^p a_n \to 2c(p)$, where $c(p) = \frac14\big(\sqrt{\pi}\,\Gamma(1/p+1)/\Gamma(1/p+\frac12)\big)^p$ is the constant of the constrained equilibrium problem solved in a companion paper. This holds for every slowly varying ℓ, including unbounded ones such as $\exp\sqrt{\log k}$. If ℓ extends analytically to a sector, the error is $O(1/n)$; for pure powers this gives $n^p b_n = c(p)(1+O(1/n))$ and $a_n/(2b_n) = 1+O(1/n)$. The proof has three parts. A Riemann–Hilbert analysis of discrete orthogonal polynomials with nodes accumulating at a hard edge controls the non-analytic factor by a Conway–Deift comparison with a Bessel model instead of a local parametrix. A smoothing step reduces arbitrary to analytic slowly varying factors. The Christoffel transformation $\sigma \mapsto x\sigma$ shifts s by p and preserves the law together with its rate. In a further paper we show that bounded but rough weights can destroy the pointwise law.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. **Setting.** A compact Jacobi operator is determined by its spectral measure. If its eigenvalues are k^{-p} and its spectral weights decay like k^{-s}, how do its matrix entries behave? This paper answers the question pointwise, for every $p>0$ and $s>1$, and shows that the answer is stable when the weights are multiplied by an arbitrary slowly varying factor.

Concretely, for $p>0$, $s>1$ and a sequence $\ell\colon \mathbb{N}\to(0,\infty)$ we study the discrete measure

$$\sigma_{p,s,\ell} := \sum_{k\ge1} k^{-s}\ell(k)\,\delta_{k^{-p}}, \qquad \sigma_{p,s} := \sigma_{p,s,1}. \tag{1}$$

It lives on $(0,1]$ and has infinitely many atoms, which accumulate only at 0. Let P_n be its monic orthogonal polynomials and $h_n := \int P_n^2\,\mathrm{d}\sigma$. They satisfy the three-term recurrence

$$xP_n = P_{n+1} + a_nP_n + b_n^2P_{n-1} \qquad (n\ge0,\ b_0:=0,\ b_n>0), \tag{2}$$

so that $b_n^2 = h_n/h_{n-1}$. The numbers a_n and b_n are the diagonal and off-diagonal entries of the Jacobi matrix of σ. (The companion paper [15] writes a_{n+1} for our a_n; the b_n agree. See Section 2.)

The constants that govern the answer come from [15]:

$$I(p) := \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{2}\,\frac{\Gamma(\frac1p+\frac12)}{\Gamma(\frac1p+1)}, \qquad c(p) := \frac14\Big(\frac{\pi}{2I(p)}\Big)^p = \frac14\Big(\frac{\sqrt{\pi}\,\Gamma(\frac1p+1)}{\Gamma(\frac1p+\frac12)}\Big)^p. \tag{3}$$

For example $c(1)=\frac12$ and $c(2)=\pi^2/16$. The question is whether

$$n^pb_n \longrightarrow c(p) \qquad\text{and}\qquad n^pa_n \longrightarrow 2c(p) \qquad (n\to\infty). \tag{4}$$

We call (4) the *pointwise law*.

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The averaged law. The companion paper [15] proves (4) on average. Its Corollary 1.2, specialised to the atoms $x_k = k^{-p}$, states: if the weights $w_k \geq 0$ satisfy $\sum_k w_k < \infty$ and $w_k \geq c_1 k^{-s'}$ for some constants $c_1 > 0$ and $s' \in \mathbb{R}$, then the recurrence coefficients of $\sum_k w_k \delta_{k^{-p}}$ satisfy

$$\frac{2}{n^2} \sum_{j=1}^{n-1} (n-j) \log\bigl(j^p b_j\bigr) \longrightarrow \log c(p). \tag{5}$$

The constant arises from an explicitly solvable constrained equilibrium problem [15, Theorem 1.3]. Its solution μ^* is an average of arcsine laws, and it is exactly the zero distribution that a Jacobi matrix with entries $a_n \approx 2b_n \approx 2c\, n^{-p}$ would produce; the saturation condition of the equilibrium problem fixes $c = c(p)$ [15, §1.2]. So $c(p)$ is the value predicted for the pointwise law.

Why the pointwise law is subtle. The statement (5) is a double Cesàro mean of $\log(j^p b_j)$. Passing from it to (4) is a Tauberian step, and it needs a regularity of the sequence $j^p b_j$ that the averaged argument does not provide. That regularity must come from the weights. Indeed, the averaged law holds under the one-sided bound $w_k \geq c_1 k^{-s'}$ alone, while the pointwise law can fail for weights that oscillate within a fixed factor of k^{-s} (see the announcement in §1.3). This paper shows that slow variation of the weights is enough.

1.2. **Results.** We use the following form of slow variation, which needs no measurability or representation theorem.

Definition 1.1 (slow variation)**.** A sequence $\ell\colon \mathbb{N} \to (0,\infty)$ is *slowly varying* if, for every $\lambda \geq 1$,

$$\operatorname{osc}_n(\lambda) := \max\bigl\{\, |\log \ell(k) - \log \ell(n)| :\ k \in \mathbb{N},\ n/\lambda \leq k \leq \lambda n \,\bigr\} \longrightarrow 0 \qquad (n \to \infty). \tag{6}$$

Equivalently, $\ell(k)/\ell(n) \to 1$ uniformly for $k \in [n/\lambda, \lambda n]$, for every fixed λ; the case $\lambda = 2$ already implies the others (Section 2). Examples are $(\log(k+1))^\beta$ with $\beta \in \mathbb{R}$, $\exp((\log k)^\theta)$ with $0 < \theta < 1$, and $\exp(\sqrt{\log k}\, \sin \log\log k)$ (for $k \geq 3$, say). Neither boundedness nor monotonicity is required.

The rate in our main theorem is measured by how well ℓ can be smoothed.

Definition 1.2 (smoothing error)**.** Let $L_\ell\colon \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$ be the piecewise-linear interpolant of the points $(\log k, \log \ell(k))$, $k \geq 1$, extended by the constant $\log \ell(1)$ on $(-\infty, 0]$. Let $G(y) := e^{-y^2/2}/\sqrt{2\pi}$ and

$$\Lambda_\ell := L_\ell * G, \qquad \rho_\ell(m) := \sup_{k \geq m} \bigl|\log \ell(k) - \Lambda_\ell(\log k)\bigr| \qquad (m \geq 1). \tag{7}$$

The function Λ_ℓ is entire, and $\rho_\ell(m) \to 0$ as $m \to \infty$ whenever ℓ is slowly varying (Lemma 4.1).

For the sharp rate we need an analytic extension of ℓ to a sector, written in the logarithmic variable $\xi = \log t$. For $\vartheta > 0$ and $c_0 > 0$ put $S_\vartheta := \{\xi \in \mathbb{C} :\ \Re\xi \geq -c_0,\ |\Im\xi| \leq \vartheta\}$.

Definition 1.3 (analytic slowly varying factors)**.** Let $\vartheta > 0$. A sequence ℓ satisfies (A_ϑ) if $\ell(k) = \exp \Lambda(\log k)$ for all $k \geq 1$, where, for some $c_0 > 0$, the function Λ is analytic on S_ϑ, real on $S_\vartheta \cap \mathbb{R}$, bounded on $S_\vartheta \cap \{\Re\xi \leq 0\}$, and

$$\varepsilon_\Lambda(T) := \sup\bigl\{|\Lambda'(\xi)| :\ \xi \in S_\vartheta,\ \Re\xi \geq T\bigr\} \longrightarrow 0 \qquad (T \to \infty). \tag{8}$$

We use the half-width

$$\vartheta_p := \pi/p \quad \text{for } p > 1, \qquad \vartheta_p := \pi/2 \quad \text{for } 0 < p \leq 1. \tag{9}$$

In words, $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$ asks that ℓ extend to an analytic function $\ell(t) = e^{\Lambda(\log t)}$ on the sector $|\arg t| \le \vartheta_p$ (for large $|t|$, and bounded near $t = 1$), with $t\ell'(t)/\ell(t) \to 0$ there. A sequence satisfying (A_ϑ) is slowly varying, since $|\Lambda(\log k) - \Lambda(\log n)| \le \varepsilon_\Lambda(\log n - \log\lambda)\log\lambda$ for $n/\lambda \le k \le \lambda n$. The sequence $\ell(k) = \exp\sqrt{\log(k+e)}$ satisfies $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$ for every $p > 0$, because the branch points of $\Lambda(\xi) = \sqrt{\log(e^\xi + e)}$ lie on the lines $|\Im\xi| = \pi$. The smoothed function Λ_ℓ of any slowly varying ℓ satisfies (A_ϑ) for every $\vartheta > 0$ (Lemma 4.1). For $p > 1$ a further example is $\Lambda(\xi) = (\log(e^\xi + e))^\theta$ with $\theta < 1$.

Finally, $M_0 = M_0(p) \ge 4$ denotes an integer that depends only on p; it is fixed in Section 4 (Lemma 4.3) and marks the indices $k < n/M_0$ at which the spectral weights of P_n are exponentially saturated.

Theorem 1 (main theorem)**.** *Let $p > 0$, $s > 1$, and let $\ell\colon \mathbb{N} \to (0,\infty)$ be slowly varying. Let*

$$\sigma = \sigma_{p,s,\ell} := \sum_{k\ge1} k^{-s}\ell(k)\,\delta_{k^{-p}}.$$

Then

(i) *$n^p b_n \to c(p)$ and $n^p a_n \to 2c(p)$;*
(ii) *more precisely, $|n^p b_n - c(p)| + |n^p a_n - 2c(p)| = O\big(1/n + \rho_\ell(\lceil n/M_0\rceil)\big)$;*
(iii) *if ℓ satisfies $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$, then $n^p b_n = c(p)(1 + O(1/n))$ and $a_n/(2b_n) = 1 + O(1/n)$.*

Here $c(p) = \frac14(\pi/(2I(p)))^p = \frac14(\sqrt{\pi}\,\Gamma(1/p+1)/\Gamma(1/p+\frac12))^p$, with $I(p) = (\sqrt{\pi}/2)\Gamma(1/p+\frac12)/\Gamma(1/p+1)$. For example, $c(1) = \frac12$ and $c(2) = \pi^2/16$.

Remark 1.4. The measure is finite: by the Potter bounds (Lemma 2.1), $\ell(k) \le C_\eta k^\eta$ for every $\eta > 0$, so $\sum_k k^{-s}\ell(k) < \infty$. Thus σ is a finite measure on $(0,1]$ with infinitely many atoms, and its Jacobi matrix is a compact operator with eigenvalues k^{-p}.

Remark 1.5. No boundedness of ℓ is assumed. For example, the weights

$$k^{-s}\exp\sqrt{\log k} \qquad \text{and} \qquad k^{-s}\exp\big(\sqrt{\log k}\,\sin\log\log k\big) \quad (k \ge 3)$$

are covered. The second one is not even eventually comparable with any fixed power of $\log k$.

Remark 1.6. Part (iii) bounds the deviation from $c(p)$ at order $1/n$, but it does not identify the $1/n$ term. In particular we do not claim that the slowly varying factor changes b_n only by a relative $o(1/n)$, and we do not determine its effect at order $1/n$. A conjecture, supported by numerics, is formulated in §10.

Remark 1.7. The averaged law (5) holds for much rougher weights. Theorem 1 is the pointwise statement, and §1.3 explains why some regularity of the weights is necessary for it.

For pure powers the rate is the sharp one.

Theorem 2 (pure powers, with rate)**.** *For every $p > 0$ and $s > 1$ the measure $\sigma_{p,s} := \sum_{k\ge1} k^{-s}\delta_{k^{-p}}$ satisfies*

$$n^p b_n = c(p)\big(1 + O(1/n)\big), \qquad a_n/(2b_n) = 1 + O(1/n).$$

Equivalently, $|n^p b_n - c(p)| + |n^p a_n - 2c(p)| = O(1/n)$.

Remark 1.8 (a classical instance). For $(p,s) = (2,2)$ the coefficients are explicit, and Theorem 2 can be checked directly. Van Assche [18, §3] records that the Lommel polynomials $h_{n,\nu}$ satisfy $h_{n+1,\nu}(x) = 2x(n+\nu)h_{n,\nu}(x) - h_{n-1,\nu}(x)$, that their orthonormal versions have the coefficients $a_n = 0$ and $\lambda_n = [4(n+\nu)(n+\nu-1)]^{-1}$, and that the spectrum is the closure of $\{1/j_{k,\nu-1}\}$, the

$j_{k,\nu-1}$ being the zeros of $J_{\nu-1}$. For $\nu=\frac{3}{2}$ these zeros are $\pm\pi k$. Passing from this symmetric measure to its image under $y\mapsto\pi^2y^2$ (the usual quadratic transformation) leads to

$$b_n=\frac{\pi^2}{(4n+1)\sqrt{(4n-1)(4n+3)}},\qquad a_n=\frac{2\pi^2}{(4n+1)(4n+5)}\qquad(n\ge1)$$

for $\sigma_{2,2}$. We have confirmed numerically that these values agree with the coefficients of $\sigma_{2,2}$ computed from the Hankel determinants of its moments $\zeta(2j+2)$ (to 90 digits for $n\le9$); we have not checked the identification of the masses against a source. They give $n^2b_n/c(2)=1-\frac{1}{2n}+O(n^{-2})$ and $a_n/(2b_n)=1-\frac{1}{n}+O(n^{-2})$, in agreement with Theorem 2.

Remark 1.9 (Hankel determinants of zeta values). For $a>0$ and $2a+b>1$ the measure $\sigma_{a,2a+b}$ has moments $\int x^j\,\mathrm{d}\sigma_{a,2a+b}=\zeta(aj+2a+b)$, so its Hankel determinants are $\det_{1\le i,j\le n}\zeta(a(i+j)+b)$ [15, Corollary 1.4]. Theorem 2 therefore gives $n^ab_n=c(a)(1+O(1/n))$ for the recurrence coefficients behind these determinants. For $a=1$ Monien [13] reports a full asymptotic expansion of the determinants, obtained numerically by D. Zagier; it goes beyond Theorem 2 but is not proved.

Remark 1.10 (where $c(p)$ comes from). The equilibrium measure μ^* of [15] is supported on $(0,\infty)$ and coincides with the node density on $[4c(p),\infty)$ (it is *saturated* there); its unconstrained part is the band $(0,4c(p))$ (Proposition 2.5). After rescaling by n^p, the Riemann–Hilbert analysis sees a band of length $4c(p)$, and a band of length β produces off-diagonal entries close to $\beta/4$.

The third result is elementary, and it is the reason why the analytic part of the proof only has to cover a window of exponents s. A sequence $\eta_n>0$ is a *regular rate* if η_n is non-increasing, $n\eta_n$ is non-decreasing, and $\eta_n\to0$; for example $\eta_n=1/n$.

Theorem 3 (Christoffel shift: law and rate)**.** *Let σ be a positive Borel measure on $[0,\infty)$ with infinite support and finite moments, let $p>0$ and $c>0$, and let η_n be a regular rate. If*

$$|n^pa_n(\sigma)-2c|+|n^pb_n(\sigma)-c|=O(\eta_n),$$

then the measure $x\sigma$ ($\mathrm{d}(x\sigma):=x\,\mathrm{d}\sigma(x)$) satisfies the same estimate, with the same c and rate $O(\eta_n)$. Without a rate: if $n^pa_n(\sigma)\to2c$ and $n^pb_n(\sigma)\to c$, then the same holds for $x\sigma$. For $x_k=k^{-p}$ one has exactly $x\cdot\sigma_{p,s,\ell}=\sigma_{p,s+p,\ell}$.

Remark 1.11. The Jacobi matrix of $x\sigma$ is obtained from that of σ by factorising $J=LU$ and reversing the factors; these transfer formulas are classical [7, §1]. The factors are governed by a chain sequence, and the statement without rate follows from a proposition of Dai, Piao and Qiao [4, Proposition 2.1] together with those formulas. The part with a rate is the one that matters here: it lets the rate $O(1/n)$ survive the shift. The parameter sequence of the chain converges only at the rate $O(\sqrt{\eta_n})$ in general, and this is sharp; the coefficients of $x\sigma$ involve only its increments, which are $O(\eta_n)$ (Section 3). We have not found the rate statement in the literature.

Remark 1.12. Conversely, without rate: if $x\sigma$ satisfies (4) (with any $c>0$ in place of $c(p)$), so does σ. In particular the pointwise law is insensitive to a point mass at 0. This direction is also a consequence of [4, Proposition 2.1], which applies to every parameter sequence of a chain sequence (Section 3).

1.3. **Context.** *Averaged versus pointwise.* The averaged law (5) is a statement about $\log D_n$, the logarithm of the Hankel determinant, at order n^2, and it is proved in [15] by a discretised equilibrium problem. Such arguments are insensitive to bounded perturbations of the weights:

multiplying w_k by factors in $[e^{-\varepsilon}, e^{\varepsilon}]$ changes $\log D_n$ by at most εn. They therefore cannot yield (4), which is sensitive to such perturbations (see the announcement below).

Riemann–Hilbert analysis of discrete orthogonal polynomials. The Riemann–Hilbert (RH) approach to discrete orthogonal polynomials was developed by Baik, Kriecherbauer, McLaughlin and Miller [1] for measures on finite node sets in a bounded interval, with real-analytic node density and potential; their analysis includes saturated regions, which also appear here. Within the literature we have read, the only Riemann–Hilbert analysis of discrete orthogonal polynomials on infinitely many nodes accumulating at a finite point is that of Wu, Lin, Xu and Zhao [19], for the Tricomi–Carlitz polynomials; our frame follows theirs. Dai and Yao make the same observation about the literature [3, §1].

Non-analytic weights. Our weights are not analytic at the hard edge, and the standard local parametrix does not exist there. The same difficulty was met by Conway and Deift [2] for the weight $\log \frac{2k}{1-x}$ on $(-1,1)$, which carries a slowly varying factor at the endpoint $x=1$. They write that "there is no known parametrix for the Riemann–Hilbert problem in a neighborhood of the logarithmic singularity at $x=1$", and they compare the problem with the Legendre problem through the operator theory behind RH problems instead of through a quotient. The comparison argument in Section 7 is that of Conway and Deift [2, Theorem 4.7 and Proposition 4.9]. What we add is a comparison model built from the Szegő function of the full weight, a uniform resolvent bound for a Bessel edge of any order $|\alpha|<1$, and the treatment of an arbitrary slowly varying factor. Deift and Piorkowski [6] extended the analysis of [2] to the weight $\log \frac{2}{1-x}$ and note that, for a comparison with a weight that has a simple zero at the endpoint, "the crucial Theorem 4.7 in [4] requires a different proof" ([4] being [2]); this is consistent with our restriction to Bessel orders $|\alpha|<1$ (Remark 7.8). Other approaches to non-analytic weights are Piorkowski's parametrix-free method, which needs an a priori estimate for the exact solution [14], the $\bar\partial$ methods of McLaughlin and Miller [12] and of Trogdon [17], which assume a finite number of Lipschitz derivatives of the weight (for [17], $C^{k,1}$ regularity up to the endpoints of the support), and the approximation of a smooth symbol by analytic ones in Deift, Its and Krasovsky [5, §6.2]. Our reduction from arbitrary to analytic slowly varying factors (Section 4) is of the last kind, but the approximation error is controlled outside the RH analysis.

Recurrence asymptotics without analyticity. For exponential weights $W=e^{-Q}$, Levin and Lubinsky [11] prove $o(1)$ asymptotics of the recurrence coefficients, with constants given by equilibrium quantities, under regularity conditions that do not involve analyticity, and without RH methods. Theorem 1 is an analogue for compact Jacobi operators. We have not found Theorem 1 in the literature, even for bounded ℓ. The closest results we know concern continuous weights on an interval [2, 6, 14, 17, 12] or exponential weights [11].

Special cases. For $(p,s)=(2,2)$ the coefficients are explicit (Lommel polynomials, Remark 1.8). The measures $\sigma_{a,2a+b}$ produce the Hankel determinants of zeta values studied by Monien [13] and by Haynes and Zudilin [9] (Remark 1.9). The orthogonality measure of the Tricomi–Carlitz polynomials is supported on $\{\pm 1/\sqrt{k+\alpha}\}$ [18, §3]; in the squared variable its atoms are $1/(k+\alpha)$, so it is an instance of $p=1$ with weights that are not pure powers. For it the recurrence coefficients are explicit [18, §3], and [19] obtain uniform asymptotics of the polynomials.

Rough weights. Slow variation cannot be replaced by boundedness. In a further paper [16] we show the following. For every $p>0$ and $s>1$ there is $\varepsilon_0>0$ such that, for every $\varepsilon\in(0,\varepsilon_0]$, there are weights $w_k=k^{-s}e^{f(k)}$ with $|f(k)|\le\varepsilon$ for which $n^p b_n$ does not converge, and weights of the same kind for which $n^p a_n$ does not converge. The averaged law (5) holds for all of them. Together with Theorem 1 this gives a dichotomy: the pointwise law is stable under slowly

varying perturbations of the weights, of any size, and unstable under rough ones, however small.

1.4. **Strategy of the proof.** The proof has a soft part and a hard part. The soft part (Sections 3 and 4) is elementary and self-contained; it reduces Theorem 1 to the following statement, which is the technical core of the paper.

Theorem 4 (the Riemann–Hilbert engine: analytic factor, base window)**.** *Let $p > 0$ and $1 < s < 1 + 2p$, i.e. $\alpha := (s - 1 - p)/p \in (-1, 1)$. Let ℓ_1 satisfy $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$. Then σ_{p,s,ℓ_1} satisfies*

$$n^p b_n = c(p)\big(1 + O(1/n)\big), \qquad a_n/(2b_n) = 1 + O(1/n).$$

Remark 1.13 (what is, and is not, proved about the slowly varying part)*.* The proof compares the true problem with an exactly solvable comparison problem. Relative to the comparison problem, the non-analytic part of ℓ_1 moves the first two coefficients at infinity by $O(\varepsilon'_n/n)$, where $\varepsilon'_n \to 0$ (Section 7). The comparison problem itself depends on ℓ_1 at order $1/n$. So no claim is made that $b_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1})/b_n(\sigma_{p,s}) - 1 = O(\varepsilon_\Lambda/n)$; the $O(1/n)$ of Theorem 4 is absolute, not relative.

From Theorem 4 to Theorems 1 and 2. Write $s = s_0 + mp$ with $s_0 \in (1, 1 + 2p)$ and an integer $m \geq 0$; this is possible because the window $(1, 1 + 2p)$ has length $2p > p$. Theorem 4 at s_0 and m applications of Theorem 3 with $\eta_n = 1/n$ give the law with rate $O(1/n)$ for every analytic factor and every $s > 1$. This is Theorem 1(iii), and with $\ell \equiv 1$ it is Theorem 2. For a general slowly varying ℓ we apply this to the analytic factor $\ell_1 := \exp \Lambda_\ell(\log \cdot)$ and compare: a multiplicative perturbation $\ell/\ell_1 \to 1$ of the weights changes $\log b_n^2$ and $n^p a_n$ by at most a constant times the supremum of $|\log(\ell/\ell_1)|$ over the indices $k \geq n/M_0$, where the spectral weight of P_n lives, up to an exponentially small contribution from the head $k < n/M_0$ (Proposition 4.5). This gives Theorem 1(ii), and (i) follows.

Why the window $|\alpha| < 1$. Near the accumulation point 0 the measure looks like a continuous weight: the nodes $x_k = k^{-p}$ have density $\frac{1}{p}x^{-1-1/p}$, and the mass per unit length near x is $k^{-s} \cdot \frac{1}{p}x^{-1-1/p} = \frac{1}{p}x^\alpha$ with $x = k^{-p}$. In the RH analysis 0 becomes a hard edge with Bessel order $\alpha = (s - 1 - p)/p$. Our comparison argument works for $|\alpha| < 1$ and fails for $\alpha \geq 1$ (Remark 7.8). Multiplication by x raises α by 1, and Theorem 3 carries the law and its rate across. For $s > 1 + p/2$ one can even choose s_0 with $|\alpha| \leq \frac{1}{2}$; the case $\alpha = 0$ cannot be avoided in general (Remark 4.6).

The frame. After rescaling $z \mapsto n^p z$ the nodes $(n/k)^p$ fill $(0, n^p]$. The equilibrium measure μ^* of [15] governs the n-th root behaviour: on the band $(0, 4c(p))$ the polynomials oscillate, on the saturated region $(4c(p), n^p)$ the zero distribution coincides with the node density, and $4c(p)$ is a soft edge with an Airy parametrix. Near 0 the band meets infinitely many nodes. We set up the discrete interpolation problem and its first transformations as Wu, Lin, Xu and Zhao do [19], in the one-sided variable x (Section 5). What depends on p is the outer scalar function that removes the Gamma-function growth of the node masses: the index function $t(z) = nz^{-1/p}$ maps the slit plane onto the sector $|\arg t| < \pi/p$, which lies inside, exactly fills, or exceeds the sector $|\arg t| < \pi$ where Stirling's formula holds, according as $p > 1$, $p = 1$ or $p < 1$. Section 6 treats the three cases in turn and ends with a Frame Proposition (Proposition 6.9), which is the only interface between the frame and the hard edge.

The hard edge, and why a local parametrix fails. The slowly varying factor enters the band weight through $r_n(z) := \ell_1(nz^{-1/p})/\ell_1(n)$. This function is analytic off $(-\infty, 0]$, but it is not analytic at 0, and it is not of Fisher–Hartwig type. The standard Bessel parametrix needs a square root of the band weight continued across $(-\delta, 0)$. Any such continuation jumps across

$(-\delta, 0)$ by a factor $1 + O(\varepsilon_\Lambda)$, with no rate in n. Conjugated by the Bessel model at the scale $|z| \asymp n^{-2}$, this jump becomes of size $O(n\varepsilon_\Lambda)$, which is not small. A Bessel order that drifts with n removes only the leading, power-like part of the factor. So a quotient (small-norm) argument fails.

The remedy. Following Conway and Deift, we build the Bessel parametrix from the Szegő function D_W of the whole band weight, the slowly varying factor included. This function has no jump on $(-\delta, 0)$, so the comparison problem is exactly solvable. The error moves to the lips of the lens, where the jump of the true problem differs from that of the comparison problem by an amount that is small in the supremum norm but has no rate. Such smallness is exactly what a Neumann series around the comparison resolvent needs, once that resolvent is bounded uniformly in n (Proposition 7.4; this is where $|\alpha| < 1$ is used, Appendix B). Finally $e^{2n\phi}$ confines the mismatch to $|z| \lesssim n^{-2}$, up to a tail, and this Bessel localisation supplies the factor $1/n$.

What is new relative to Conway–Deift. The weight factor is an arbitrary analytic slowly varying function rather than one explicit logarithm; the Bessel order is any $\alpha \in (-1, 1)$ rather than the Legendre value $\alpha = 0$; the comparison model is an explicit parametrix rather than a second orthogonality problem; and the problem is discrete, with nodes accumulating at the hard edge. The key estimate for the slowly varying factor is a scale-invariant path integral of Λ' (Section 7).

Figure 1 shows how the parts fit together.

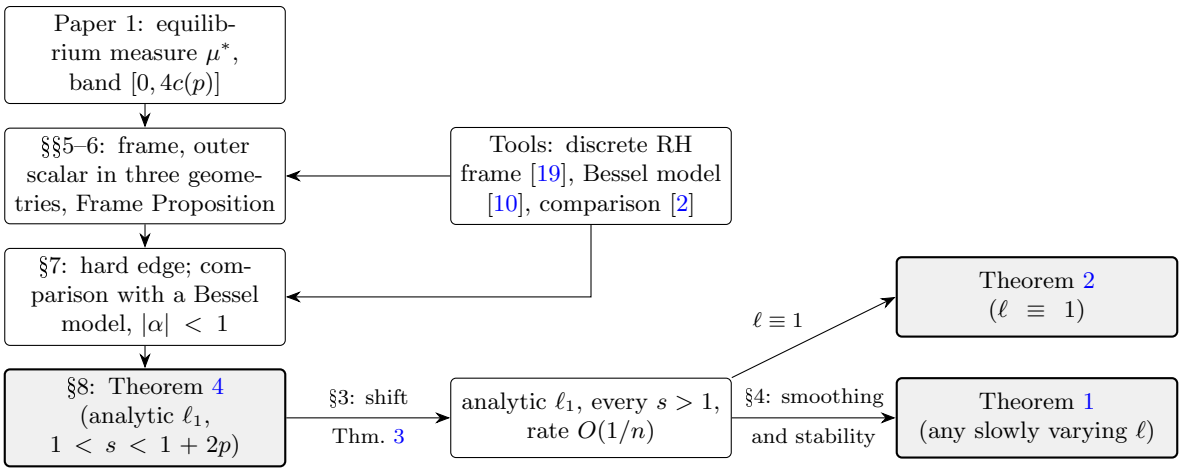


FIGURE 1. Structure of the proof. Sections 3 and 4 are elementary and reduce Theorems 1 and 2 to Theorem 4, which is proved in Sections 5–8.

1.5. **Organisation.** Section 2 fixes conventions, proves two facts about slowly varying sequences, quotes the input from [15] (only parts (i) and (ii) of its Theorem 1.3 are used), and states the external tools with their hypotheses. Section 3 proves Theorem 3. Section 4 reduces arbitrary slowly varying factors to analytic ones and proves Theorems 1 and 2, assuming Theorem 4. Sections 5–8 prove Theorem 4: the common frame (Section 5), the outer scalar function in the three geometries $p > 1$, $p = 1$ and $p < 1$ (Section 6), the comparison at the hard edge (Section 7), and the extraction of a_n and b_n (Section 8). Section 9 illustrates the results numerically, and Section 10 collects remarks and open problems. The appendices contain two L^2 bounds on a star of arcs (Appendix A), the proof of the uniform resolvent bound (Appendix B) and the a priori bound at the hard edge (Appendix C). A reader who is

mainly interested in the Riemann–Hilbert analysis can start at Section 5, with the statement of Theorem 4 in hand.

Throughout, $p > 0$ is fixed, C, C' denote positive constants that may change from line to line (never c, which is reserved for $c(p)$), and n is the degree.

2. Preliminaries

This section fixes conventions and collects the inputs of the proof. Two elementary facts about slowly varying sequences are used repeatedly: they are locally almost constant on dyadic scales, and they grow more slowly than any power. We prove both in §2.2. The only input from the companion paper [15] is the explicit equilibrium measure (§2.4). Every external result used later is stated in §2.5, with its hypotheses, under a label T1–T4 by which the later sections refer to it.

2.1. Orthogonal polynomials and Jacobi coefficients.

Let σ be a positive Borel measure on $[0,\infty)$ with infinite support and finite moments. Its Hankel determinants are positive, so the monic orthogonal polynomials P_n ($\deg P_n = n$) exist for every $n \ge 0$. Put $h_n := \int P_n^2 \, d\sigma > 0$, $P_{-1} := 0$ and $b_0 := 0$. The polynomials satisfy the three-term recurrence

$$xP_n = P_{n+1} + a_n P_n + b_n^2 P_{n-1} \qquad (n \ge 0), \qquad b_n^2 = \frac{h_n}{h_{n-1}} \quad (n \ge 1), \tag{10}$$

with $a_n \in \mathbb{R}$ and $b_n > 0$ for $n \ge 1$. We call a_n and b_n the *Jacobi coefficients* of σ.[1] Multiplying σ by a positive constant does not change them.

The orthonormal polynomials $p_n := P_n/\sqrt{h_n}$ satisfy

$$xp_n = b_{n+1}p_{n+1} + a_n p_n + b_n p_{n-1} \qquad (n \ge 0), \tag{11}$$

as one sees by dividing (10) by $\sqrt{h_n}$ and using $b_n^2\sqrt{h_{n-1}/h_n} = b_n$. Since xp_j has degree $j+1$, orthonormality gives

$$a_n = \int x p_n^2 \, d\sigma, \qquad b_n = \int x p_{n-1} p_n \, d\sigma, \qquad \int x p_n p_j \, d\sigma = 0 \quad (j \le n-2). \tag{12}$$

In matrix form, (11) says that the symmetric tridiagonal matrix $\mathcal{J}(\sigma)$ with diagonal $(a_0, a_1, \dots)$ and off-diagonal $(b_1, b_2, \dots)$ is the Jacobi matrix of σ. The monic form (10) corresponds to the non-symmetric matrix $J = J(\sigma)$ with $J_{n,n} = a_n$, $J_{n,n+1} = 1$ and $J_{n+1,n} = b_{n+1}^2$; this is the form used in §3.

Christoffel's extremal property. For $y \in \mathbb{R}$ and $m \ge 1$ let $\mathsf{K}_m(y) := \sum_{j<m} p_j(y)^2$. If $\deg P < m$ and $P = \sum_{j<m} c_j p_j$, then the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality gives $P(y)^2 \le \big(\sum_j c_j^2\big)\mathsf{K}_m(y) = \mathsf{K}_m(y)\int P^2 \, d\sigma$, with equality for $c_j = p_j(y)$. Hence

$$\frac{1}{\mathsf{K}_m(y)} = \min\Big\{ \int P^2 \, d\sigma : \ \deg P < m, \ P(y) = 1 \Big\}. \tag{13}$$

If σ has an atom of mass w at y, then every competitor in (13) has $\int P^2 \, d\sigma \ge w P(y)^2 = w$, and therefore

$$w\,\mathsf{K}_m(y) \le 1. \tag{14}$$

[1] Paper [15] writes $xP_k = P_{k+1} + a_{k+1}P_k + b_k^2 P_{k-1}$; its a_{n+1} is our a_n, and b_n agrees.

2.2. **Slow variation.** Recall from Definition 1.1 that a sequence $\ell : \mathbb{N} \to (0,\infty)$ is slowly varying if, for every $\lambda \geq 1$,

$$\operatorname{osc}_n(\lambda) := \max\bigl\{|\log \ell(k) - \log \ell(n)| : \ k \in \mathbb{N},\ n/\lambda \leq k \leq \lambda n\bigr\} \longrightarrow 0 \qquad (n \to \infty).$$

Each $\operatorname{osc}_n(\lambda)$ is a maximum of finitely many finite numbers. Put

$$\varepsilon_n := \sup_{m \geq n} \operatorname{osc}_m(2).$$

Since $\operatorname{osc}_m(2) \to 0$, every ε_n is finite, the sequence (ε_n) is non-increasing, and $\varepsilon_n \to 0$.

Lemma 2.1 (Dyadic chaining and Potter bounds)**.** *Let ℓ be slowly varying.*

(i) *For all $n \geq 1$ and all integers $k \geq n$, $|\log \ell(k) - \log \ell(n)| \leq \varepsilon_n\bigl(1 + \log_2(k/n)\bigr)$.*
(ii) *For every $\eta > 0$ there is $A_\eta < \infty$ such that $e^{-A_\eta} k^{-\eta} \leq \ell(k) \leq e^{A_\eta} k^{\eta}$ for all $k \geq 1$.*

Proof. (i) Let $j := \lfloor \log_2(k/n) \rfloor \geq 0$, so that $2^j n \leq k < 2^{j+1} n$. For $0 \leq i < j$ the integer $2^{i+1} n$ lies in $[2^i n/2,\, 2 \cdot 2^i n]$, so $|\log \ell(2^{i+1} n) - \log \ell(2^i n)| \leq \operatorname{osc}_{2^i n}(2) \leq \varepsilon_n$. Also $k \in [2^j n,\, 2 \cdot 2^j n]$, so $|\log \ell(k) - \log \ell(2^j n)| \leq \varepsilon_n$. Summing these $j+1$ steps gives $|\log \ell(k) - \log \ell(n)| \leq (j+1)\varepsilon_n \leq \varepsilon_n(1 + \log_2(k/n))$.

(ii) Fix $\eta > 0$ and choose N with $\varepsilon_N \leq \eta \log 2$. For $k \geq N$, part (i) with $n = N$ gives

$$|\log \ell(k)| \leq |\log \ell(N)| + \varepsilon_N + \frac{\varepsilon_N}{\log 2} \log \frac{k}{N} \leq |\log \ell(N)| + \varepsilon_N + \eta \log k.$$

The finitely many $k < N$ are covered by taking $A_\eta := \max\bigl(|\log \ell(N)| + \varepsilon_N,\ \max_{k<N} |\log \ell(k)|\bigr)$. □

Remark 2.2 ($\lambda = 2$ suffices). If $\operatorname{osc}_n(2) \to 0$, then $\operatorname{osc}_n(\lambda) \to 0$ for every $\lambda \geq 1$. Indeed, Lemma 2.1(i) uses only $\operatorname{osc}(2)$. For $n \leq k \leq \lambda n$ it gives $|\log \ell(k) - \log \ell(n)| \leq \varepsilon_n(1 + \log_2 \lambda)$. For $n/\lambda \leq k < n$, apply it with base point k: $|\log \ell(n) - \log \ell(k)| \leq \varepsilon_k(1 + \log_2(n/k)) \leq \varepsilon_{\lceil n/\lambda \rceil}(1 + \log_2 \lambda)$. Both bounds tend to 0.

For every $s > 1$, Lemma 2.1(ii) with $\eta < s - 1$ gives $\sum_k k^{-s} \ell(k) < \infty$. So $\sigma_{p,s,\ell} = \sum_k k^{-s} \ell(k) \delta_{k^{-p}}$ is a finite measure on $(0,1]$ with infinitely many atoms, and §2.1 applies to it.

2.3. **Regular rates.**

Definition 2.3. A sequence $\eta_n > 0$ is a *regular rate* if η_n is non-increasing, $n\eta_n$ is non-decreasing, and $\eta_n \to 0$.

The rate $\eta_n = 1/n$ is regular. Every regular rate satisfies

$$\frac{1}{n} \leq \frac{\eta_n}{\eta_1}, \qquad \eta_{n-1} \leq 2\eta_n \quad (n \geq 2), \qquad \sum_n \eta_n = \infty. \tag{15}$$

The first holds because $n\eta_n \geq \eta_1$; the second because $(n-1)\eta_{n-1} \leq n\eta_n$; the third follows from the first.

Remark 2.4 (Regular majorants). Every non-increasing sequence $\varrho_n > 0$ with $\varrho_n \to 0$ is dominated by a regular rate, namely $\eta_n := \max_{m \leq n}(m\varrho_m)/n$. Indeed $\eta_n \geq \varrho_n$ and $n\eta_n$ is non-decreasing by construction; $\eta_{n+1} \leq \max\bigl(\eta_n\, n/(n+1), \varrho_{n+1}\bigr) \leq \eta_n$ because $\varrho_{n+1} \leq \varrho_n \leq \eta_n$; and $\eta_n \to 0$, since $m\varrho_m/n \leq \varrho_1/\sqrt{n}$ for $m \leq \sqrt{n}$ and $m\varrho_m/n \leq \varrho_{\lceil \sqrt{n} \rceil}$ for $\sqrt{n} < m \leq n$. So Theorem 3 applies to any monotone rate. We use it only with $\eta_n = 1/n$.

2.4. **The equilibrium measure.** The Riemann–Hilbert analysis of Sections 5–8 is built on the equilibrium measure of the constrained problem solved in [15]. We use only its explicit form and the equality of its potential on the band; the optimality statement [15, Theorem 1.3(iii)] is not used anywhere in this paper.

Let $c = c(p)$ and $I(p)$ be as in (3), let $\gamma_p := \log c(p) + p$, and let $\lambda_p(x) := \frac{1}{p}x^{-1-1/p}$ be the density of the nodes k^{-p} (the image of Lebesgue measure on $(0,\infty)$ under $u \mapsto u^{-p}$). For $V \in [0,1]$ and $a, b > 0$ write $\mathcal{I}_V(a,b) := B(a,b)^{-1}\int_0^V t^{a-1}(1-t)^{b-1}\,\mathrm{d}t$ for the regularised incomplete beta function. For $\beta > 0$ let ω_β be the arcsine law on $[0,\beta]$, with density $1/(\pi\sqrt{y(\beta-y)})$.

Proposition 2.5 ([15, Theorem 1.3(i)–(ii)])**.** *Let $p > 0$ and let $\mu^* := \int_0^1 \omega_{4ct^{-p}}\,\mathrm{d}t$, a probability measure on $(0,\infty)$.*

(i) *μ^* has the density*

$$\psi^*(x) = \lambda_p(x)\,\mathcal{I}_{\min(1,\,x/4c)}\big(\tfrac{1}{p}+\tfrac{1}{2},\tfrac{1}{2}\big), \qquad x > 0.$$

In particular $\psi^* = \lambda_p$ on $[4c,\infty)$ (saturation) and $0 < \psi^* < \lambda_p$ on $(0,4c)$.

(ii) *The function $U^*(x) := \int \log|x-y|\,\mathrm{d}\mu^*(y)$ satisfies $U^*(x) = \gamma_p$ for $0 < x \le 4c$, and $U^*(x) \ge \gamma_p$ for all $x > 0$.*

(iii) *(Hard edge.) As $x \to 0^+$,*

$$\psi^*(x) = C_* x^{-1/2}\big(1 + O(x)\big), \qquad C_* := \frac{(4c)^{-1/p-1/2}}{p\,a_* B(a_*,\tfrac{1}{2})}, \quad a_* := \frac{1}{p}+\frac{1}{2}.$$

Proof. Parts (i) and (ii) are [15, Theorem 1.3(i)–(ii)], transported from the variable u to $x = u^{-p}$: there, μ_u^* is the image of μ^* under $x \mapsto x^{-1/p}$ and has density $\rho^*(u) = \mathcal{I}_{\min(1,u^{-p}/4c)}(\frac{1}{p}+\frac{1}{2},\frac{1}{2})$, with $\rho^* = 1$ exactly on $(0,(4c)^{-1/p}]$ and $0 < \rho^* < 1$ on $((4c)^{-1/p},\infty)$. Since $|\,\mathrm{d}u/\,\mathrm{d}x| = \lambda_p(x)$, the density of μ^* in x is $\lambda_p(x)\rho^*(x^{-1/p})$, which is (i). Part (ii) is quoted verbatim, with $\gamma_p = \log c + p$. For (iii), let $V = x/4c \le 1$. Then $\int_0^V t^{a_*-1}(1-t)^{-1/2}\,\mathrm{d}t = \frac{V^{a_*}}{a_*}(1+O(V))$, so $\psi^*(x) = \frac{1}{p}x^{-1-1/p}(x/4c)^{1/p+1/2}\big(a_*B(a_*,\frac{1}{2})\big)^{-1}(1+O(x))$, which is (iii). □

The point $x = 4c$ is the soft edge, $(0,4c)$ is the band, and $x = 0$ is the hard edge, where μ^* has the inverse-square-root density of (iii).

2.5. **Tools.** This subsection lists every external result used in Sections 5–8 and the appendices. Each is stated with its hypotheses and the equation numbers of the source, so that the reader can check them against our use. The later sections refer to these items as T1–T4. Throughout, the Cauchy transform on an oriented contour Σ is

$$\mathcal{C}f(z) := \frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_\Sigma \frac{f(s)\,\mathrm{d}s}{s-z}, \qquad z \in \mathbb{C}\setminus\Sigma,$$

and $\mathcal{C}_\pm f$ are its non-tangential boundary values from the left $(+)$ and the right $(-)$ of Σ, so that $\mathcal{C}_+ - \mathcal{C}_- = 1$. For a jump matrix v on Σ we write $\mathcal{C}_v f := \mathcal{C}_-\big(f(v-I)\big)$. Matrices $\sigma_1,\sigma_2,\sigma_3$ are the Pauli matrices, and $\sigma_3 = \mathrm{diag}(1,-1)$.

T1. The discrete interpolation problem (Wu–Lin–Xu–Zhao [19]). Wu, Lin, Xu and Zhao [19] develop the Riemann–Hilbert method for discrete orthogonal polynomials on infinitely many nodes with an accumulation point, for the Tricomi–Carlitz polynomials with a positive parameter (their standing hypothesis: "α is a positive parameter"). We do not apply any of their theorems to our measures. We use three things from their paper: the formulation of the problem, the order of the transformations, and the Airy construction. Our own versions are written out and verified in Sections 5 and 6.

(a) The problem and its solution by the orthogonal polynomials. Let $\sigma = \sum_{k\ge1} w_k\delta_{x_k}$ with distinct nodes $x_k \in (0,1]$, $w_k > 0$ and $\sum_k w_k < \infty$, and fix $n \ge 1$. Following [19, (2.14) and Theorem 2.3], which they attribute to Fokas, Its and Kitaev, consider the 2×2 matrix

$$Y(z) := \begin{pmatrix} P_n(z) & \displaystyle\sum_k \frac{w_k P_n(x_k)}{z-x_k} \\ h_{n-1}^{-1}P_{n-1}(z) & \displaystyle h_{n-1}^{-1}\sum_k \frac{w_k P_{n-1}(x_k)}{z-x_k} \end{pmatrix}. \tag{16}$$

Then: Y is analytic in $\mathbb{C}\setminus(\{x_k\}_k\cup\{0\})$; at each node it has a simple pole with

$$\operatorname*{Res}_{z=x_k} Y(z) = \lim_{z\to x_k} Y(z)\begin{pmatrix} 0 & w_k \\ 0 & 0\end{pmatrix}$$

(the residue condition [19, (2.14)]); and $Y(z)z^{-n\sigma_3} = I + Y_1/z + Y_2/z^2 + O(z^{-3})$ as $z\to\infty$. Moreover

$$(Y_1)_{12}(Y_1)_{21} = b_n^2, \qquad \frac{(Y_2)_{12}}{(Y_1)_{12}} - (Y_1)_{22} = a_n. \tag{17}$$

Proof. The sums converge uniformly on compact subsets of $\mathbb{C}\setminus(\{x_k\}\cup\{0\})$, because $|P_j(x_k)|$ is bounded and $\sum w_k < \infty$; this gives analyticity and the simple poles, and $\operatorname{Res}_{x_k} Y_{j2} = w_k Y_{j1}(x_k)$, which is the residue condition. For $|z| > 2$ expand $(z-x)^{-1} = \sum_{i\ge0} x^i z^{-i-1}$, uniformly for $x\in(0,1]$; then $\sum_k w_k P_m(x_k)/(z-x_k) = \sum_{i\ge0} z^{-i-1}\int P_m x^i\,\mathrm{d}\sigma$. Write $P_m(x) = x^m + \pi_m x^{m-1} + \dots$. Then $\int P_m x^i\,\mathrm{d}\sigma = 0$ for $i < m$, $= h_m$ for $i = m$, and $= -\pi_{m+1}h_m$ for $i = m+1$ (since $x^{m+1} = P_{m+1} - \pi_{m+1}P_m +$ lower terms). Hence $z^nY_{12} = h_n z^{-1} - \pi_{n+1}h_n z^{-2} + O(z^{-3})$, $z^nY_{22} = 1 - \pi_n z^{-1} + O(z^{-2})$, $z^{-n}Y_{21} = h_{n-1}^{-1}z^{-1} + O(z^{-2})$ and $z^{-n}Y_{11} = 1 + O(z^{-1})$. This gives the normalisation at ∞, $(Y_1)_{12} = h_n$, $(Y_1)_{21} = h_{n-1}^{-1}$, $(Y_2)_{12} = -\pi_{n+1}h_n$ and $(Y_1)_{22} = -\pi_n$. So $(Y_1)_{12}(Y_1)_{21} = h_n/h_{n-1} = b_n^2$, and comparing the coefficients of x^n in (10) gives $\pi_n = \pi_{n+1} + a_n$, i.e. the second identity in (17). □

No uniqueness or existence statement for this problem is used: the matrix in Section 5 is built from (16).

(b) Transformations. The sequence of transformations in Section 5 follows [19, §§3–5]: removal of the poles by the triangular factors built from $\Pi = \sin\theta/\theta'$ and $e^{\pm i\theta}$ ([19, (3.9)–(3.15)]), normalisation by the g-function ([19, (4.1)]), the lens and saturated-region factors $V_\pm$, $V_\pm^{\triangle}$ ([19, (4.12)–(4.13)]; in (4.12) the first two cases carry the superscript $\triangle$), and the conjugation by the outer scalar ([19, (5.1)]). In [19] these are written in a symmetric variable with nodes $\pm x_k$; we use only their pattern, and every jump is recomputed in Section 5 for our one-sided problem.

(c) The Airy parametrix at a soft edge. [19, §6.1] construct, in a disc $U(2,\varepsilon)$ about the soft edge 2 of their band, a matrix $V_r(z) = E_r(z)\sigma_2\Psi(\tilde f_n(z))\sigma_2 e^{n\tilde\varphi\sigma_3}(\tilde D/\tilde w^{1/2})^{\sigma_3}$ ([19, (6.12)]), with Ψ the Airy model problem, $\tilde f_n(z) = (-\frac32 n\tilde\varphi(z))^{2/3}$ ([19, (6.10)]) and $\tilde\varphi(z) = -\frac23(z-2)^{3/2} + O((z-2)^2)$ ([19, (6.11)]). Its hypotheses are: the local jumps have the form [19, (6.4)] (band $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & w_0/\tilde D^2 \\ -\tilde D^2/w_0 & 0\end{smallmatrix}\right)$, vertical segments $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & \tilde w/(\tilde D^2 e^{2n\tilde\varphi}) \\ 0 & 1\end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \tilde D^2 e^{2n\tilde\varphi}/\tilde w & 1\end{smallmatrix}\right)$ on $(2,2+\varepsilon)$), with $\tilde w$ analytic and non-vanishing in the disc. Its conclusion is the matching condition [19, (6.2)]: $V_{\mathrm{loc}}(z)N^{-1}(z) = I + O(1/n)$ on $\partial U(2,\varepsilon)$, where N is the global parametrix.

T2. The Bessel model problem (Kuijlaars, McLaughlin, Van Assche and Vanlessen [10]). We use the explicit Bessel model of [10, §6] and its algebraic properties; we do not apply their theorems on orthogonal polynomials. (Their standing hypothesis [10, (1.1)],

"$h(x)$ is real analytic and strictly positive on $[-1,1]$", concerns their weight and is not needed for the facts below; see Section 7.)

(a) The model. Let $\alpha > -1$ and let Σ_Ψ consist of the rays $\gamma_1 : \arg\zeta = 2\pi/3$, $\gamma_2 : \arg\zeta = \pi$, $\gamma_3 : \arg\zeta = -2\pi/3$, "oriented as in Figure 3" of [10]; in that figure all three rays are oriented towards the origin, with the + side on the left. The function

$$\Psi_\alpha(\zeta) = \begin{pmatrix} I_\alpha(2\zeta^{1/2}) & \frac{i}{\pi}K_\alpha(2\zeta^{1/2}) \\ 2\pi i\zeta^{1/2}I'_\alpha(2\zeta^{1/2}) & -2\zeta^{1/2}K'_\alpha(2\zeta^{1/2}) \end{pmatrix}, \qquad |\arg\zeta| < 2\pi/3,$$

([10, (6.23)]), continued to $2\pi/3 < \pm\arg\zeta < \pi$ by the Hankel-function formulas [10, (6.24)–(6.25)], satisfies the jump relations

$$\Psi_+ = \Psi_- \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ e^{\alpha\pi i} & 1 \end{pmatrix} \text{ on } \gamma_1, \qquad \Psi_+ = \Psi_- \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \text{ on } \gamma_2, \qquad \Psi_+ = \Psi_- \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ e^{-\alpha\pi i} & 1 \end{pmatrix} \text{ on } \gamma_3$$

([10, (6.16)–(6.18)]) and is a solution of the Bessel model problem ([10, Theorem 6.3]). As $\zeta \to \infty$, "uniformly as $\zeta \to \infty$, $\zeta \in \mathbb{C} \setminus \Sigma_\Psi$",

$$\Psi_\alpha(\zeta) = (2\pi\zeta^{1/2})^{-\sigma_3/2}\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\begin{pmatrix} 1+O(\zeta^{-1/2}) & i+O(\zeta^{-1/2}) \\ i+O(\zeta^{-1/2}) & 1+O(\zeta^{-1/2}) \end{pmatrix} e^{2\zeta^{1/2}\sigma_3}$$

([10, (6.28)]). KMVV obtain (6.28) by inserting the large-argument expansions of I_α, K_α into (6.23) for $|\arg\zeta| < 2\pi/3$, and those of the Hankel functions into (6.24)–(6.25) in the other two sectors. When the rays are moved by the angle freedom (b) below, the expansions of T4 (DLMF §10.40) give the same formula (6.28) in the enlarged sector; this is checked where it is used. The behaviour of Ψ_α at $\zeta = 0$ is derived in Lemma 7.1 directly from (6.23) and T4; we do not use [10, (6.19)–(6.21)] beyond the comparison made there.

(b) Angle freedom. After [10, (6.21)]: "In the above, we have chosen the angle $2\pi/3$ rather arbitrarily. It could be replaced by any angle in $(0,\pi)$." The lens contours in the disc are then defined as preimages of the rays under $\zeta = n^2 f(z)$, which "does not depend on n". We use rays at $\pm(\pi - \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$.

(c) The left endpoint. Our hard edge has the band to its right, which is the endpoint -1 of [10]. There the conformal map reverses orientation ("if $z < -1$, then $\zeta > 0$, while if $z > -1$, then $\zeta < 0$"), and "the reversal of the directions is taken care of by conjugating with the Pauli matrix σ_3": $\tilde\Psi(\zeta) = \sigma_3\Psi(\zeta;\alpha \to \beta)\sigma_3$ ([10, (6.51)]), with the prefactor $\tilde E_n(z) = N(z)\tilde W(z)^{\sigma_3}\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & i \\ i & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)\tilde f(z)^{\sigma_3/4}(2\pi n)^{\sigma_3/2}$ ([10, (6.53)]); compare the right-endpoint formulas [10, (6.27), (6.31)] and $\det E_n \equiv 1$ ([10, (6.33)]). The analyticity of the prefactor is proved in [10, proof of Proposition 6.5] by a removability argument: "all entries of $E_n(z)$ have at most a square-root singularity at $z = 1$. Since we already know that E_n is analytic in a punctured neighborhood of 1, the isolated singularity at 1 is removable." In Section 7 this argument is applied only to a prefactor that does not involve the weight.

T3. The comparison argument (Conway–Deift [2]). The following are quoted from [2, §4]. Their Cauchy operator is normalised as ours, as the identity in (b) requires $(\mathcal{C}_+ - \mathcal{C}_- = 1)$.

(a) Boundedness and the class $\partial\mathcal{C}$. "The operators $C^\pm_\Sigma$ are bounded from $L^2(\Sigma) \to L^2(\Sigma)$ (and in fact in $L^p(\Sigma)$ for all $1 < p < \infty$) if and only if Σ is Carleson." A pair of functions $A_\pm \in L^p(\Sigma)$ belongs to $\partial\mathcal{C}(L^p(\Sigma))$ "iff $A_\pm = C^\pm_\Sigma f$ for some (unique) $f \in L^p(\Sigma)$"; we write $A_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^p)$ if $A_\pm - I \in \partial\mathcal{C}(L^p)$.

(b) Theorem 4.4 of [2]. "Suppose $v_A, v_B \in L^\infty(\Sigma)$ and $A_\pm$ solves the RHP: $A_+(x) = A_-(x)v_A(x)$, for $x \in \Sigma$, $A_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^p(\Sigma))$, and $B_\pm$ the RHP: $B_+(x) = B_-(x)v_B(x)$, for $x \in \Sigma$, $B_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^p(\Sigma))$. Suppose further that $v_B^{-1} \in L^\infty(\Sigma)$ and $B_\pm^{-1} \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^q(\Sigma))$

where $1/p + 1/q = 1$, then if A, B are the analytic extensions of $A_\pm$ and $B_\pm$ respectively,

$$AB^{-1} = I + C_\Sigma\big(A_-(v_A v_B^{-1} - I)B_-^{-1}\big).\text{"}$$

Consequence (moments at infinity). If in addition Σ is bounded and $A = I + A_1/z + A_2/z^2 + O(z^{-3})$, $B = I + B_1/z + B_2/z^2 + O(z^{-3})$ as $z \to \infty$, then with $H := A_-(v_A - v_B)v_B^{-1}B_-^{-1} \in L^1(\Sigma)$ (take $p = q = 2$),

$$A_1 - B_1 = -\frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_\Sigma H(s)\,\mathrm{d}s, \qquad A_2 - B_2 = -\frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_\Sigma sH(s)\,\mathrm{d}s + (A_1 - B_1)B_1. \tag{18}$$

Indeed, for $|z| > \max_\Sigma |s|$ we have $\mathcal{C}H(z) = -\sum_{j\ge 0} z^{-j-1}\frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_\Sigma s^j H(s)\,\mathrm{d}s$, while $AB^{-1} = I + (A_1 - B_1)z^{-1} + (A_2 - B_2 - (A_1 - B_1)B_1)z^{-2} + O(z^{-3})$. This is the mechanism of [2, Proposition 4.9, (4.14)], whose proof identifies "$\mu = Q_-$, $\tilde\mu = \tilde Q_-$".

(c) Solution formula. [2, §4.2]: with $(C_h f)(x) = C_\Sigma^-(f(h-I))(x)$, "If $1 - C_{v_\Sigma}$ is an invertible operator from $L^2(\Sigma)$ to $L^2(\Sigma)$, then $\mu = (1 - C_{v_\Sigma})^{-1}I$ … the unique solution X to the RHP normalized at infinity with jump v_Σ is given by $X(z) = I + C_\Sigma(\mu(v_\Sigma - I))$."

(d) The Neumann-series step of [2, proof of Thm. 4.7, (4.12)–(4.13)]. If $\|(1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})^{-1}\|_{L^2\to L^2} \le K$ and $\|\mathcal{C}_v - \mathcal{C}_{\tilde v}\|_{L^2\to L^2} \le 1/(2K)$, then

$$(1 - \mathcal{C}_v)^{-1} = (1 - \mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})^{-1}\big(1 - (\mathcal{C}_v - \mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})(1 - \mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})^{-1}\big)^{-1}$$

exists and has norm at most $2K$. (This is elementary: the inner factor is 1 minus an operator of norm at most $\frac12$.) In [2] the smallness comes from "$\|v_\Sigma - \tilde v_\Sigma\|_{L^\infty(\Sigma)} \to 0$, which, in particular, implies that $\|C_{v_\Sigma} - C_{\tilde v_\Sigma}\|_{L^2\to L^2} \to 0$".

(e) Proposition 4.6 of [2] (attributed there to Deift–Zhou): "A family of operators $(1-C_{h_n})^{-1}$ is bounded uniformly with respect to n if and only if the inhomogeneous RHP $m_+(s) = m_-(s)h_n(s) + g(s)$ for $s \in \Sigma$, $m_\pm \in \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\Sigma))$ is (uniquely) solvable for all $g \in L^2(\Sigma)$ with $\|m_\pm\|_{L^2} \le c\|g\|_{L^2}$ with c independent of both n and g." We use only the direction "solvable with bounds ⇒ bounded inverse", and we re-prove it in Appendix B.

We do *not* use [2, Theorem 4.5], whose proof is specific to the Legendre comparison problem.

T4. Special functions (NIST DLMF [8]). Principal branches throughout. We use:

- *Gamma function.* (5.5.1) $\Gamma(z+1) = z\Gamma(z)$; (5.5.3) $\Gamma(z)\Gamma(1-z) = \pi/\sin(\pi z)$ for $z \ne 0, \pm1, \dots$; (5.11.1) as $z \to \infty$ in $|\mathrm{ph}\, z| \le \pi - \delta$, $\mathrm{Ln}\,\Gamma(z) \sim (z - \frac12)\ln z - z + \frac12\ln(2\pi) + \sum_{k\ge1}\frac{B_{2k}}{2k(2k-1)z^{2k-1}}$; and the remainder bound of §5.11(ii): if the sum is terminated at $k = m-1$ and z is complex, the remainder is bounded in magnitude by $\sec^{2m}(\frac12\mathrm{ph}\, z)$ times the first neglected term.
- *Beta integrals.* (5.12.1) $B(a,b) = \int_0^1 t^{a-1}(1-t)^{b-1}\,\mathrm{d}t = \Gamma(a)\Gamma(b)/\Gamma(a+b)$ and (5.12.3) $\int_0^\infty t^{a-1}(1+t)^{-a-b}\,\mathrm{d}t = B(a,b)$, for $\Re a, \Re b > 0$.
- *Mellin transform.* (1.14.32) $\mathcal{M}f(s) = \int_0^\infty x^{s-1}f(x)\,\mathrm{d}x$. (1.14.38) For real f,
$$\int_0^\infty f(x)^2\,\mathrm{d}x = \frac{1}{2\pi}\int_{-\infty}^\infty \big|\mathcal{M}f(\tfrac12 + it)\big|^2\,\mathrm{d}t.$$
(1.14.39)–(1.14.40) The Mellin convolution $(f*g)(x) := \int_0^\infty f(y)g(x/y)\,\mathrm{d}y/y$ satisfies $\int_0^\infty x^{s-1}(f*g)(x)\,\mathrm{d}x = \mathcal{M}f(s)\,\mathcal{M}g(s)$ when $x^{\Re s-1}f$ and $x^{\Re s-1}g$ are absolutely integrable.
- *Modified Bessel functions.* (10.25.2) $I_\nu(z) = (\frac12 z)^\nu\sum_{k\ge0}(\frac14 z^2)^k/(k!\,\Gamma(\nu+k+1))$, the principal branch being analytic in $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty,0]$ (§10.25(ii)); (10.27.3) $K_{-\nu} = K_\nu$; (10.27.4) $K_\nu(z) = \frac12\pi(I_{-\nu}(z) - I_\nu(z))/\sin(\nu\pi)$; (10.31.2) $K_0(z) = -(\ln(\frac12 z) + \gamma)I_0(z) + \frac{\frac14 z^2}{(1!)^2} + (1+\frac12)\frac{(\frac14 z^2)^2}{(2!)^2} + \cdots$ (γ Euler's constant).

- *Wronskian.* (1.13.4) $\mathcal{W}\{w_1, w_2\} = w_1 w_2' - w_2 w_1'$ and (10.28.2) $\mathcal{W}\{K_\nu(z), I_\nu(z)\} = I_\nu(z)K_{\nu+1}(z) + I_{\nu+1}(z)K_\nu(z) = 1/z$. Together with (6.23) of T2 they give $\det \Psi_\alpha = 2\zeta^{1/2}\mathcal{W}\{K_\alpha, I_\alpha\}(2\zeta^{1/2}) = 1$ for $|\arg\zeta| < 2\pi/3$.
- *Large argument.* As $z \to \infty$ with ν fixed (§10.40(i)),

$$I_\nu(z) \sim \frac{e^z}{(2\pi z)^{1/2}} \sum_{k\geq 0} (-1)^k \frac{a_k(\nu)}{z^k}, \qquad |\mathrm{ph}\, z| \leq \tfrac{1}{2}\pi - \delta, \tag{10.40.1}$$

$$K_\nu(z) \sim \left(\frac{\pi}{2z}\right)^{1/2} e^{-z} \sum_{k\geq 0} \frac{a_k(\nu)}{z^k}, \qquad |\mathrm{ph}\, z| \leq \tfrac{3}{2}\pi - \delta, \tag{10.40.2}$$

and (10.40.3)–(10.40.4) are the same expansions for I_ν', K_ν' with $a_k(\nu)$ replaced by $b_k(\nu)$ and an overall minus sign for K_ν', in the same sectors. The "more general (and more accurate)" (10.40.5) is

$$I_\nu(z) \sim \frac{e^z}{(2\pi z)^{1/2}} \sum_{k\geq 0} (-1)^k \frac{a_k(\nu)}{z^k} \pm i e^{\pm\nu\pi i} \frac{e^{-z}}{(2\pi z)^{1/2}} \sum_{k\geq 0} \frac{a_k(\nu)}{z^k}, \qquad -\tfrac{1}{2}\pi + \delta \leq \pm \mathrm{ph}\, z \leq \tfrac{3}{2}\pi - \delta.$$

Here $\delta > 0$ is a small constant, and $a_0(\nu) = 1$ by (10.17.1) (an empty product).

3. The Christoffel shift

Multiplying the measure by x shifts the exponent s by exactly p: for $x_k = k^{-p}$,

$$x\,\sigma_{p,s,\ell} = \sum_{k\geq 1} k^{-p}\, k^{-s} \ell(k)\, \delta_{k^{-p}} = \sigma_{p,s+p,\ell}, \tag{19}$$

with the same ℓ. This section proves Theorem 3: the pointwise law, with its rate, passes from σ to $x\sigma$. The Jacobi matrix of $x\sigma$ is obtained by factoring the Jacobi matrix of σ as a product LU of bidiagonal matrices and multiplying the factors in the opposite order. The entries of the factors are not known in advance, since they involve the values $P_n(0)$. The point of the section is that no information about $P_n(0)$ is needed beyond its sign: the factors satisfy a recursion whose limiting map has a double (parabolic) fixed point, and positivity alone forces them to converge to it.

We restate the theorem for convenience. As in §2.1, a_n, b_n are the Jacobi coefficients of σ, and $\tilde{a}_n, \tilde{b}_n$ denote those of $x\sigma$, where $\mathrm{d}(x\sigma) := x\,\mathrm{d}\sigma(x)$.

Theorem 3 (restated). *Let σ be a positive Borel measure on $[0,\infty)$ with infinite support and finite moments, let $p > 0$ and $c > 0$, and let η_n be a regular rate. If $|n^p a_n - 2c| + |n^p b_n - c| = O(\eta_n)$, then $|n^p \tilde{a}_n - 2c| + |n^p \tilde{b}_n - c| = O(\eta_n)$. If $n^p a_n \to 2c$ and $n^p b_n \to c$, then $n^p \tilde{a}_n \to 2c$ and $n^p \tilde{b}_n \to c$.*

3.1. The transfer formulas.

Lemma 3.1. *Let σ be a positive Borel measure on $[0,\infty)$ with infinite support and finite moments. Then for $n \geq 1$ the polynomial P_n has n simple zeros, all in $(0,\infty)$. In particular $(-1)^n P_n(0) > 0$ for all $n \geq 0$.*

Proof. Let $y_1 < \cdots < y_m$ be the zeros of P_n in $(0,\infty)$ of odd multiplicity, and put $\pi(x) := \prod_j (x - y_j)$ ($\pi := 1$ if $m = 0$). Suppose $m < n$. Then $\int P_n \pi\, \mathrm{d}\sigma = 0$ by orthogonality. On the other hand, every remaining factor of P_n is of the form $(x-y)^{2i}$ with y real, or $(x-y)$ with $y \leq 0$, or $(x-z)(x-\bar{z}) = |x-z|^2$ with $z \notin \mathbb{R}$; each is non-negative on $[0,\infty)$. Hence $P_n\pi \geq 0$ on $[0,\infty)$. Since $P_n\pi$ is a non-zero polynomial and σ has infinite support, $\int P_n \pi\, \mathrm{d}\sigma > 0$, a

contradiction. So $m = n$, the n zeros are simple and positive, and $P_n(0) = \prod_j(-y_j)$ has the sign $(-1)^n$. □

By Lemma 3.1 we may define

$$u_n := -\frac{P_{n+1}(0)}{P_n(0)} > 0 \quad (n \ge 0), \qquad l_0 := 0, \qquad l_n := \frac{b_n^2}{u_{n-1}} > 0 \quad (n \ge 1).$$

Lemma 3.2. *Let σ be as in Lemma 3.1. Then:*

(i) *$a_n = u_n + l_n$ for $n \ge 0$, and $b_n^2 = u_{n-1}l_n$ for $n \ge 1$. Equivalently, $u_0 = a_0$ and $u_n = a_n - b_n^2/u_{n-1}$ for $n \ge 1$.*

(ii) *The measure $x\sigma$ has infinite support, its monic orthogonal polynomials are $\widetilde{P}_n(x) := \big(P_{n+1}(x) + u_nP_n(x)\big)/x$, and its Jacobi coefficients are*

$$\tilde{a}_n = u_n + l_{n+1} \quad (n \ge 0), \qquad \tilde{b}_n^2 = u_nl_n \quad (n \ge 1). \tag{20}$$

In matrix form: $J(\sigma) = LU$, with L unit lower bidiagonal with subdiagonal $(l_1, l_2, \dots)$ and U upper bidiagonal with diagonal $(u_0, u_1, \dots)$ and superdiagonal 1; and $J(x\sigma) = UL$. This is the classical Christoffel (or Darboux) transformation; see Derevyagin–Derkach [7, §1], where it is written $J = LU \mapsto UL$. We include the short proof. (Equivalently, the symmetric Jacobi matrix factors as $\mathcal{J}(\sigma) = \mathcal{L}\mathcal{L}^{\mathsf{T}}$ with $\mathcal{L}$ lower bidiagonal, and $\mathcal{J}(x\sigma) = \mathcal{L}^{\mathsf{T}}\mathcal{L}$; this Cholesky form leads to a second proof of the results of this section, which we do not give.)

Proof. (i) Evaluate (10) at $x = 0$: $0 = P_{n+1}(0) + a_nP_n(0) + b_n^2P_{n-1}(0)$. Dividing by $P_n(0) \ne 0$ gives $a_n = u_n - b_n^2P_{n-1}(0)/P_n(0) = u_n + b_n^2/u_{n-1} = u_n + l_n$ for $n \ge 1$, and $a_0 = u_0$ since $P_{-1} = 0$. The identity $b_n^2 = u_{n-1}l_n$ is the definition of l_n.

(ii) The support of $x\sigma$ is $\operatorname{supp}\sigma \setminus \{0\}$, which is infinite, and $x\sigma$ has finite moments. The polynomial $P_{n+1} + u_nP_n$ vanishes at 0 by the definition of u_n, so $\widetilde{P}_n$ is a monic polynomial of degree n. For $j \le n-1$, $\int \widetilde{P}_n x^j \,\mathrm{d}(x\sigma) = \int (P_{n+1} + u_nP_n)x^j \,\mathrm{d}\sigma = 0$. Hence the $\widetilde{P}_n$ are the monic orthogonal polynomials of $x\sigma$.

Next, for $n \ge 1$ the polynomial $P_n - \widetilde{P}_n$ has degree at most $n-1$, and for $j \le n-2$

$$\int (P_n - \widetilde{P}_n)x^j \,\mathrm{d}(x\sigma) = \int P_n x^{j+1} \,\mathrm{d}\sigma - \int \widetilde{P}_n x^j \,\mathrm{d}(x\sigma) = 0.$$

So $P_n - \widetilde{P}_n = l_n'\widetilde{P}_{n-1}$ for some constant l_n'; put $l_0' := 0$, consistent with $P_0 = \widetilde{P}_0 = 1$. Then

$$xP_n = x\widetilde{P}_n + l_n' \, x\widetilde{P}_{n-1} = (P_{n+1} + u_nP_n) + l_n'(P_n + u_{n-1}P_{n-1}).$$

Comparing with (10) (the P_j are linearly independent) gives $a_n = u_n + l_n'$ and $b_n^2 = l_n'u_{n-1}$, so $l_n' = l_n$ by (i). Finally,

$$x\widetilde{P}_n = P_{n+1} + u_nP_n = (\widetilde{P}_{n+1} + l_{n+1}\widetilde{P}_n) + u_n(\widetilde{P}_n + l_n\widetilde{P}_{n-1}),$$

which is the recurrence of $x\sigma$ with $\tilde{a}_n = u_n + l_{n+1}$ and $\tilde{b}_n^2 = u_nl_n$. □

3.2. **The chain sequence converges.** Assume now that σ satisfies the pointwise law at scale n^p with constant $c > 0$. We work with the rescaled quantities

$$\hat{a}_n := n^p a_n, \quad \hat{b}_n := n^p b_n, \quad \hat{u}_n := n^p u_n, \quad \hat{l}_n := n^p l_n, \quad \kappa_n := \Big(\frac{n-1}{n}\Big)^p.$$

Multiplying the identities of Lemma 3.2(i) by n^p, and using $n^p \cdot (n-1)^p = n^{2p}\kappa_n$, we get

$$\hat{u}_n + \hat{l}_n = \hat{a}_n, \qquad \hat{u}_{n-1}\hat{l}_n = \kappa_n\hat{b}_n^2, \qquad \text{so} \qquad \hat{u}_n = \hat{a}_n - \frac{\kappa_n\hat{b}_n^2}{\hat{u}_{n-1}} \qquad (n \ge 1). \tag{21}$$

If $\hat a_n \to 2c$, $\hat b_n \to c$ and $\hat u_{n-1} \to c$, the last identity tends to

$$\hat u_n \approx F(\hat u_{n-1}), \qquad F(t) := 2c - \frac{c^2}{t}, \qquad F(t) - t = -\frac{(t-c)^2}{t}, \qquad F(c+y) = c + \frac{cy}{c+y}. \tag{22}$$

The map F is increasing on $(0,\infty)$, has the single fixed point c, and this fixed point is double: $F(t) \le t$ for every $t > 0$. An orbit that settles below c is therefore pushed down towards 0, and one above c is pulled down to c. Positivity of u_n rules out the first possibility.

Lemma 3.3. *Let σ be as in Lemma 3.1, $p > 0$ and $c > 0$. If $\hat a_n \to 2c$ and $\hat b_n \to c$, then $\hat u_n \to c$ and $\hat l_n \to c$.*

Lemma 3.3 is a special case of Dai–Piao–Qiao [4, Proposition 2.1]: in the variables $\mathsf{a}_n := b_n^2/(a_{n-1}a_n)$ and $\mathsf{m}_n := l_n/a_n$ one has $\mathsf{a}_n = (1-\mathsf{m}_{n-1})\mathsf{m}_n$ with $\mathsf{m}_0 = 0$ and $0 < \mathsf{m}_n < 1$, so (a_n) is a chain sequence with parameter sequence (m_n); the hypothesis gives $\mathsf{a}_n = \kappa_n \hat b_n^2/(\hat a_{n-1}\hat a_n) \to \frac14$, and [4, Proposition 2.1] states that then every parameter sequence tends to $\frac12$. We include the short proof, because the rate version, Lemma 3.4, follows the same lines.

Proof. A priori bounds. By Lemma 3.1, $u_n, l_n > 0$, so $\hat u_n < \hat a_n$ and $\hat l_n < \hat a_n$. Hence $\hat u_{n-1} = \kappa_n \hat b_n^2/\hat l_n > \kappa_n \hat b_n^2/\hat a_n \to c/2$. So there is n_1 with $\hat u_n \in [c/3, 3c]$ for $n \ge n_1$.

Recursion. For $n > n_1$, (21) reads $\hat u_n = F(\hat u_{n-1}) + e_n$ with

$$e_n := (\hat a_n - 2c) - \frac{\kappa_n \hat b_n^2 - c^2}{\hat u_{n-1}}, \qquad |e_n| \le |\hat a_n - 2c| + \frac{3}{c}\,|\kappa_n \hat b_n^2 - c^2| \longrightarrow 0.$$

Fix $\delta \in (0, c/3)$ and put $d := \delta^2/(3c)$. By (22), $F(t) \le t - d$ for every $t \in [c/3, 3c]$ with $|t - c| \ge \delta$. Choose $n_2 > n_1$ with $|e_n| < \min(d/2, \delta)$ for $n \ge n_2$.

Lower bound. Suppose $\hat u_m < c - \delta$ for some $m \ge n_2$. Then $\hat u_{m+1} \le \hat u_m - d + |e_{m+1}| < \hat u_m - d/2 < c - \delta$, and by induction $\hat u_{m+j} < \hat u_m - jd/2$ for all $j \ge 1$. This contradicts $\hat u_n \ge c/3$. So $\hat u_n \ge c - \delta$ for all $n \ge n_2$.

Upper bound. Let $n \ge n_2$. If $\hat u_n \ge c + \delta$, then $\hat u_{n+1} < \hat u_n - d/2$. If $\hat u_n < c + \delta$, then, F being increasing, $\hat u_{n+1} < F(c+\delta) + \delta < c + 2\delta$, because $F(c+\delta) < c + \delta$. The first alternative cannot hold for all $n \ge n_2$, since $\hat u_n$ would then decrease by $d/2$ at every step while staying above $c/3$. So $\hat u_m < c + \delta$ for some $m \ge n_2$. From then on $\hat u_n < c + 2\delta$: if $\hat u_n < c + \delta$ this was just shown, and if $c + \delta \le \hat u_n < c + 2\delta$ then $\hat u_{n+1} < \hat u_n < c + 2\delta$.

Hence $c - \delta \le \liminf \hat u_n \le \limsup \hat u_n \le c + 2\delta$ for every small $\delta > 0$, so $\hat u_n \to c$, and $\hat l_n = \hat a_n - \hat u_n \to c$. □

3.3. **Rates.** With a rate, the same argument gives a rate for $\hat u_n$, but only the square root of the input rate. What saves the transfer is that the coefficients of $x\sigma$ depend on $\hat u_n$ only through its increments, which converge at the full rate.

Lemma 3.4. *Let σ be as in Lemma 3.1, $p > 0$, $c > 0$, and let η_n be a regular rate with $|\hat a_n - 2c| + |\hat b_n - c| \le M\eta_n$ for $n \ge 1$. Then*

$$|\hat u_n - c| = O(\sqrt{\eta_n}) \qquad \text{and} \qquad |\hat u_n - \hat u_{n-1}| = O(\eta_n).$$

Proof. We keep the notation of the previous proof; in particular $\hat u_n \in [c/3, 3c]$ for $n \ge n_1$, and $\hat u_n \to c$ by Lemma 3.3. We first bound the perturbation e_n. For every $p > 0$ and $n \ge 2$ we have $0 \le 1 - \kappa_n \le \max(p, 1)/n$: for $p \ge 1$ by Bernoulli's inequality $(1 - 1/n)^p \ge 1 - p/n$, and for $p < 1$ because $(1 - 1/n)^p \ge 1 - 1/n$. By (15), $1/n \le \eta_n/\eta_1$. Also $\hat b_n$ is bounded, so $|\hat b_n^2 - c^2| = O(\eta_n)$. Hence $|\kappa_n \hat b_n^2 - c^2| \le (1 - \kappa_n)\hat b_n^2 + |\hat b_n^2 - c^2| = O(\eta_n)$, and there is M_1 with $|e_n| \le M_1\eta_n$ for $n > n_1$.

Put $y_n := \hat{u}_n - c$. By (22),

$$y_{n+1} = \frac{cy_n}{c+y_n} + e_{n+1} = y_n - \frac{y_n^2}{\hat{u}_n} + e_{n+1} \qquad (n \ge n_1).$$

Lower bound. Let $\lambda_- := \sqrt{6cM_1}$. Suppose $y_m \le -\lambda_-\sqrt{\eta_m}$ for some $m \ge n_1$. Then $y_m^2/\hat{u}_m \ge \lambda_-^2\eta_m/(3c) = 2M_1\eta_m$, so $y_{m+1} \le y_m - 2M_1\eta_m + M_1\eta_{m+1} \le y_m - M_1\eta_m \le -\lambda_-\sqrt{\eta_m} \le -\lambda_-\sqrt{\eta_{m+1}}$. By induction $y_{m+j} \le y_m - M_1\sum_{i<j}\eta_{m+i}$, which tends to $-\infty$ because $\sum\eta_n = \infty$. This contradicts $\hat{u}_n > 0$. Hence $y_n > -\lambda_-\sqrt{\eta_n}$ for all $n \ge n_1$.

Upper bound. Choose $n_3 \ge n_1$ with $|y_n| \le c/2$ for $n \ge n_3$; then $\hat{u}_n \le 2c$ there. Choose $\lambda_+ > 0$ with $\lambda_+^2/(2c) \ge 2M_1 + \lambda_+/(2\sqrt{\eta_1})$ (possible, since the left side is quadratic in λ_+), and $n_4 \ge n_3$ with $\lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_n} \le c$ for $n \ge n_4$.

Step. Let $n \ge n_4$ and $y_n \le t := \lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_n}$. The map $y \mapsto cy/(c+y)$ is increasing on $(-c,\infty)$ and $y_n \ge -c/2$, so

$$y_{n+1} \le \frac{ct}{c+t} + M_1\eta_{n+1} \le t - \frac{t^2}{2c} + M_1\eta_n = t - \Big(\frac{\lambda_+^2}{2c} - M_1\Big)\eta_n \le t - \frac{\lambda_+\eta_n}{2\sqrt{\eta_1}},$$

using $t \le c$ and the choice of λ_+. On the other hand, $\eta_{n+1} \ge \eta_n n/(n+1)$ gives $t - \lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_{n+1}} \le \lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_n}\big(1 - \sqrt{n/(n+1)}\big) \le \lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_n}/(2n)$, where the last step is $\sqrt{n(n+1)} \ge n - 1$. Since $1/n \le \eta_n/\eta_1 \le \sqrt{\eta_n/\eta_1}$, this is at most $\lambda_+\eta_n/(2\sqrt{\eta_1})$. Together, $y_{n+1} \le \lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_{n+1}}$.

Entry. If $y_n > \lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_n}$ for some $n \ge n_4$, then $y_n^2/\hat{u}_n \ge y_n^2/(2c) \ge 2M_1\eta_n$, so $y_{n+1} \le y_n - M_1\eta_n$. While y stays above $\lambda_+\sqrt{\eta} \ge 0$ it decreases by the non-summable amounts $M_1\eta_n$, which is impossible for ever. So $y_m \le \lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_m}$ for some $m \ge n$, and by the step $y_k \le \lambda_+\sqrt{\eta_k}$ for all $k \ge m$.

Hence $|y_n| = O(\sqrt{\eta_n})$ (the finitely many earlier terms only change the constant). Finally, $|\hat{u}_n - \hat{u}_{n-1}| = |y_n - y_{n-1}| \le y_{n-1}^2/\hat{u}_{n-1} + |e_n| = O(\eta_{n-1}) + O(\eta_n) = O(\eta_n)$ by (15). □

3.4. **Proof of Theorem 3.** By Lemma 3.2(ii), $x\sigma$ is again a positive measure on $[0,\infty)$ with infinite support and finite moments, and by (20) and (21),

$$n^{2p}\tilde{b}_n^2 = \hat{u}_n\hat{l}_n = \frac{\kappa_n\hat{b}_n^2\,\hat{u}_n}{\hat{u}_{n-1}},$$
$$n^p\tilde{a}_n = \hat{u}_n + \Big(\frac{n}{n+1}\Big)^p\hat{l}_{n+1} = \hat{a}_{n+1} - (\hat{u}_{n+1} - \hat{u}_n) + \Big(\Big(\frac{n}{n+1}\Big)^p - 1\Big)\hat{l}_{n+1}.$$

Without a rate. By Lemma 3.3, $\hat{u}_n \to c$ and $\hat{l}_n \to c$, so $n^p\tilde{b}_n \to c$ and $n^p\tilde{a}_n \to 2c$.

With a regular rate η_n. By Lemma 3.4, $\hat{u}_n/\hat{u}_{n-1} = 1 + O(\eta_n)$, since $\hat{u}_{n-1} \ge c/3$ for large n. Also $\kappa_n = 1 + O(1/n) = 1 + O(\eta_n)$ and $\hat{b}_n = c + O(\eta_n)$. Hence $n^p\tilde{b}_n = \hat{b}_n\big(\kappa_n\hat{u}_n/\hat{u}_{n-1}\big)^{1/2} = c + O(\eta_n)$. For the diagonal, $\hat{a}_{n+1} = 2c + O(\eta_{n+1})$, $\hat{u}_{n+1} - \hat{u}_n = O(\eta_{n+1})$, $\hat{l}_{n+1}$ is bounded and $(n/(n+1))^p - 1 = O(1/n)$. Since $\eta_{n+1} \le \eta_n$ and $1/n \le \eta_n/\eta_1$, this gives $n^p\tilde{a}_n = 2c + O(\eta_n)$. □

For $x_k = k^{-p}$, (19) shows that Theorem 3 can be iterated: the pointwise law with a regular rate η_n for $\sigma_{p,s,\ell}$ implies the same for $\sigma_{p,s+mp,\ell}$, $m = 1, 2, \dots$, with the same ℓ and the rate $O(\eta_n)$. Each $x^j\sigma_{p,s,\ell} = \sigma_{p,s+jp,\ell}$ is again a positive measure on $(0,1]$ with infinite support.

Remark 3.5 (Only increments enter). The bound $|\hat{u}_n - c| = O(\sqrt{\eta_n})$ of Lemma 3.4 cannot be improved under the hypotheses of the lemma. Take $\eta_n = 1/n$, any $\theta_0 > 0$, and define $u_n := n^{-p}(c + \theta_0 n^{-1/2})$ for $n \ge 1$, $u_0 := 1$, $b_n := cn^{-p}$, $l_n := b_n^2/u_{n-1}$ $(n \ge 1)$, $l_0 := 0$ and $a_n := u_n + l_n$. All u_n, l_n are positive. The symmetric tridiagonal matrix with diagonal a_n and off-diagonal b_n equals $\mathcal{L}\mathcal{L}^{\mathsf{T}}$, where $\mathcal{L}$ is lower bidiagonal with diagonal $\sqrt{u_n}$ and subdiagonal $\sqrt{l_{n+1}}$. It is therefore a bounded positive semi-definite operator, so it is the Jacobi matrix of

a unique positive measure with infinite compact support in $[0,\infty)$. By Lemma 3.2(i), the u_n of that measure are the ones just defined, because $u_0 = a_0$ and $u_n = a_n - b_n^2/u_{n-1}$ determine them. A short expansion gives $\hat{b}_n = c$ and $\hat{a}_n - 2c = (\theta_0^2/c - pc)/n + O(n^{-3/2})$, so the law holds with rate $1/n$, while $\hat{u}_n - c = \theta_0\, n^{-1/2}$. Thus the parameters $\hat{u}_n$ themselves converge only at the rate $\sqrt{\eta_n}$, and the transfer keeps the full rate only because $\tilde{a}_n$ and $\tilde{b}_n$ involve $\hat{u}_n$ through the increments $\hat{u}_n - \hat{u}_{n-1}$ and the ratio $\hat{u}_n/\hat{u}_{n-1}$.

Remark 3.6 (The converse; a point mass at 0). Without a rate, the implication of Theorem 3 can be reversed: *if $x\sigma$ satisfies $n^p\tilde{a}_n \to 2c$ and $n^p\tilde{b}_n \to c$, then so does σ.* This direction is also a consequence of [4, Proposition 2.1], since that proposition covers every parameter sequence of the chain sequence, not only the minimal one. Since σ and $\sigma + m\delta_0$ ($m \geq 0$) have the same image $x\sigma$, it follows that the pointwise law is insensitive to a point mass at 0.

For completeness we give the argument. By (20), $l_{n+1} = \tilde{a}_n - u_n > 0$ and $u_{n+1} = \tilde{b}_{n+1}^2/l_{n+1}$, so $z_n := n^p u_n/c$ satisfies

$$z_{n+1} = \frac{B_n}{A_n - z_n}, \qquad 0 < z_n < A_n, \qquad A_n := \frac{n^p\tilde{a}_n}{c} \to 2, \qquad B_n := \frac{(n+1)^p n^p \tilde{b}_{n+1}^2}{c^2} \to 1.$$

The limiting map $z \mapsto 1/(2-z)$ has the double fixed point 1, now with $1/(2-z) \geq z$ for $z < 2$. Fix $\delta \in (0, \frac{1}{5}]$, put $\epsilon := \delta^3/16$, and take n_5 with $|A_n - 2|, |B_n - 1| \leq \epsilon$ for $n \geq n_5$. For $n \geq n_5$, $z_{n+1} < A_{n+1}$ gives $A_n - z_n > B_n/A_{n+1} \geq (1-\epsilon)/(2+\epsilon) > 0.49$; hence $z_n < 1.52$, $2 - z_n > 0.48$, and

$$\left| z_{n+1} - \frac{1}{2 - z_n} \right| \leq \frac{|B_n - 1|}{A_n - z_n} + \frac{|A_n - 2|}{(A_n - z_n)(2 - z_n)} \leq 7\epsilon.$$

If $z_m \geq 1 + \delta$ for some $m \geq n_5$, then $z_{m+1} \geq z_m + (z_m - 1)^2/(2 - z_m) - 7\epsilon \geq z_m + \delta^2 - 7\epsilon \geq z_m + \delta^2/2$, and inductively z would exceed 1.52; so $z_n < 1 + \delta$ for $n \geq n_5$. If $z_n \leq 1 - \delta$, then $z_{n+1} \geq z_n + \delta^2/2 - 7\epsilon \geq z_n + \delta^2/4$, so z enters $(1-\delta, 1+\delta)$ after finitely many steps; and if $z_n > 1 - \delta$, then $z_{n+1} \geq 1/(1+\delta) - 7\epsilon > 1 - \delta$, because $1/(1+\delta) - (1-\delta) = \delta^2/(1+\delta) > 7\epsilon$. Hence $z_n \to 1$. Then $a_n = u_n + l_n = u_n + (\tilde{a}_{n-1} - u_{n-1})$ and $b_n^2 = u_{n-1} l_n$ give $n^p a_n \to c + c = 2c$ and $n^{2p} b_n^2 \to c^2$.

4. From analytic to arbitrary slowly varying factors

A slowly varying sequence is "almost analytic". Gaussian smoothing in the logarithmic variable turns $\log \ell$ into an entire function Λ_ℓ whose derivatives tend to 0 in every horizontal strip, and which differs from $\log \ell$ by $o(1)$ at the integers (§4.1). The factor $\ell_1 := e^{\Lambda_\ell(\log \cdot)}$ is therefore covered by the Riemann–Hilbert analysis, and it remains to compare the measures with factors ℓ and ℓ_1. Their ratio $\psi := \ell/\ell_1$ tends to 1. A multiplicative perturbation that tends to 1 changes $\log b_n^2$ by at most the supremum of $|\log \psi|$ over the bulk of the spectral weights, which sit at indices $k \gtrsim n$ (§4.2). The only danger is the head $k < n/M_0$, where $|\log \psi|$ need not be small; there the spectral weights are exponentially small, because those atoms are saturated (§4.3).

One cannot instead compare directly with the pure power k^{-s}: ℓ may be unbounded and need not be close to 1 anywhere, and controlling $\log \ell(k) - \log \ell(n)$ against the spectral weights far beyond $k \asymp n$ would require information about the hard edge at the level of $1/n$ corrections. Comparing ℓ with its own smoothing avoids this.

§4.4 then assembles the proofs of Theorems 1 and 2, given Theorem 4 and Theorem 3 (proved in §3).

Throughout this section $p > 0$ and $s > 1$ are fixed, $x_k := k^{-p}$, and for a positive sequence $w = (w_k)$ with $\sum_k w_k < \infty$ we write $a_n(w)$, $b_n(w)$ for the Jacobi coefficients of $\sum_k w_k \delta_{x_k}$. With p_n the orthonormal polynomials (§2.1), the spectral weights are

$$q_n(k) := w_k^{1/2} p_n(x_k), \qquad m_n(k) := q_n(k)^2, \qquad K_n(k) := \sum_{j<n} m_j(k) = w_k \mathsf{K}_n(x_k).$$

Each m_n is a probability vector on $\mathbb{N}$ (orthonormality of p_n), $0 \le K_n(k) \le 1$ by (14), and $m_n = K_{n+1} - K_n$. For sequences f, g on $\mathbb{N}$ we write $\langle f, g\rangle := \sum_k f(k)g(k)$ whenever the sum converges absolutely, and x also denotes the sequence (x_k).

4.1. **Gaussian smoothing.** Recall the construction of Definition 1.2. For a slowly varying ℓ, $L_\ell : \mathbb{R} \to \mathbb{R}$ is the piecewise-linear interpolant of the points $(\log k, \log \ell(k))$, $k \ge 1$, extended by the constant $\log \ell(1)$ on $(-\infty, 0]$; $G(y) := e^{-y^2/2}/\sqrt{2\pi}$; and

$$\Lambda_\ell(\xi) := \int_{\mathbb{R}} L_\ell(y)\, G(\xi - y)\, \mathrm{d}y, \qquad \rho_\ell(m) := \sup_{k \ge m} \bigl|\log \ell(k) - \Lambda_\ell(\log k)\bigr|. \tag{23}$$

Here G is extended to an entire function. Recall also hypothesis (A_ϑ) from Definition 1.3: $\ell(k) = \exp \Lambda(\log k)$, where Λ is analytic on $S_\vartheta = \{\xi : \Re\xi \ge -c_0,\ |\Im\xi| \le \vartheta\}$ for some $c_0 > 0$, real on $S_\vartheta \cap \mathbb{R}$, bounded on $S_\vartheta \cap \{\Re\xi \le 0\}$, and $\varepsilon_\Lambda(T) = \sup\{|\Lambda'(\xi)| : \xi \in S_\vartheta,\ \Re\xi \ge T\} \to 0$.

Smoothing statements of this kind are familiar from the theory of regular variation; we include the short proof, which uses only the sequence form of slow variation.

Lemma 4.1 (Gaussian smoothing)**.** *Let ℓ be slowly varying and write $L = L_\ell$, $\Lambda = \Lambda_\ell$.*

(o) *For every $\eta > 0$, $|L(y)| \le A_\eta + \eta(|y| + \log 2)$ for all $y \in \mathbb{R}$, with A_η from Lemma 2.1(ii). The function Λ is entire and real on $\mathbb{R}$.*

(i) *$\Lambda(\log k) - \log \ell(k) \to 0$ as $k \to \infty$; that is, $\rho_\ell(m) \to 0$ as $m \to \infty$.*

(ii) *For every $\vartheta \ge 0$ and $j \ge 0$,*

$$\sup_{|\Im\xi| \le \vartheta} \bigl|\Lambda^{(j)}(\xi) - \delta_{j0}\Lambda(\Re\xi)\bigr| \longrightarrow 0 \qquad (\Re\xi \to +\infty),$$

and Λ is bounded on $\{\Re\xi \le 0,\ |\Im\xi| \le \vartheta\}$.

(iii) *Consequently Λ satisfies (A_ϑ) for every $\vartheta > 0$ (with any $c_0 > 0$). The sequence $\ell_1(k) := e^{\Lambda(\log k)}$ is positive, and $\psi := \ell/\ell_1$ satisfies $\sup_{k \ge m} |\log \psi(k)| = \rho_\ell(m) \to 0$.*

Proof. We prove (o), then (ii), from which (i) and (iii) follow.

(o). Let $y \ge 0$ and choose $k \ge 1$ with $y \in [\log k, \log(k+1)]$. Then $L(y)$ is a convex combination of $\log \ell(k)$ and $\log \ell(k+1)$, each of absolute value at most $A_\eta + \eta \log(k+1) \le A_\eta + \eta(y + \log 2)$ by Lemma 2.1(ii). For $y < 0$, $|L(y)| = |\log \ell(1)| \le A_\eta$. For $\xi = T + i\upsilon$ $(T, \upsilon \in \mathbb{R})$ and $y \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$|G(\xi - y)| = G(T - y)\, e^{\upsilon^2/2}. \tag{24}$$

Since L grows at most linearly, the integrand $L(y)G(\xi - y)$ is dominated, for ξ in any bounded set, by an integrable function of y; as it is entire in ξ for each y, Λ is entire, and its derivatives may be taken under the integral sign. Λ is real on $\mathbb{R}$ because L and G are.

Local oscillation of L. For $T \ge T_0 := 1 + \log 2$ put

$$\omega(T) := \sup\bigl\{|L(y) - L(y')| :\ y, y' \in [T-1, T+1]\bigr\}, \qquad \omega^*(T) := \sup_{T' \ge T} \omega(T').$$

Let $y \in [T-1, T+1]$ and $y \in [\log k, \log(k+1)]$. Then $k \ge e^{T-1} - 1 \ge e^{T-1}/2$ and $k+1 \le e^{T+1} + 1$. With $m := \lceil e^T \rceil$ and $\lambda := 2e^2$ we have $m/\lambda \le e^{T-2} \le e^{T-1}/2$ and $\lambda m \ge 2e^{T+2} \ge e^{T+1} + 1$, so $k, k+1 \in [m/\lambda, \lambda m]$. Hence $L(y)$ and $L(y')$ are convex combinations of values $\log \ell(k')$ with

$k' \in [m/\lambda, \lambda m]$, and $\omega(T) \le 2\,\mathrm{osc}_m(2e^2)$. Slow variation gives $\omega(T) \to 0$, so $\omega^*(T)$ is finite and $\omega^*(T) \to 0$ as $T \to \infty$.

Chaining. Let $T \ge 2T_0$. If $y \ge T$, join T to y by $\lfloor y-T \rfloor$ steps of length 1 and one shorter step; every step lies in an interval $[T'-1, T'+1]$ with $T' \ge T$, so $|L(y)-L(T)| \le \omega^*(T)(1+|y-T|)$. If $T/2 \le y < T$, the same argument started at $y \ge T_0$ gives $|L(y)-L(T)| \le \omega^*(T/2)(1+|y-T|)$. If $y < T/2$, then $|y| + T \le |y-T| + 2T \le 5|y-T|$, and (o) with $\eta = 1$ gives $|L(y) - L(T)| \le 2A_1 + 2\log 2 + |y| + T \le C_1(1 + |y-T|)$ with $C_1 := \max(2A_1 + 2, 5)$. In all cases

$$|L(y) - L(T)| \le \big(\omega^*(T/2)\,\mathbf{1}_{\{y \ge T/2\}} + C_1 \mathbf{1}_{\{y<T/2\}}\big)(1 + |y-T|). \tag{25}$$

(ii). The derivatives of G are $G^{(j)}(w) = \mathsf{h}_j(w)G(w)$ with polynomials h_j of degree j. Let $\bar{\mathsf{h}}_j$ be the polynomial whose coefficients are the absolute values of those of h_j; then $|\mathsf{h}_j(t+i\upsilon)| \le \bar{\mathsf{h}}_j(|t| + \vartheta)$ for $t \in \mathbb{R}$, $|\upsilon| \le \vartheta$. The function $\xi \mapsto \int_{\mathbb{R}} G(\xi - y)\,\mathrm{d}y$ is entire and equals 1 on $\mathbb{R}$, hence everywhere; therefore $\int_{\mathbb{R}} G^{(j)}(\xi - y)\,\mathrm{d}y = \delta_{j0}$ for all $\xi \in \mathbb{C}$. For $\xi = T + i\upsilon$ with $|\upsilon| \le \vartheta$ and $T \ge 2T_0$, this, (24), (25) and the substitution $t = T - y$ give

$$\begin{aligned} \big|\Lambda^{(j)}(\xi) - \delta_{j0}L(T)\big| &= \Big|\int_{\mathbb{R}} \big(L(y) - L(T)\big)G^{(j)}(\xi - y)\,\mathrm{d}y\Big| \\ &\le e^{\vartheta^2/2}\Big[\omega^*(T/2)\int_{\mathbb{R}} \mathsf{g}_j(t)\,\mathrm{d}t + C_1 \int_{|t|>T/2} \mathsf{g}_j(t)\,\mathrm{d}t\Big], \end{aligned}$$

where $\mathsf{g}_j(t) := \bar{\mathsf{h}}_j(|t| + \vartheta)(1 + |t|)G(t)$ is integrable. The right side tends to 0 as $T \to \infty$, uniformly in $|\upsilon| \le \vartheta$. For $j = 0$, applying this at ξ and at $T = \Re\xi$ and subtracting gives $\sup_{|\Im\xi| \le \vartheta} |\Lambda(\xi) - \Lambda(\Re\xi)| \to 0$. For $j \ge 1$ it gives $\Lambda^{(j)} \to 0$ uniformly in the strip.

For the bound on $\Re\xi \le 0$, note that $L(y) - L(0) = 0$ for $y \le 0$ and $|L(y) - L(0)| \le 2A_1 + 2\log 2 + y$ for $y > 0$. If $T = \Re\xi \le 0$ and $y > 0$, then $|T - y| \ge y$, so $G(T - y) \le G(y)$. Hence $|\Lambda(\xi) - L(0)| \le e^{\vartheta^2/2} \int_0^\infty (2A_1 + 2 + y)G(y)\,\mathrm{d}y$ for $|\Im\xi| \le \vartheta$.

(i). Since $L(\log k) = \log \ell(k)$, the case $j = 0$, $\Im\xi = 0$ of the estimate in (ii) gives $\Lambda(\log k) - \log \ell(k) \to 0$.

(iii). Λ is entire, real on $\mathbb{R}$, bounded on $\{-c_0 \le \Re\xi \le 0, |\Im\xi| \le \vartheta\}$ by (ii), and $\varepsilon_\Lambda(T) \to 0$ by (ii) with $j = 1$. So (A_ϑ) holds. Finally $\log \psi(k) = \log \ell(k) - \Lambda(\log k)$, so $\sup_{k \ge m} |\log \psi(k)| = \rho_\ell(m)$, which tends to 0 by (i). □

4.2. **First variation.** The comparison of ℓ and ℓ_1 runs along the path $w^{(\tau)} := w^{(0)}\psi^\tau$, $\tau \in [0,1]$. The next lemma computes the derivatives of the Jacobi coefficients along such a path. It is classical in substance (for $f = x$ it is the Toda flow); we give the short proof.

Lemma 4.2 (First variation)**.** *Let $x_k \in (0,1]$ be distinct, $v_k > 0$ with $\sum_k v_k < \infty$, and let $f : \mathbb{N} \to \mathbb{R}$ be bounded. For $\tau \in \mathbb{R}$ put $w_k^{(\tau)} := v_k e^{\tau f(k)}$, and let a_n, b_n, q_n, m_n denote the quantities of $w^{(\tau)}$. Then $\tau \mapsto a_n$ $(n \ge 0)$ and $\tau \mapsto \log b_n^2$ $(n \ge 1)$ are C^1 on $\mathbb{R}$, and*

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}\tau} \log b_n^2 = \langle f, m_n - m_{n-1}\rangle, \tag{26}$$

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}\tau} a_n = \langle (x - a_n)f, m_n\rangle - 2b_n\langle f, q_{n-1}q_n\rangle. \tag{27}$$

Proof. Write $\sigma_\tau := \sum_k w_k^{(\tau)}\delta_{x_k}$ and $\|f\|_\infty := \sup_k |f(k)|$.

Smoothness. The moments $\int x^i\,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau = \sum_k v_k e^{\tau f(k)} x_k^i$ are C^∞ in τ, with derivatives computed term by term: the r-th termwise derivative is bounded by $v_k \|f\|_\infty^r e^{|\tau|\|f\|_\infty}$, which is summable uniformly for τ in compact sets. The coefficients of P_n solve the linear system $\int P_n x^i\,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau = 0$ $(i < n)$, whose determinant is the Hankel determinant $D_n(\sigma_\tau) > 0$; by Cramer's rule they are

C^∞ in τ. So are $h_n = \int P_n^2 \,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau > 0$, $p_n = P_n/\sqrt{h_n}$, a_n and $b_n^2 = h_n/h_{n-1}$. Moreover, if $g(x;\tau)$ is a polynomial in x whose coefficients are C^1 in τ, then

$$\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}\tau}\int g\,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau = \int \partial_\tau g\,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau + \sum_k f(k) w_k^{(\tau)} g(x_k;\tau), \tag{28}$$

since $\int g\,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau$ is a finite linear combination of moments.

The b-formula. Apply (28) to $g = P_n^2$. Since P_n is monic, $\partial_\tau P_n$ has degree less than n and is orthogonal to P_n. Hence $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}\tau} h_n = \sum_k f(k) w_k^{(\tau)} P_n(x_k)^2 = h_n \langle f, m_n\rangle$, i.e. $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}\tau}\log h_n = \langle f, m_n\rangle$. Since $\log b_n^2 = \log h_n - \log h_{n-1}$, this is (26).

The a-formula. Write $\dot p_n := \partial_\tau p_n$, a polynomial of degree at most n, and expand $\dot p_n = \sum_{j\le n} \varpi_j p_j$ with $\varpi_j = \int \dot p_n p_j \,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau$. Differentiating $\int p_n p_j \,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau = \delta_{nj}$ with (28) gives $\int \dot p_n p_j \,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau + \int p_n \dot p_j \,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau + \langle f, q_n q_j\rangle = 0$. For $j < n$ the middle term vanishes ($\deg \dot p_j \le j < n$), so $\varpi_j = -\langle f, q_n q_j\rangle$; for $j = n$ we get $\varpi_n = -\frac12\langle f, m_n\rangle$. Now $a_n = \int x p_n^2 \,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau$ by (12), and by (28) and (12),

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\mathrm{d}a_n}{\mathrm{d}\tau} &= 2\int x p_n \dot p_n \,\mathrm{d}\sigma_\tau + \langle xf, m_n\rangle = 2\varpi_n a_n + 2\varpi_{n-1} b_n + \langle xf, m_n\rangle \\ &= -a_n\langle f, m_n\rangle - 2b_n\langle f, q_{n-1}q_n\rangle + \langle xf, m_n\rangle,\end{aligned}$$

which is (27). (For $n = 0$ the term with ϖ_{n-1} is absent, consistent with $b_0 = 0$.) All the sums converge absolutely, since f and x are bounded, m_n is a probability vector and $|q_{n-1}q_n| \le \frac12(m_{n-1} + m_n)$. □

4.3. **The head is saturated; stability under $\ell/\ell_1 \to 1$.** For $p > 0$ and $0 < \theta < 1$ let

$$g_p(\theta) := (p-\theta)\log\frac{1}{\theta} + (1-\theta)\log(1-\theta) - p + (p-1)\theta, \qquad g_p^+ := \begin{cases} g_p, & p \ge 1, \\ g_p - \log\frac{1}{p}, & 0 < p < 1. \end{cases} \tag{29}$$

For $\theta < p/2$ the first term is at least $\frac{p}{2}\log\frac{1}{\theta}$, and the other terms are bounded; so $g_p^+(\theta) \to +\infty$ as $\theta \to 0^+$. Hence there is $\theta_1 > 0$ with $g_p^+ \ge 1$ on $(0, \theta_1]$. We fix the *head margin* $M_0 = M_0(p)$ used in Theorem 1: it is the least integer $M_0 \ge 4$ such that $g_p^+ \ge 1$ on $(0, 2/M_0]$.

The next lemma says that the atoms x_k with k much smaller than n are almost fully occupied by the first n orthonormal polynomials. Its proof combines Christoffel's extremal property with a Lagrange test polynomial.

Lemma 4.3 (Saturation of the head)**.** *Let $w_k > 0$ with $W := \sum_k w_k < \infty$, and consider $\sum_k w_k \delta_{k^{-p}}$. For integers $1 \le k < n$ and $\theta := k/n$,*

$$1 - K_n(k) \le \frac{W}{w_k}\Big(\frac{n+1}{k}\Big)^{2(1-p)_+} e^{-2ng_p^+(\theta)}.$$

Moreover $m_n(k) \le 1 - K_n(k)$ for all k and n.

Proof. The last statement holds because $m_n(k) = K_{n+1}(k) - K_n(k)$ and $K_{n+1}(k) \le 1$. For the main bound we use the test polynomial

$$P(x) := \prod_{j\le n,\, j\ne k} \frac{x - x_j}{x_k - x_j},$$

which has degree $n-1$, satisfies $P(x_k) = 1$, and vanishes at x_j for $j \le n$, $j \ne k$. For $i > n$ and $j \le n$ we have $0 < x_i < x_j$, so $|x_i - x_j| \le x_j$ and $|P(x_i)| \le \Pi := \prod_{j\le n,\, j\ne k} x_j/|x_k - x_j|$.

Therefore $\int P^2\,\mathrm{d}\sigma \le w_k + W\Pi^2$, and (13) gives $1/\mathsf{K}_n(x_k) \le w_k + W\Pi^2$. Hence $K_n(k) = w_k\mathsf{K}_n(x_k) \ge w_k/(w_k + W\Pi^2)$ and

$$1 - K_n(k) \le \frac{W\Pi^2}{w_k + W\Pi^2} \le \frac{W}{w_k}\Pi^2.$$

It remains to bound Π. Here $x_j/|x_k - x_j| = k^p/|k^p - j^p|$. Put $c_p := \min(1,p)$. We claim $|k^p - j^p| \ge c_p \max(j,k)^{p-1}|k-j|$. For $p \ge 1$ and $j < k$: $k^p - j^p = k^{p-1}k - j^{p-1}j \ge k^{p-1}(k-j)$; for $p \ge 1$ and $j > k$ the same computation gives $j^p - k^p \ge j^{p-1}(j-k)$. For $p < 1$ the mean value theorem gives $|k^p - j^p| = p\xi^{p-1}|k-j|$ with ξ between j and k, and $\xi^{p-1} \ge \max(j,k)^{p-1}$. Hence

$$\Pi \le c_p^{-(n-1)} \prod_{j<k} \frac{k}{k-j} \prod_{j=k+1}^{n} \frac{k^p}{j^{p-1}(j-k)} = c_p^{-(n-1)}\,\frac{k^{k-1}}{(k-1)!}\cdot\frac{k^{p(n-k)}\,(n!/k!)^{1-p}}{(n-k)!}.$$

We bound the three factors. First, $k^{k-1}/(k-1)! = k^k/k! \le e^k$. Second, $\log(n-k)! \ge (n-k)\log(n-k) - (n-k)$. Third, $S := \log(n!/k!) = \sum_{j=k+1}^{n} \log j$ satisfies

$$I_{k,n} := \int_k^n \log t\,\mathrm{d}t \le S \le I_{k,n} + \log\frac{n+1}{k},$$

because log is increasing ($\log j \ge \int_{j-1}^{j} \log$ and $\log j \le \int_j^{j+1} \log$). We use the lower bound if $p \ge 1$ (then $1-p \le 0$) and the upper bound if $p < 1$; in both cases $(1-p)S \le (1-p)I_{k,n} + (1-p)_+ \log\frac{n+1}{k}$. With $I_{k,n} = n\log n - n - k\log k + k$ and $k = \theta n$, the terms in $\log n$ cancel and

$$k + p(n-k)\log k + (1-p)I_{k,n} - (n-k)\log(n-k) + (n-k) = -n\,g_p(\theta),$$

as a direct expansion shows. (The coefficient of $n\log n$ is $p(1-\theta)+(1-p)(1-\theta)-(1-\theta) = 0$.) Hence

$$\log\Pi \le -n\,g_p(\theta) + (n-1)\log\frac{1}{c_p} + (1-p)_+\log\frac{n+1}{k}.$$

For $p \ge 1$, $c_p = 1$ and squaring gives the claim. For $p < 1$, $c_p = p$ and $(n-1)\log\frac{1}{p} \le n\log\frac{1}{p}$, so $\Pi^2 \le e^{-2n(g_p(\theta) - \log(1/p))}((n+1)/k)^{2(1-p)}$, which is the claim with g_p^+. □

We now fix the setting of the comparison. Let ℓ be slowly varying, let Λ_ℓ, ℓ_1, $\psi = \ell/\ell_1$ be as in Lemma 4.1, and put

$$\bar\rho := \sup_k |\log\psi(k)| = \rho_\ell(1) < \infty, \qquad w_k^{(\tau)} := k^{-s}\ell_1(k)\psi(k)^\tau \quad (\tau \in [0,1]).$$

So $w^{(0)}$ is the weight of σ_{p,s,ℓ_1} and $w^{(1)}$ that of $\sigma_{p,s,\ell}$. Since $\ell_1\psi^\tau = \ell\psi^{\tau-1}$, we have $e^{-\bar\rho}\ell(k) \le \ell_1(k)\psi(k)^\tau \le e^{\bar\rho}\ell(k)$, so every $w^{(\tau)}$ has finite total mass. Let $\mathcal{H}_n := \{k \in \mathbb{N} : k < n/M_0\}$ be the head, and let

$$\mathfrak{h}_n := \sup_{\tau\in[0,1]} \max_{m\in\{n-1,n\}} \sum_{k\in\mathcal{H}_n} m_m^{(\tau)}(k)$$

be the largest head mass of the spectral weights $m_{n-1}^{(\tau)}$, $m_n^{(\tau)}$ of $w^{(\tau)}$.

Lemma 4.4 (A priori size)**.** *In this setting there are constants C and n_0, depending on p, s, ℓ, such that for all $n \ge 2$*

$$\mathfrak{h}_n \le Cn^{s+5}e^{-2n}, \tag{30}$$

and for all $n \ge n_0$ and $\tau \in [0,1]$,

$$a_n(w^{(\tau)}) \le 2M_0^p n^{-p}, \qquad b_n(w^{(\tau)}) \le 2M_0^p n^{-p}.$$

Proof. Head. Let $W^{(\tau)} := \sum_k w_k^{(\tau)}$. By Lemma 2.1(ii) with $\eta = 1$, $W^{(\tau)} \le e^{\bar\rho} \sum_j j^{-s}\ell(j) =: e^{\bar\rho} W_\ell < \infty$ and $w_k^{(\tau)} \ge e^{-\bar\rho} k^{-s}\ell(k) \ge e^{-\bar\rho - A_1} k^{-s-1}$, so $W^{(\tau)}/w_k^{(\tau)} \le C' k^{s+1}$ with $C' := e^{2\bar\rho + A_1} W_\ell$. Let $n \ge 2$, $m \in \{n-1, n\}$ and $k \in \mathcal{H}_n$. Then $k < n/4 < m$, and $k/m \le n/(M_0(n-1)) \le 2/M_0$, so $g_p^+(k/m) \ge 1$. Lemma 4.3, with $(m+1)/k \le n+1$ and $2(1-p)_+ \le 2$, gives

$$m_m^{(\tau)}(k) \le 1 - K_m^{(\tau)}(k) \le C' k^{s+1} (n+1)^2 e^{-2(n-1)}.$$

Summing over the fewer than n points of $\mathcal{H}_n$ gives (30).

Size. By (12), $a_m = \langle x, m_m\rangle$ and $b_n = \langle x q_{n-1}, q_n\rangle \le \frac12 \langle x, m_{n-1} + m_n\rangle$, since $x \ge 0$ and $|q_{n-1}q_n| \le \frac12(m_{n-1} + m_n)$. For $k \notin \mathcal{H}_n$ we have $x_k = k^{-p} \le (M_0/n)^p$, and $x_k \le 1$ always. Hence, for $m \in \{n-1, n\}$, $\langle x, m_m^{(\tau)}\rangle \le (M_0/n)^p + \mathfrak{h}_n$, and both a_n and b_n are at most $(M_0/n)^p + \mathfrak{h}_n$. By (30), $\mathfrak{h}_n \le (M_0/n)^p$ for $n \ge n_0$. □

Proposition 4.5 (Stability under $\ell/\ell_1 \to 1$)**.** *Let $p > 0$, $s > 1$, let ℓ be slowly varying, and let $\ell_1 := e^{\Lambda_\ell(\log\cdot)}$. There are constants C and n_0, depending on p, s, ℓ, such that for $n \ge n_0$*

$$\begin{aligned} \big|\log b_n^2(\sigma_{p,s,\ell}) - \log b_n^2(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1})\big| &\le 2\rho_\ell(\lceil n/M_0\rceil) + C n^{s+5} e^{-2n}, \\ n^p \big|a_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell}) - a_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1})\big| &\le 6M_0^p\, \rho_\ell(\lceil n/M_0\rceil) + C n^{p+s+5} e^{-2n}. \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Apply Lemma 4.2 with $v_k = k^{-s}\ell_1(k)$ and $f = \log\psi$, which is bounded by $\bar\rho$; then $w^{(\tau)}$ is the path defined above. Write $\rho := \rho_\ell(\lceil n/M_0\rceil)$. For $k \notin \mathcal{H}_n$ we have $k \ge \lceil n/M_0\rceil$, so $|f(k)| \le \rho$; for $k \in \mathcal{H}_n$, $|f(k)| \le \bar\rho$.

The b-part. By (26) and the fundamental theorem of calculus,

$$\big|\log b_n^2(w^{(1)}) - \log b_n^2(w^{(0)})\big| \le \sup_{\tau\in[0,1]} \sum_k |f(k)| \big(m_n^{(\tau)}(k) + m_{n-1}^{(\tau)}(k)\big) \le 2\rho + 2\bar\rho\mathfrak{h}_n,$$

because $m_n^{(\tau)}$ and $m_{n-1}^{(\tau)}$ are probability vectors. Lemma 4.4 bounds $\mathfrak{h}_n$.

The a-part. By (27) and $2|q_{n-1}q_n| \le m_{n-1} + m_n$,

$$\Big|\frac{\mathrm{d}a_n}{\mathrm{d}\tau}\Big| \le \sum_k |f(k)| \Big(|x_k - a_n|\, m_n(k) + b_n \big(m_{n-1}(k) + m_n(k)\big)\Big).$$

Let $n \ge n_0$, where n_0 is as in Lemma 4.4, enlarged so that $2M_0^p n_0^{-p} \le 1$. For $k \notin \mathcal{H}_n$, $0 \le x_k \le (M_0/n)^p$ and $0 \le a_n \le 2M_0^p n^{-p}$, so $|x_k - a_n| \le 2M_0^p n^{-p}$; also $b_n \le 2M_0^p n^{-p}$. These k contribute at most $\rho\big(2M_0^p n^{-p} + 2\cdot 2M_0^p n^{-p}\big) = 6M_0^p \rho\, n^{-p}$. For $k \in \mathcal{H}_n$ use $|x_k - a_n| \le 1$ and $b_n \le 1$; these contribute at most $3\bar\rho\mathfrak{h}_n$. Integrating over $\tau \in [0,1]$ and multiplying by n^p gives the second bound, again with Lemma 4.4. □

The proof uses the slow variation of ℓ only through the Potter bounds and through $\rho_\ell \to 0$; it uses nothing about the hard edge, and it holds for every $p > 0$ and $s > 1$.

4.4. **Proofs of Theorems 1 and 2, assuming Theorem 4.** We recall Theorem 4, which is proved in Sections 5–8.

Theorem 4 (restated). *Let $p > 0$ and $1 < s < 1 + 2p$, i.e. $\alpha := (s - 1 - p)/p \in (-1, 1)$. Let ℓ_1 satisfy $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$. Then σ_{p,s,ℓ_1} satisfies $n^p b_n = c(p)(1 + O(1/n))$ and $a_n/(2b_n) = 1 + O(1/n)$.*

For a sequence of measures with Jacobi coefficients a_n, b_n and a constant $c > 0$, the two forms of the rate statement are equivalent:

$$\Big\{ n^p b_n = c\big(1 + O(1/n)\big),\quad \frac{a_n}{2b_n} = 1 + O(1/n)\Big\} \iff |n^p a_n - 2c| + |n^p b_n - c| = O(1/n). \tag{31}$$

Indeed, from the left side, $n^p a_n = 2n^p b_n \cdot a_n/(2b_n) = 2c(1+O(1/n))^2$; from the right side, $n^p b_n = c + O(1/n)$ and $a_n/(2b_n) = (2c+O(1/n))/(2c+O(1/n))$. We write $c = c(p)$.

Step 1: analytic factors, every $s > 1$. Let ℓ_1 satisfy $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$ and let $s > 1$. We claim

$$|n^p a_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1}) - 2c| + |n^p b_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1}) - c| = O(1/n). \tag{32}$$

Let $m \geq 0$ be the least integer with $s_0 := s - mp < 1 + 2p$. If $m = 0$ then $s_0 = s > 1$; if $m \geq 1$ then $s - (m-1)p \geq 1 + 2p$, so $s_0 \geq 1 + p$. In both cases $s_0 \in (1, 1+2p)$. Theorem 4 at s_0 and (31) give (32) for σ_{p,s_0,ℓ_1}. By (19), $\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1} = x^m \sigma_{p,s_0,\ell_1}$, and each $x^j \sigma_{p,s_0,\ell_1} = \sigma_{p,s_0+jp,\ell_1}$ is a positive measure on $(0,1]$ with infinite support and finite moments. Theorem 3, applied m times with the regular rate $\eta_n = 1/n$, gives (32) for σ_{p,s,ℓ_1}.

Step 2: Theorem 1(iii). If ℓ itself satisfies $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$, Step 1 with $\ell_1 = \ell$ and (31) give $n^p b_n = c(1+O(1/n))$ and $a_n/(2b_n) = 1 + O(1/n)$.

Step 3: Theorem 2. The constant sequence $\ell \equiv 1$ is $e^{\Lambda(\log k)}$ with $\Lambda \equiv 0$, which satisfies (A_ϑ) for every ϑ (with $\varepsilon_\Lambda \equiv 0$). Step 2 applies.

Step 4: Theorem 1(ii). Let ℓ be slowly varying and $\ell_1 := e^{\Lambda_\ell(\log \cdot)}$. By Lemma 4.1(iii), Λ_ℓ satisfies $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$, so Step 1 gives (32) for σ_{p,s,ℓ_1}. Write $\rho := \rho_\ell(\lceil n/M_0 \rceil)$ and $\Delta_n := \log b_n^2(\sigma_{p,s,\ell}) - \log b_n^2(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1})$. By Proposition 4.5, $|\Delta_n| \leq 2\rho + Cn^{s+5}e^{-2n}$ for $n \geq n_0$; in particular $|\Delta_n|$ is bounded, since $\rho \leq \rho_\ell(1)$. Hence $|e^{\Delta_n/2} - 1| \leq C'|\Delta_n|$ and

$$|n^p b_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell}) - c| \leq |n^p b_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1}) - c| + n^p b_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1})\,|e^{\Delta_n/2} - 1| = O(1/n) + O(\rho) + O(n^{s+5}e^{-2n}).$$

Similarly, by the second bound of Proposition 4.5, $|n^p a_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell}) - 2c| \leq |n^p a_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1}) - 2c| + 6M_0^p \rho + Cn^{p+s+5}e^{-2n}$. The exponentially small terms are $O(1/n)$, and finitely many n only affect the constant. This is

$$|n^p b_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell}) - c| + |n^p a_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell}) - 2c| = O\big(1/n + \rho_\ell(\lceil n/M_0 \rceil)\big).$$

Step 5: Theorem 1(i) follows from (ii), because $\rho_\ell(m) \to 0$ by Lemma 4.1(i). □

On the order of the steps. The smoothing is applied last, at the final exponent s, after the shift. This is possible because Proposition 4.5 holds for every $p > 0$ and every $s > 1$, while Theorem 3 is applied only to the analytic factor ℓ_1, with the rate $1/n$ that Theorem 4 provides. Each step therefore uses its input exactly in the range where it is proved: Theorem 4 only for $s_0 \in (1, 1+2p)$; Theorem 3 for positive measures on $[0,\infty)$ with infinite support; Lemma 4.1 for $\vartheta = \vartheta_p$; and Proposition 4.5 at s. Smoothing first and shifting afterwards would also work, but the shift would then have to carry the rate $1/n + \rho_\ell(\lceil n/M_0 \rceil)$, which is in general not regular and must be replaced by a regular majorant (Remark 2.4); the order chosen here avoids this and gives the rate of Theorem 1(ii) directly.

Remark 4.6 (Which part of Theorem 4 is used). Any half-open s-window of length p inside $(1, 1+2p)$ can serve as the base in Step 1. For $s > 1 + p/2$ one may take s_0 to be the unique point of $s - p\mathbb{N}_0$ in $(1 + p/2, 1 + 3p/2]$, so that $\alpha = (s_0 - 1 - p)/p \in (-\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}]$. Thus for every $s > 1 + p/2$ only the case $|\alpha| \leq \frac{1}{2}$ of Theorem 4 is used, and the range $\frac{1}{2} < |\alpha| < 1$ is needed only for $1 < s \leq 1 + p/2$, where no shift takes place. The case $\alpha = 0$ cannot be avoided: for $s \in 1 + p + p\mathbb{N}_0$ every admissible base point has $s_0 \in 1 + p\mathbb{Z}$, i.e. $\alpha \in \mathbb{Z} \cap (-1, 1) = \{0\}$.

5. The Riemann–Hilbert problem and the common frame

This section and the next prove the part of Theorem 4 that does not concern the hard edge. We encode the discrete measure by a meromorphic interpolation problem of Fokas–Its–Kitaev type, rescale it by n^p, and normalise it with the g-function of the equilibrium measure μ^* of Paper 1. After rescaling, the nodes fill $(0, n^p]$. On the band $(0, 4c)$ the orthogonal polynomials

oscillate; on the saturated region $(4c, n^p)$ the nodes are as dense as the equilibrium measure allows, and the problem is close to a pure interpolation problem; near 0 the band meets infinitely many nodes, and 0 is a hard edge. The frame is that of Wu, Lin, Xu and Zhao for the Tricomi–Carlitz polynomials (T1), written in the one-sided variable x.

Almost every step is the same for all $p > 0$. The only geometry-dependent ingredient is a scalar function F, the *outer scalar*, which removes the Gamma-function growth of the node masses away from the hard edge. We list in §5.9 the five properties of F that the analysis uses, and we construct F in §6 separately for $p > 1$, $p = 1$ and $0 < p < 1$. Table 1 at the end of this section collects everything that depends on the geometry.

5.1. **Standing assumptions.** Throughout §§5–6 and Appendix C we fix $p > 0$ and $1 < s < 1 + 2p$, and we put

$$\alpha := \frac{s - 1 - p}{p} \in (-1, 1). \tag{33}$$

We fix $\ell_1(t) = e^{\Lambda(\log t)}$ satisfying $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$, with the strip half-width $\vartheta_p = \pi/p$ for $p > 1$ and $\vartheta_p = \pi/2$ for $0 < p \le 1$, and with the constant $c_0 > 0$ of that hypothesis. We write $\sigma := \sigma_{p,s,\ell_1} = \sum_{k\ge1} w_k \delta_{x_k}$, with $x_k = k^{-p}$ and $w_k = k^{-s}\ell_1(k)$, and $c = c(p)$, $\gamma_p = \log c + p$. The degree n is large, $n \ge n_0$, where n_0 may increase from line to line. Constants $C, c', \dots$ (never the letter c, which is $c(p)$) depend only on p, s, ℓ_1 and the contour parameters fixed in §5.6; they do not depend on n unless they carry the subscript n. We put

$$\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}} := \begin{cases} 7\pi/16, & p \ge 1, \\ 3\pi p/8, & 0 < p < 1, \end{cases} \qquad \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} := \begin{cases} \pi/3, & p \ge 1, \\ \pi p/4, & 0 < p < 1, \end{cases} \tag{34}$$

so that $0 < \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}$ and $\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}/p < \vartheta_p$ in all three cases ($\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}/p = 7\pi/(16p) < \pi/p$ for $p > 1$, $\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}} = 7\pi/16 < \pi/2$ for $p = 1$, and $\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}/p = 3\pi/8 < \pi/2$ for $p < 1$); moreover $\frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}$, and for $p < 1$, $\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}} < \pi p/2$. The angle ϑ_{w} bounds the arguments at which the weight is ever evaluated (Lemma 5.5); ϑ_{lip} is the angle at which the lens leaves the hard edge.

5.2. **The interpolation problem.** Let P_n be the monic orthogonal polynomials of σ and $h_n = \int P_n^2 \, \mathrm{d}\sigma$. For a 2×2 matrix function X with an expansion $X(z) = I + X_1/z + X_2/z^2 + O(z^{-3})$ at ∞ we write

$$\mathsf{a}(X) := \frac{(X_2)_{12}}{(X_1)_{12}} - (X_1)_{22} \qquad (\text{when } (X_1)_{12} \ne 0). \tag{35}$$

Lemma 5.1 (The interpolation problem)**.** *Let Y be the matrix (16) of T1(a), built from the monic orthogonal polynomials P_n, P_{n-1} of σ and $h_{n-1} = \int P_{n-1}^2 \, \mathrm{d}\sigma$. Then $\det Y \equiv 1$. The rescaled matrix*

$$U(z) := n^{pn\sigma_3} \, Y(z n^{-p}) \tag{36}$$

is analytic off $\{X_k\}_{k\ge1} \cup \{0\}$, where

$$X_k := n^p x_k = (n/k)^p \quad (k \ge 1), \qquad X_1 = n^p \ \textit{(the top node)}; \tag{37}$$

it has simple poles at the X_k in its second column only, with $\operatorname{Res}_{z=X_k} U_{j2} = n^p w_k \, U_{j1}(X_k)$ $(j = 1, 2)$; and $U(z) z^{-n\sigma_3} = I + U_1/z + U_2/z^2 + \dots$ for $|z| > n^p$, with

$$(U_1)_{12}(U_1)_{21} = n^{2p} b_n^2, \qquad \mathsf{a}(U z^{-n\sigma_3}) = n^p a_n. \tag{38}$$

Proof. For the determinant, write $h_{n-1}\det Y$ as

$$\int \frac{P_n(z)P_{n-1}(x)-P_{n-1}(z)P_n(x)}{z-x}\,\mathrm{d}\sigma(x) = \int \frac{P_n(z)-P_n(x)}{z-x}P_{n-1}(x)\,\mathrm{d}\sigma(x) - \int \frac{P_{n-1}(z)-P_{n-1}(x)}{z-x}P_n(x)\,\mathrm{d}\sigma(x).$$

The first difference quotient is a polynomial in x of degree $n-1$ with leading coefficient 1, so the first integral is h_{n-1}; the second has degree $n-2$ in x, so the second integral vanishes. Hence $\det Y \equiv 1$. The statements for U follow from those of T1(a) by the substitution $z = n^p\zeta$: the residue picks up the factor n^p from $\mathrm{d}z = n^p\,\mathrm{d}\zeta$, and $U_j = n^{jp}\,n^{pn\sigma_3}Y_j n^{-pn\sigma_3}$ $(j=1,2)$. The conjugation multiplies the $(1,2)$ entries by n^{2pn} and the $(2,1)$ entries by n^{-2pn}; this cancels in the product and in the ratio in (35), and (17) gives (38). □

We never use that Y is the *unique* solution of an interpolation problem: every object below is built from Y, and only its explicit properties are used. In particular no existence theorem for a Riemann–Hilbert problem is needed.

5.3. **The index function and the band weight.** The node set $\{X_k\}$ is the set of points where the *index function*

$$t(z) := nz^{-1/p} \qquad (z\in\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty,0],\ \text{principal power}) \tag{39}$$

takes positive integer values: $t(X_k)=k$. We put

$$\theta(z) := \pi t(z), \qquad \Pi(z) := \frac{\sin\theta(z)}{\theta'(z)}, \qquad \theta'(z) = -\frac{\pi}{p}\frac{t(z)}{z}, \tag{40}$$

so that Π has simple zeros at the nodes. On $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty,0]$ we have $\arg t = -\arg z/p$, hence

$$\pm\operatorname{Im}\theta(z) < 0 \quad \text{for } 0<\pm\arg z<\min(\pi,\pi p), \qquad |e^{\mp 2i\theta(z)}| = \exp\bigl(-2\pi n|z|^{-1/p}\sin(|\arg z|/p)\bigr). \tag{41}$$

The weight enters through the log variable $\xi := \log t = \log n - (\operatorname{Log} z)/p$. Let

$$\mathcal{Z}_n := \{z:\ 0<|z|<e^{pc_0}n^p,\ |\arg z|<\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}\}. \tag{42}$$

For $z\in\mathcal{Z}_n$ we have $|\operatorname{Im}\xi| < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}/p < \vartheta_p$ and $\operatorname{Re}\xi > -c_0$, so $\xi\in S_{\vartheta_p}$ and the *residue weight* and the *slowly varying factor*

$$w(z) := n^p\,t(z)^{-s}\,\ell_1(t(z)), \qquad r_n(z) := \frac{\ell_1(t(z))}{\ell_1(n)} = e^{\Lambda(\xi)-\Lambda(\log n)} \tag{43}$$

are analytic on $\mathcal{Z}_n$. By Lemma 5.1, $\operatorname{Res}_{X_k} U_{j2} = w(X_k)U_{j1}(X_k)$. The combination that appears in all jumps is

$$W(z) := 2i\theta'(z)w(z) \qquad (z\in\mathcal{Z}_n). \tag{44}$$

Lemma 5.2 (Band weight)**.** *On $\mathcal{Z}_n$,*

$$W(z) = C_n'\,z^{\alpha}\,r_n(z), \qquad C_n' := -\frac{2\pi i}{p}\,n^{1+p-s}\ell_1(n), \tag{45}$$

with the principal power. In particular $|W(x)| = \frac{2\pi}{p}n^{1+p-s}\ell_1(n)\,x^{\alpha}r_n(x)$ and $\arg W(x) = -\pi/2$ for $x\in(0,e^{pc_0}n^p)$, where $r_n(x)>0$. The weight has a hard edge at 0 with Bessel order α, and $\alpha>-1$ if and only if $s>1$.

Proof. By (40), $2i\theta' w = -\frac{2\pi i}{p}\frac{t}{z}n^p t^{-s}\ell_1(t)$, and $t^{1-s} = n^{1-s}z^{(s-1)/p}$. The exponent of z is $(s-1)/p-1=\alpha$. Finally $\ell_1(t)=\ell_1(n)r_n$, and $r_n>0$ on $(0,\infty)$ because Λ is real on the real axis. □

5.4. **The g-function.** We use the equilibrium measure of Paper 1 exactly as quoted in Proposition 2.5: $\mu^* = \int_0^1 \omega_{\beta_\tau}\,\mathrm{d}\tau$ with $\beta_\tau := 4c\tau^{-p}$ and ω_β the arcsine law on $[0,\beta]$; its density ψ^* satisfies $\psi^* = \lambda_p$ on $[4c,\infty)$ and $0 < \psi^* < \lambda_p$ on $(0,4c)$, where $\lambda_p(x) = \frac{1}{p}x^{-1-1/p}$ is the node density; and $U^*(x) = \int \log|x-y|\,\mathrm{d}\mu^*(y)$ equals γ_p on $(0,4c]$. Note $\int_x^\infty \lambda_p = x^{-1/p} = t(x)/n$. Put

$$g(z) := \int \log(z-y)\,\mathrm{d}\mu^*(y) \quad (z \in \mathbb{C}\setminus\mathbb{R}), \qquad \varphi := \gamma_p - g, \qquad \tilde\varphi := \varphi \pm \frac{i\theta}{n} \ \text{ in } \mathbb{C}_\pm, \tag{46}$$

with principal logarithms. Nothing here depends on ℓ_1: the external field of the weight is $\frac{1}{n}\log w = O(\frac{\log n}{n})$ on the contour (Lemma 5.6) and is not put into g.

Lemma 5.3 (g-function)**.** (i) *g has continuous boundary values $g_\pm$ on $\mathbb{R}\setminus\{0\}$, $g_+ - g_- = 2\pi i$ on $(-\infty,0)$ and $g_+ - g_- = 2\pi i\mu^*((x,\infty))$ on $(0,\infty)$. In particular $\varphi_+ + \varphi_- = 0$ on $(0,4c)$, and $\tilde\varphi$ has no jump on $(4c,\infty)$.*

(ii) *$g(z) - \operatorname{Log} z \to 0$ as $z\to\infty$, uniformly in $\mathbb{C}\setminus\mathbb{R}$.*

(iii) *U^* is strictly increasing on $[4c,\infty)$, and $U^*(x) = \log x + o(1)$ as $x\to\infty$. Hence $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi(x) = \gamma_p - U^*(x) < 0$ for $x > 4c$, and $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi(x) \le -\frac12\log x$ for $x \ge x_0$.*

Proof. (i) For $y>0$, $\log(z-y)$ jumps by $2\pi i$ across $(-\infty,y)$. Integrating against μ^* gives the jumps; continuity of the boundary values follows from the continuity of ψ^* on $(0,\infty)$. On $(0,4c)$, $g_+ + g_- = 2U^* = 2\gamma_p$, so $\varphi_+ + \varphi_- = 0$. On $(4c,\infty)$, $\mu^*((x,\infty)) = \int_x^\infty \lambda_p = t(x)/n$, so $g_+ - g_- = 2i\theta/n$, and $\tilde\varphi_+ - \tilde\varphi_- = -(g_+ - g_-) + 2i\theta/n = 0$.

(ii) For $z\in\mathbb{C}_+$ and $y>0$ we have $\operatorname{Log}(z-y) = \operatorname{Log} z + \operatorname{Log}(1-y/z)$, because $\arg(z-y) - \arg z \in (0,\pi)$; the case $z\in\mathbb{C}_-$ is the mirror image. So $g(z) - \operatorname{Log} z = \int \operatorname{Log}(1-y/z)\,\mathrm{d}\mu^*(y)$. On $\{y \le |z|/2\}$ we use $|\operatorname{Log}(1-y/z)| \le 2y/|z|$ and $\int_{y\le R} y\,\mathrm{d}\mu^* \le 1 + \int_1^R y\lambda_p(y)\,\mathrm{d}y = o(R)$ (as $\psi^* \le \lambda_p$). On $\{y > |z|/2\}$ we use $\psi^* \le \lambda_p \le C|z|^{-1-1/p}$ there and $|\operatorname{Log}(1-y/z)| \le \pi + \log(1+u) + |\log|1-u||$ with $u = y/|z|$, which follows from $|1-u| \le |1-y/z| \le 1+u$. The resulting integral is $O(|z|^{-1/p})$. Both parts tend to 0 uniformly.

(iii) For $\beta>0$ put $G_\beta(z) := 2\log\big((\sqrt{z} + \sqrt{z-\beta})/2\big)$. It is analytic off $(-\infty,\beta]$, equals $\log z + o(1)$ at ∞, and $G_\beta'(z) = 1/\sqrt{z(z-\beta)} = \int \mathrm{d}\omega_\beta(y)/(z-y)$, the Stieltjes transform of the arcsine law. Hence $G_\beta(z) = \int \log(z-y)\,\mathrm{d}\omega_\beta(y)$. Taking real parts, $u_\beta(x) := \int \log|x-y|\,\mathrm{d}\omega_\beta(y)$ equals $\log(\beta/4)$ on $[0,\beta]$ (there $|\sqrt{x} + i\sqrt{\beta-x}|^2 = \beta$), and it is strictly increasing on $[\beta,\infty)$. So $U^* = \int_0^1 u_{\beta_\tau}\,\mathrm{d}\tau$ is non-decreasing on $(0,\infty)$. For $x > 4c$ the set of τ with $\beta_\tau < x$ is the interval $((4c/x)^{1/p}, 1]$, of positive length, on which u_{β_τ} is strictly increasing at x. So U^* is strictly increasing on $[4c,\infty)$. For the asymptotics, $U^*(x) - \log x = \int \log|1-y/x|\,\mathrm{d}\mu^*(y)$, and the argument of (ii) on the real axis shows that this tends to 0. Finally, $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi = \operatorname{Re}\varphi = \gamma_p - U^*$ on $(4c,\infty)$, because θ is real there; $U^*(4c) = \gamma_p$, which gives the sign, and $U^*(x) \ge \frac12\log x + \gamma_p$ for large x. □

At $p=1$ the first moment of μ^* diverges and $g(z) - \operatorname{Log} z = O(|z|^{-1}\log|z|)$; for $p>1$ it is $O(|z|^{-1/p})$ and for $p<1$ it is $O(|z|^{-1})$. Only (ii) is used.

5.5. **Signs and the local variables at the two edges.** The lens opening needs $\operatorname{Re}\varphi < 0$ off the band, and the triangular factors that appear later need $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi > 0$ just above and below the band. Near the edges we need the local variables of the Bessel and Airy models.

Lemma 5.4 (Signs and local variables)**.** (i) *$\operatorname{Re}\varphi(z) < 0$ for every $z\in\mathbb{C}\setminus[0,4c]$ (for z on $(4c,\infty)$ and $(-\infty,0)$ this refers to the common real part of the two boundary values), and $\operatorname{Re}\varphi_\pm = 0$ on $(0,4c)$.*

(ii) *For every compact $K \subset (0,4c)$ there is $y_K > 0$ such that $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi(x \pm iy) > 0$ for $x \in K$ and $0 < y \le y_K$. Moreover $\partial_y \operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi(x+iy)|_{y=0^+} = \pi(\lambda_p - \psi^*)(x) > 0$ on $(0,4c)$.*

(iii) *(Hard edge.) There are $\delta_0 > 0$ and a function f, analytic and univalent on $U(0,2\delta_0)$, real on the real axis, with $f(0) = 0$ and $f'(0) < 0$, such that $(\varphi \pm i\pi)^2 = 4f$ on $U(0,2\delta_0) \cap \mathbb{C}_\pm$. More precisely $\varphi = \mp i\pi - 2f^{1/2}$ in $\mathbb{C}_\pm$, with the principal root. In particular f does not depend on n, $|\operatorname{Re}\varphi(z)| \le C|z|^{1/2}$ on $U(0,\delta_0)$, and $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi(z) \ge \pi|z|^{-1/p}\sin(|\arg z|/p) - C|z|^{1/2}$ for $z \in U(0,\delta_0)$, $0 < |\arg z| \le \vartheta_{\mathrm w}$.*

(iv) *(Soft edge.) There are $\varepsilon_0 > 0$ and a function f_r, analytic and univalent on $U(4c,2\varepsilon_0)$, real on the real axis, with $f_r(4c) = 0$ and $f_r'(4c) > 0$, such that $\tilde\varphi^2 = \frac49 f_r^3$ on $U(4c,2\varepsilon_0)$, and $\tilde\varphi = -\frac23 f_r^{3/2}$ (principal branch, cut along $f_r^{-1}((-\infty,0])$). In particular $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi > 0$ on $\{z \in U(4c,\varepsilon_0) :\ \pi/3 < |\arg(z-4c)| < \pi\}$ and $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi < 0$ for $|\arg(z-4c)| < \pi/3$.*

Proof. (i) We have $\operatorname{Re}\varphi(z) = \gamma_p - \int \log|z-y|\,\mathrm d\mu^*(y)$. If $\operatorname{Re} z > 0$ and $\operatorname{Im} z \ne 0$, then $|z-y| > |\operatorname{Re} z - y|$ for all y, so $\operatorname{Re} g(z) > U^*(\operatorname{Re} z) \ge \gamma_p$ (Proposition 2.5 and Lemma 5.3(iii)). On $(4c,\infty)$, $\operatorname{Re} g_\pm = U^* > \gamma_p$ by Lemma 5.3(iii). If $\operatorname{Re} z \le 0$ and $z \ne 0$, choose $0 < \varepsilon \le \min(|z|/2, 4c)$; then $|z-y| \ge y > y - \varepsilon$ for $y \ge \varepsilon$, and $|z-y| \ge |z| > \varepsilon \ge |\varepsilon - y|$ for $0 < y < \varepsilon$, so $\operatorname{Re} g(z) > U^*(\varepsilon) = \gamma_p$. On $(0,4c)$, $\operatorname{Re} g_\pm = U^* = \gamma_p$.

(ii) In $\mathbb{C}_+$, $\tilde\varphi = \varphi + i\theta/n = \gamma_p - g + i\pi z^{-1/p}$. Since ψ^* is real-analytic on $(0,4c)$ (it is λ_p times a regularised incomplete beta function of $x/4c$), $g|_{\mathbb{C}_+}$ continues analytically across $(0,4c)$, and so does $\tilde\varphi$. By the Cauchy–Riemann equations, $\partial_y \operatorname{Re} g(x+i0) = -\operatorname{Im} g'(x+i0) = \pi\psi^*(x)$ and $\partial_y \operatorname{Re}(i\pi z^{-1/p})|_{z=x} = -\pi \frac{\mathrm d}{\mathrm dx} x^{-1/p} = \pi\lambda_p(x)$. Since $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi = 0$ on $(0,4c)$, a Taylor expansion with a uniform remainder on K gives the claim. $\mathbb{C}_-$ is the mirror image.

(iii) On $(0,4c)$, $\varphi_+(x) = \gamma_p - U^*(x) - i\pi\mu^*((x,\infty)) = -i\pi + i\pi\mu^*((0,x])$. By Proposition 2.5, $\psi^*(x) = \lambda_p(x)\,\mathcal B_{x/4c}(\frac1p + \frac12, \frac12)$ near 0, and $\mathcal B_y(a,\frac12) = y^a A_0(y)$ with A_0 analytic near 0 and $A_0(0) > 0$. Since $\lambda_p(x)(x/4c)^{1/p+1/2} = Cx^{-1/2}$, we get $\mu^*((0,x]) = x^{1/2}A(x)$ with A analytic near 0 and $A(0) > 0$. Put $f(z) := -\frac{\pi^2}{4} z A(z)^2$. Then f is analytic and real on the real axis, $f(0) = 0$, $f'(0) = -\pi^2 A(0)^2/4 < 0$, so f is univalent on a disc $U(0,2\delta_0)$. The functions $(\varphi + i\pi)^2$ (on $\mathbb{C}_+$) and $4f$ are analytic in $U(0,2\delta_0) \cap \mathbb{C}_+$ and have the same continuous boundary values $-\pi^2 x A(x)^2$ on $(0,2\delta_0)$; by the reflection principle they coincide. The same holds in $\mathbb{C}_-$ with $\varphi - i\pi$. On the band, $f(x+i0)$ lies on the negative axis approached from below, and the principal root gives $f^{1/2} = -\frac{i\pi}{2} x^{1/2} A(x)$, so $\varphi_+ + i\pi = -2f^{1/2}$; by continuity $\varphi = -i\pi - 2f^{1/2}$ in $U(0,2\delta_0) \cap \mathbb{C}_+$. The remaining claims follow from $|f(z)| \le C|z|$, from $\tilde\varphi = \varphi \pm i\pi z^{-1/p}$ and from $\operatorname{Re}(\pm i\pi z^{-1/p}) = \pi|z|^{-1/p}\sin(|\arg z|/p)$.

(iv) On $(4c - 2\varepsilon_0, 4c)$ we have $\tilde\varphi_+ + \tilde\varphi_- = \varphi_+ + \varphi_- = 0$ and, using Lemma 5.3(i), $\tilde\varphi_+ - \tilde\varphi_- = 2\pi i \int_x^\infty (\lambda_p - \psi^*) = 2\pi i \int_x^{4c} (\lambda_p - \psi^*)$. Near $y = 1$, $1 - \mathcal B_y(a,\frac12) = (1-y)^{1/2} A_1(y)$ with A_1 analytic and $A_1(1) > 0$, so $\tilde\varphi_+(x) = i\pi(4c-x)^{3/2} A_2(x)$ with A_2 analytic near $4c$ and $A_2(4c) > 0$. As in (iii), $\tilde\varphi^2$ and $h(z) := \pi^2(z-4c)^3 A_2(z)^2$ are analytic in $U(4c,2\varepsilon_0) \setminus [4c - 2\varepsilon_0, 4c + 2\varepsilon_0]$ with equal boundary values on $(4c - 2\varepsilon_0, 4c)$, and $\tilde\varphi$ has no jump on $(4c, 4c + 2\varepsilon_0)$ (Lemma 5.3(i)). So $\tilde\varphi^2 = h$. Put $f_r := (9h/4)^{1/3} = (\frac{3\pi}{2})^{2/3}(z-4c)A_2(z)^{2/3}$. On $(4c,\infty)$, $\tilde\varphi$ is real and negative (Lemma 5.3(iii)), which fixes the branch $\tilde\varphi = -\frac23 f_r^{3/2}$. The sign statements follow from $\arg f_r^{3/2} = \frac32 \arg(z-4c) + o(1)$. □

5.6. **The contour.** We fix, once and for all and independently of n, numbers $\delta, \varepsilon, h_0, \delta'$ with

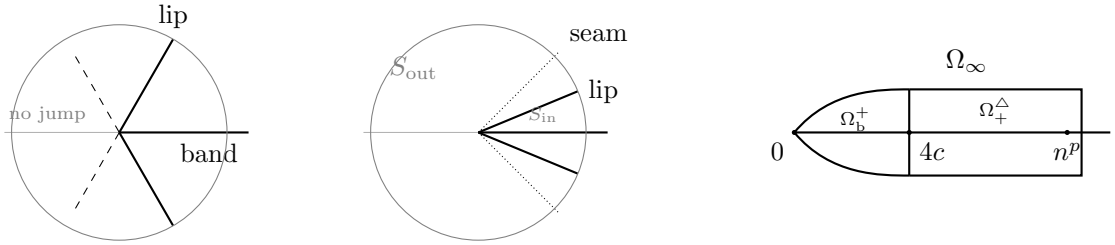
$$0 < \varepsilon < h_0 < \varepsilon_0, \qquad 0 < \delta < \min(\delta_0, \tfrac14, \tfrac{c}{2}), \qquad h_0 \le \tfrac12 \delta \tan\vartheta_{\mathrm w}, \qquad 0 < \delta' < 1,$$

and the following arcs (Figure 2).

- The *band* $[0,4c]$, the *saturated segment* $(4c, n^p+\delta')$ and the *top segment* $\Sigma_{\mathrm{top}} := \{n^p+\delta'+iy:\ 0<|y|\le h_0\}$. The top node $X_1 = n^p$ lies inside, and no node lies on $[n^p+\delta',\infty)$.
- The *lips* $\Sigma^{\pm}_{\mathrm{lip}}$, C^2 arcs in $\mathbb{C}_\pm$ from 0 to $4c\pm ih_0$. In $U(0,\delta)$ they are the preimages under $\zeta = n^2 f(z)$ of the rays $\arg\zeta = \mp(\pi-\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$; since $f'(0)<0$, they leave 0 at the angles $\pm\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$, and they do not depend on n. Outside $U(0,\delta)$ they run in $\mathbb{C}_\pm\cap\{|\arg z|<\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}\}$, inside the domain where $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi>0$ (such arcs exist by Lemma 5.4(ii)–(iv): near 0 the last inequality of (iii) gives $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi>0$ on $\{\delta\le|z|\le\delta_0,\ \frac34\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}\le|\arg z|\le\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}\}$ if δ_0 is small, so the lips can descend to a small height there, follow the band at a height where (ii) applies, and rise to $4c\pm ih_0$ along $|z-4c|=h_0$, where (iv) applies). They stay outside $U(4c,h_0)$ except at their endpoint. We take δ so small that $\frac34\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}\le|\arg z|\le\frac54\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$ on $\Sigma^{\pm}_{\mathrm{lip}}\cap U(0,\delta)$.
- The *vertical segments* $\Sigma^{\pm}_v := \{4c\pm iy:\ 0<y\le h_0\}$.
- The *saturated lips* $\Sigma^{\triangle\pm} := \{x\pm ih_0:\ 4c\le x\le n^p+\delta'\}$.

These arcs bound the *lens* $\Omega^{\pm}_{\mathrm{b}}$ (between the band and $\Sigma^{\pm}_{\mathrm{lip}}$, left of $\Sigma^{\pm}_v$) and the *saturated regions* $\Omega^{\triangle}_{\pm} := \{4c<\operatorname{Re}z<n^p+\delta',\ 0<\pm\operatorname{Im}z<h_0\}$. The rest of $\mathbb{C}$ is Ω_∞. We write Σ for the union of all these arcs. Only finitely many arcs meet at each vertex, and for fixed n, Σ is bounded. In $U(4c,\varepsilon)$ the only arcs are the band, the saturated segment and $\Sigma^{\pm}_v$; at 0 only the band and the two lips meet. Nothing lies on $(-\infty,0)$ or on $(n^p+\delta',\infty)$.

The closures of $\Omega^{\pm}_{\mathrm{b}}$ and $\Omega^{\triangle}_{\pm}$, minus the point 0, lie in $\mathcal{Z}_n$. Indeed, near 0 the lens lies in $|\arg z|<\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}$ by construction of the lips; every point of $\Omega^{\triangle}$ has $\operatorname{Re}z\ge 4c$ and $|\operatorname{Im}z|\le h_0 < 4c\tan\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}$, so $|\arg z|<\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}$; and $|z|\le n^p+\delta'+h_0<e^{pc_0}n^p$ for $n\ge n_0$.



$p\ge1$: lips at $\pm\pi/3$ $\quad p<1$: lips at $\pm\pi p/4$, seams at $\pm\pi p/2$ $\qquad$ all p (not to scale)

FIGURE 2. The contour near the hard edge for $p\ge1$ and $p<1$ (Bessel rays dashed), and the whole contour. The negative axis and, for $p<1$, the seams carry no jump of V or Q. The seams are used only to construct the outer scalar (§6.3).

5.7. **The transformations.** We now remove the poles, normalise at infinity and open the lens. The pattern is that of T1(b); since we work in a one-sided variable, we write every factor out. Put, in $\mathbb{C}_\pm$,

$$\kappa_\pm := \frac{1}{1-e^{\mp2i\theta}}, \qquad \text{so that} \qquad \kappa_\pm - 1 = e^{\mp2i\theta}\kappa_\pm, \tag{47}$$

and note $|e^{\mp2i\theta}|<1$ in $\mathbb{C}_\pm\cap\mathcal{Z}_n$ by (41), so $\kappa_\pm$ is analytic there. Define, on $\mathcal{Z}_n\cap\mathbb{C}_\pm$,

$$L_\pm := \begin{pmatrix}1 & \mp We^{\mp2i\theta}\kappa_\pm\\ 0 & 1\end{pmatrix}, \qquad A_\pm := \begin{pmatrix}1 & 0\\ \mp e^{2n\varphi}/W & 1\end{pmatrix}, \qquad A^{\triangle}_\pm := \begin{pmatrix}1 & 0\\ \mp1/(\kappa_\pm W) & 1\end{pmatrix}. \tag{48}$$

Step 1: removal of the poles. Let

$$R := U \text{ in } \Omega_\infty, \qquad R := UL_\pm \text{ in } \Omega_{\mathrm{b}}^{\pm}, \qquad R := UA_\pm^{\triangle}\,\kappa_\pm^{\sigma_3} \text{ in } \Omega_\pm^{\triangle}. \tag{49}$$

The restriction of R to each of the four regions $\Omega_{\mathrm{b}}^{\pm}$, $\Omega_\pm^{\triangle}$ extends continuously to the real axis, including the nodes. Indeed, near X_k all factors are meromorphic, and $1 - e^{\mp 2i\theta} = \pm 2i\theta'(X_k)(z-X_k)(1+O(z-X_k))$ because $e^{2i\theta(X_k)} = 1$. In $\Omega_{\mathrm{b}}^{\pm}$ the entry $\mp W e^{\mp 2i\theta}\kappa_\pm$ then has the simple pole $W(X_k)/(2i\theta'(X_k)(z-X_k)) = w(X_k)/(z-X_k)$, and $R_{j2} = U_{j2} - U_{j1}w(X_k)/(z-X_k) + O(1)$ is regular by Lemma 5.1. In $\Omega_\pm^{\triangle}$, $\kappa_\pm^{-1}$ vanishes simply at X_k, which removes the pole of the second column; the first column is $\kappa_\pm(U_{j1} \mp U_{j2}/(\kappa_\pm W))$, and the bracket vanishes at X_k since $U_{j2}/(\kappa_\pm W) \to \pm U_{j1}(X_k)$, so the first column is regular too.

Step 2: normalisation. $T := e^{-n\gamma_p\sigma_3} R e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}$.

Step 3: the lens. $S := TA_\pm$ in $\Omega_{\mathrm{b}}^{\pm}$, and $S := T$ elsewhere.

Step 4: the outer scalar. Given a function F with the properties (O1)–(O2) of §5.9 below and its lens version $\tilde F$, let

$$V := C_\infty\, S\, \tilde F^{\sigma_3} \text{ in } \Omega_{\mathrm{b}} \cup \Omega^{\triangle}, \qquad V := C_\infty\, S\, F^{\sigma_3} \text{ in } \Omega_\infty, \tag{50}$$

with a constant diagonal matrix C_∞ fixed in Lemma 6.7.

Composing the four steps, and using $\kappa_\pm^{\sigma_3}\tilde F^{\sigma_3} = F^{\sigma_3}$ in $\Omega_\pm^{\triangle}$ (definition (52) below),

$$V = C_\infty e^{-n\gamma_p\sigma_3}\, U\, M, \qquad M := \begin{cases} e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}F^{\sigma_3} & \text{in } \Omega_\infty, \\ L_\pm e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}A_\pm \tilde F^{\sigma_3} & \text{in } \Omega_{\mathrm{b}}^{\pm}, \\ A_\pm^{\triangle} e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}F^{\sigma_3} & \text{in } \Omega_\pm^{\triangle}. \end{cases} \tag{51}$$

Since U is analytic off the nodes, the jump of V on any arc of Σ away from the nodes is $M_-^{-1}M_+$.

The factor in $\Omega_\pm^{\triangle}$ is the product of the factors $\Pi^{-\sigma_3}(\cdot)$ and $V_\pm^{\triangle}$ of T1(b), moved into one step, except that in $\Omega_-^{\triangle}$ we have changed it by the scalar -1. With the literal product a constant jump $-I$ would appear on the saturated segment.

5.8. **Where the weight is evaluated.** The following bookkeeping explains why the three strips ϑ_p of Table 1 differ.

Lemma 5.5 (Where the weight is evaluated)**.** *The functions w, W, r_n and W_0 (defined in (54)) are evaluated in this paper only at points of $\mathcal{Z}_n$: in the closures of Ω_{b} and $\Omega^{\triangle}$ (minus the point 0), which contain the band, the saturated segment, the lips, the vertical segments, $\Sigma^{\triangle\pm}$ and the top segment, and at the points of the lips and of the sectors $\{|\arg z| \le \frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}\} \cap U(0,\delta)$ used in §7 and Appendix C, and on the top segment. The region Ω_∞ never uses the weight: there $M = e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}F^{\sigma_3}$ contains neither w nor W. Consequently, for every such point $\xi(z) = \log t(z)$ lies in $\{\operatorname{Re}\xi \ge -c_0,\ |\operatorname{Im}\xi| \le \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}/p\} \subset S_{\vartheta_p}$.*

Proof. By (51), w and W enter V only in $\Omega_{\mathrm{b}} \cup \Omega^{\triangle}$, whose closure minus $\{0\}$ lies in $\mathcal{Z}_n$ (§5.6); the top segment has $|z| \le n^p + \delta' + h_0 < e^{pc_0}n^p$ and $|\arg z| < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}$. The sectors used near 0 lie in $\mathcal{Z}_n$ because $\frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}$. For $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$, $\operatorname{Re}\xi = \log n - \frac{1}{p}\log|z| > -c_0$ and $|\operatorname{Im}\xi| = |\arg z|/p < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}/p$. □

For $p > 1$ every argument up to $\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}} < \pi$ would be allowed, and the hypothesis is the full strip π/p. For $p < 1$ the same bookkeeping keeps all evaluations in the inner sector $|\arg z| < \pi p/2$, so the strip $\pi/2$ suffices; the strip π/p would be wider than needed, and wider than the strip on which, for example, $\Lambda(\xi) = \sqrt{\log(e^\xi + e)}$ is analytic. At $p = 1$ the strip is $\pi/2$ for the same reason.

Lemma 5.6 (Potter bounds in the sector)**.** *For every $\eta > 0$ there is C_η such that:*

(i) $|\Lambda(\xi)| \le C_\eta + \eta \operatorname{Re}\xi$ *for* $\xi \in S_{\vartheta_p}$, $\operatorname{Re}\xi \ge 0$, *and* $|\Lambda| \le C$ *on* $S_{\vartheta_p} \cap \{\operatorname{Re}\xi \le 0\}$. *Hence* $|\ell_1(t)|^{\pm 1} \le C_\eta |t|^\eta$ *for* $|\arg t| \le \vartheta_p$, $|t| \ge 1$.

(ii) $|r_n(z)|^{\pm 1} \le C_\eta n^{2\eta}(1 + |z|^{-\eta/p})$ *for* $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$.

(iii) *For* $R \ge 1$, $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$ *with* $|z| \le R$ *and* $x \in (0, R]$,

$$|\log r_n(z) - \log r_n(x)| \le \frac{\varepsilon_\Lambda(T)}{p}\big(|\arg z| + |\log(x/|z|)|\big),$$

$$|\log r_n(z)| \le \frac{\varepsilon_\Lambda(T)}{p}\big(|\arg z| + |\log|z||\big),$$

with $T := \log n - \frac{1}{p}\log R$. *Here* $\log r_n = \Lambda(\xi) - \Lambda(\log n)$.

Proof. (i) For $\operatorname{Re}\xi \ge T_0$, integrate Λ' along the horizontal segment from $T_0 + i\operatorname{Im}\xi$ to ξ: $|\Lambda(\xi) - \Lambda(T_0 + i\operatorname{Im}\xi)| \le \varepsilon_\Lambda(T_0)\operatorname{Re}\xi$. Choose T_0 with $\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_0) \le \eta$; Λ is bounded on the compact set $S_{\vartheta_p} \cap \{0 \le \operatorname{Re}\xi \le T_0\}$ and, by hypothesis, on $\operatorname{Re}\xi \le 0$. Then $|\ell_1(t)|^{\pm 1} = e^{\pm \operatorname{Re}\Lambda(\log t)}$. (ii) $|r_n|^{\pm 1} = |\ell_1(t)|^{\pm 1}\ell_1(n)^{\mp 1}$ with $|t| = n|z|^{-1/p}$; apply (i) to both factors (for $|t| \le 1$ use the bound on $\operatorname{Re}\xi \le 0$). (iii) Join $\xi(x)$ to $\xi(z)$ by the horizontal segment from $\log n - \frac{1}{p}\log x$ to $\log n - \frac{1}{p}\log|z|$ followed by the vertical segment to $\xi(z)$. Along this path $\operatorname{Re}\xi \ge T$ and $|\operatorname{Im}\xi| \le |\arg z|/p$, and its length is $(|\log(x/|z|)| + |\arg z|)/p$. The second inequality is the case $x = 1$, since $r_n(1) = 1$. □

5.9. **The outer scalar and the jumps of V.** §6 constructs, for each geometry, a function F with the following five properties. The constants in (O3) and (O4) do not depend on n; $\nu_p := \min(1/p, \frac{1}{2})$, and $\eta_0 \in (0, \delta]$ is fixed.

(O1) F is analytic and zero-free in $\mathbb{C} \setminus [0, \infty)$ (in particular, it has no jump on $(-\infty, 0)$), it has continuous boundary values on $(0, \infty) \setminus \{X_k\}$, and $F_+ = F_- e^{2i\theta}$ on $(4c, \infty) \setminus \{X_k\}$.

(O2) The *lens scalar*

$$\tilde F := (1 - e^{\mp 2i\theta})F = F/\kappa_\pm \qquad \text{in } \mathbb{C}_\pm \cap \mathcal{Z}_n \tag{52}$$

extends to an analytic, zero-free function on $\mathcal{Z}_n \setminus [4c, \infty)$, with $\tilde F_+ = -\tilde F_-$ on $(4c, e^{pc_0}n^p)$. Thus $\tilde F^2$ is analytic and zero-free on $\mathcal{Z}_n$, and so is the *band factor*

$$H_n(z) := \frac{1}{(4c - z)\tilde F(z)^2} \qquad (z \in \mathcal{Z}_n). \tag{53}$$

We require $H_n > 0$ on $(0, e^{pc_0}n^p)$ and that $H_n(0^+) := \lim_{z \to 0,\, z \in \mathcal{Z}_n} H_n(z)$ exists in $(0, \infty)$.

(O3) For $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$ with $|z| \le \eta_0$: $|\log H_n(z) - \log H_n(0^+)| \le C|z|^{\nu_p}$ and $|(\log H_n)'(z)| \le C|z|^{\nu_p - 1}$.

(O4) For $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$ with $|z| \ge \eta_0$: $|\log H_n(z) - \log H_n(0^+)| \le C\big(1 + \log(1 + |z|)\big)^2$.

(O5) (For each fixed n.) $|F|^{\pm 1}$ is bounded on $U(0, \delta) \setminus (\overline{\Omega_{\mathrm{b}}} \cup [0, \infty))$, and $\tilde F^{\pm 1}$ is bounded on $U(0, \delta) \cap \Omega_{\mathrm{b}}$. There is m_n with $|F(z)|^{\pm 1} \le C_n|z|^{m_n}$ for $|z| \ge n^p + \delta'$, $z \notin \mathbb{R}$, and $F(iy)$ is bounded and bounded away from 0 as $y \to \pm\infty$.

The *band weight* is

$$W_0 := \frac{W}{\tilde F^2} = C_n\, z^\alpha (4c - z) H_n(z) r_n(z) \quad \text{on } \mathcal{Z}_n, \qquad C_n := C_n' \tag{54}$$

(Lemma 5.2). On $(0, 4c)$ it equals C_n times a positive function.

Lemma 5.7 (Jumps of V)**.** *Assume (O1) and (O2). Then V is analytic in $\mathbb{C}\setminus\Sigma$, has continuous boundary values on Σ minus its vertices (including at the nodes), and $V_+ = V_- v_V$ with*

(a) *on the band $(0,4c)$: $v_V = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & W_0 \\ -1/W_0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$;*

(b) *on $\Sigma^{\pm}_{\mathrm{lip}}$ (oriented away from 0), with $\epsilon_+ = 1$ and $\epsilon_- = 0$:*

$$v_V = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ e^{2n\varphi}/W_0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} \epsilon_\pm(\kappa_\pm - 1) & W_0 e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ (\kappa_\pm - 1)e^{2n\varphi}/W_0 & \epsilon_\mp(\kappa_\pm - 1) \end{pmatrix};$$

(c) *on $\Sigma_v^{\pm}$ (oriented away from the real axis): $v_V = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -W_0 e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$;*

(d) *on the saturated segment $(4c, n^p+\delta')$: $v_V = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ e^{2n\tilde\varphi}/W_0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$;*

(e) *on $\Sigma^{\triangle\pm}$ (oriented from left to right): $v_V = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \kappa_\pm e^{2n\varphi}/W_0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$;*

(f) *on $\Sigma_{\mathrm{top}}\cap\mathbb{C}_\pm$ (oriented upwards): $v_V = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \mp\kappa_\pm e^{2n\varphi}/W_0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$;*

(g) *there is no jump on $(-\infty,0)$ or on $(n^p+\delta',\infty)$.*

Proof. We use $M_-^{-1}M_+$ from (51) and the identities

$$e^{\mp 2i\theta}e^{-2n\varphi} = e^{-2n\tilde\varphi}, \qquad F = \kappa_\pm \tilde F, \qquad W/\tilde F^2 = W_0 \qquad \text{in } \mathbb{C}_\pm. \tag{55}$$

For a diagonal matrix $D = \mathrm{diag}(d_1,d_2)$, conjugation $D^{-1}XD$ multiplies the $(1,2)$ entry by d_2/d_1 and the $(2,1)$ entry by d_1/d_2.

(a) $L_-^{-1}L_+ = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & W \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$: its $(1,2)$ entry is $-W(e^{-2i\theta}\kappa_+ + e^{2i\theta}\kappa_-) = -W\left(\frac{e^{-2i\theta}}{1-e^{-2i\theta}} + \frac{1}{e^{-2i\theta}-1}\right) = W$. Conjugating by $e^{n\varphi_\pm\sigma_3}$ and using $\varphi_- = -\varphi_+$ (Lemma 5.3(i)) gives $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} e^{2n\varphi_+} & W \\ 0 & e^{2n\varphi_-} \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and

$$A_-^{-1}\begin{pmatrix} e^{2n\varphi_+} & W \\ 0 & e^{2n\varphi_-} \end{pmatrix} A_+ = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & W \\ -1/W & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Since $\tilde F$ has no jump on the band (O2), the final conjugation gives (a) by (55).

(b) Upper lip: the $+$ side is Ω_∞, so $v_V = M^{-1}_{\Omega_{\mathrm{b}}} M_{\Omega_\infty} = \tilde F^{-\sigma_3} A_+^{-1}\big(e^{-n\varphi\sigma_3}L_+^{-1}e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}\big)F^{\sigma_3}$. The bracket is $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & W\kappa_+ e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and

$$A_+^{-1}\begin{pmatrix} 1 & W\kappa_+ e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & W\kappa_+ e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ e^{2n\varphi}/W & \kappa_+ \end{pmatrix},$$

because $1+\kappa_+ e^{2n\varphi}e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} = 1+\kappa_+e^{-2i\theta} = \kappa_+$. Conjugating with $\tilde F^{-\sigma_3}(\cdot)F^{\sigma_3}$, $F=\kappa_+\tilde F$, gives $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} \kappa_+ & W_0 e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ \kappa_+ e^{2n\varphi}/W_0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, which is (b). The lower lip (where the $+$ side is the lens) is the mirror computation and gives $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & W_0 e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ \kappa_- e^{2n\varphi}/W_0 & \kappa_- \end{smallmatrix}\right)$.

(c) Upper segment, $+$ side $= \Omega_{\mathrm{b}}^+$: $v_V = M^{-1}_{\Omega^\triangle} M_{\Omega_{\mathrm{b}}} = F^{-\sigma_3}e^{-n\varphi\sigma_3}(A_+^\triangle)^{-1}L_+e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}A_+\tilde F^{\sigma_3}$. One checks $(A_+^\triangle)^{-1}L_+ = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & -We^{-2i\theta}\kappa_+ \\ 1/(\kappa_+ W) & 1-e^{-2i\theta} \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and after the conjugation by $e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}$ and right multiplication by A_+ the $(2,1)$ entry vanishes and the diagonal becomes (κ_+,κ_+^{-1}); the final conjugation with $F=\kappa_+\tilde F$ removes the diagonal and gives (c). The lower segment is the mirror image.

(d) On $(4c, n^p+\delta')$ both sides lie in $\Omega^\triangle$. Since $\kappa_\pm^{-1} = 1-e^{\mp 2i\theta}$, $(A_-^\triangle)^{-1}A_+^\triangle = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ -(\kappa_+^{-1}+\kappa_-^{-1})/W & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and $\kappa_+^{-1}+\kappa_-^{-1} = 2-2\cos 2\theta = \kappa_+^{-1}\kappa_-^{-1}$. Conjugating by $e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}F^{\sigma_3}$ with boundary values, the

diagonal is $(e^{n(\varphi_+-\varphi_-)}F_+/F_-)^{\sigma_3} = (e^{-2i\theta}e^{2i\theta})^{\sigma_3} = I$ by Lemma 5.3(i) and (O1), and the $(2,1)$ entry is $-e^{n(\varphi_++\varphi_-)}F_+F_-/(\kappa_+\kappa_-W) = -e^{2n\tilde{\varphi}}\tilde{F}_+\tilde{F}_-/W$. By (O2), $-\tilde{F}_+\tilde{F}_- = \tilde{F}^2$, which gives (d).

(e), (f) Here $v_V = (F^{-\sigma_3}e^{-n\varphi\sigma_3})(A_\pm^{\triangle})^{\pm1}(e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}F^{\sigma_3})$ with the exponent fixed by the orientation, and the $(2,1)$ entry $\mp1/(\kappa_\pm W)$ of $A_\pm^{\triangle}$ becomes $\mp F^2e^{2n\varphi}/(\kappa_\pm W) = \mp\kappa_\pm e^{2n\varphi}/W_0$.

(g) On $(-\infty,0)$: U has no jump, $e^{n\varphi}$ jumps by $e^{-2\pi in} = 1$ (Lemma 5.3(i)) and F has no jump (O1). On $(n^p+\delta',\infty)$ there are no nodes, and $M_-^{-1}M_+ = (e^{n(\varphi_+-\varphi_-)}F_+/F_-)^{\sigma_3} = I$ as in (d).

Continuity at the nodes: in (a) and (d) all entries are analytic across the real axis; together with Step 1 this shows that V has continuous boundary values there. □

	$p>1$	$p=1$	$0<p<1$
$\arg t$ on $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty,0]$	$(-\pi/p,\pi/p)\subset(-\pi,\pi)$	$(-\pi,\pi)$, open	wider than $(-\pi,\pi)$; poles of $\Gamma(t)$ on $\arg z=\pm\pi p$
where $\tilde{D}=e^{-j(t)}$ is used	slit plane	$\lvert\arg z\rvert\le\vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}=7\pi/16$	inner sector $S_{\mathrm{in}}=\{\lvert\arg z\rvert<\pi p/2\}$
outer scalar F	DBK, Binet-cut scalar B (Lemma 6.1)	DK, $D=e^{j(-n/z)}$, no cut (Lemma 6.2)	$DB_{\mathrm{in}}Ke^{\chi}$ in S_{in}, $B_{\mathrm{out}}Ke^{\chi}$ in S_{out} (Lemma 6.4)
$\lvert\log\frac{H_n(z)}{H_n(0^+)}\rvert$ near 0	$\le C\lvert z\rvert^{1/p}$	$\le C\lvert z\rvert$	$\le C\lvert z\rvert(1+\log\frac{1}{\lvert z\rvert})$
$g(z)-\log z$ at ∞	$O(\lvert z\rvert^{-1/p})$	$O(\lvert z\rvert^{-1}\log\lvert z\rvert)$	$O(\lvert z\rvert^{-1})$
lip angle ϑ_{lip}; Bessel rays	$\pi/3$; $\pm2\pi/3$	$\pi/3$; $\pm2\pi/3$	$\pi p/4$; $\pm(\pi-\pi p/4)$
angle ϑ_{w} (weight evaluated)	$7\pi/16$	$7\pi/16$	$3\pi p/8$
super-small entries $\lvert e^{\mp2i\theta}\rvert$ on the lips	$e^{-2\pi n\sin(\frac{\pi}{3p})\lvert z\rvert^{-1/p}}$	$e^{-\sqrt{3}\pi n/\lvert z\rvert}$	$e^{-\sqrt{2}\pi n\lvert z\rvert^{-1/p}}$
strip ϑ_p for ℓ_1	π/p	$\pi/2$	$\pi/2$
ν_p (in $\varepsilon_n'=n^{-2\nu_p}\log n+\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)$)	$\min(1/p,\frac12)$	$\frac12$	$\frac12$
classical quotient parametrix at 0	works for pure powers (not used)	fails (Remark 6.3)	works with a seam glue (not used)

TABLE 1. The ingredients of the Riemann–Hilbert analysis that depend on the geometry. Everything else in §§5–8 is the same for all $p>0$. The super-small entries are evaluated on the rays $\arg z=\pm\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$; ε_n' is the lip-mismatch size of §7.

6. The outer scalar in three geometries

The transformations of §5 reduce everything away from the hard edge to one scalar problem: find an outer scalar F with the properties (O1)–(O5) of §5.9. The natural candidate comes from Stirling's formula. The node masses carry the factor $1/\Gamma(t)$ through $\Pi=\sin\theta/\theta'$, and

$$\tilde{D}(z):=e^{-j(t(z))},\qquad j(t):=\operatorname{Ln}\Gamma(t)-\left(t-\tfrac12\right)\ln t+t-\tfrac12\ln(2\pi),$$

removes this growth. Here j is Binet's function, $\operatorname{Ln}\Gamma$ is the branch analytic on $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty,0]$ and real on $(0,\infty)$, and $\ln t$ is principal; so $\tilde D=\sqrt{2\pi}\,t^{t-1/2}e^{-t}/\Gamma(t)$, and this sign convention is used throughout. Then

$$D:=\kappa_\pm\tilde D=\frac{\tilde D}{1-e^{\mp 2i\theta}}\quad\text{in }\mathbb{C}_\pm \tag{56}$$

satisfies $D_+/D_-=(1-e^{2i\theta})/(1-e^{-2i\theta})=-e^{2i\theta}$ on $(0,\infty)$ off the nodes, and $K(z):=(4c-z)^{-1/2}$ (principal branch, cut $[4c,\infty)$) supplies the missing factor -1, so that DK has the jump required in (O1).

The difficulty is the cut of $t(z)$ on $(-\infty,0)$. How it is handled depends on how far the sector of t reaches. For $p>1$, $|\arg t|<\pi/p<\pi$ on the slit plane: $\Gamma(t)$ has no poles there, and DK has a jump on $(-\infty,0)$ which is removed exactly by a Cauchy integral, the Binet-cut scalar B (§6.1). At $p=1$ the sector is exactly $|\arg t|<\pi$, and the reflection formula shows that D has no jump at all on $(-\infty,0)$ (§6.2). For $p<1$ the sector of t is wider than $(-\pi,\pi)$ and the poles of Γ enter; we then use D only in the inner sector $|\arg z|<\pi p/2$ and glue it to an elementary function outside along two seams, with an exact scalar χ (§6.3). §6.4 is common to all geometries: Szegő functions, the normalisation at infinity, the super-small entries, the two parametrices away from 0, and the Frame Proposition, which is the only input of §§7–8 from this section.

Two facts about j are used in all three geometries. By T4 (DLMF 5.11.1 with the remainder bound of §5.11(ii), first term $1/(12t)$), for every $\vartheta<\pi$,

$$|j(t)|\le\frac{\sec^2(\vartheta/2)}{12|t|},\qquad |j'(t)|\le\frac{C_\vartheta}{|t|^2}\qquad(|\arg t|\le\vartheta,\ |t|\ge1), \tag{57}$$

the second by Cauchy's estimate on a disc of radius $c_\vartheta|t|$ in a slightly larger sector. And for $|t|\le1$, $\operatorname{Re}t\ge0$, $t\ne0$, DLMF 5.5.1 gives $\operatorname{Ln}\Gamma(t)=\operatorname{Ln}\Gamma(1+t)-\ln t$, hence

$$j(t)=-\tfrac12\ln t-\tfrac12\ln(2\pi)+O(|t|\log(2/|t|))\qquad(t\to0,\ \operatorname{Re}t\ge0). \tag{58}$$

6.1. The case $p>1$: the Binet-cut scalar.

Lemma 6.1 (Binet-cut scalar)**.** *Let $p>1$.*

(i) *$\tilde D$ is analytic and zero-free on $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty,0]$, and D is analytic and zero-free in $\mathbb{C}_\pm$, with continuous boundary values on $\mathbb{R}\setminus(\{X_k\}\cup\{0\})$. On $(-\infty,0)$, $D_-=\overline{D_+}$.*

(ii) *Let $\hat\ell(y):=2\operatorname{Im}\big(-j(t_+(y))-\operatorname{Log}(1-e^{-2i\theta_+(y)})\big)$ for $y<0$, where t_+,θ_+ are boundary values from $\mathbb{C}_+$. Then $D_+/D_-=e^{i\hat\ell}$ on $(-\infty,0)$; $\hat\ell$ is real-analytic, $|\hat\ell(y)|\le C\min(1,|y|^{1/p})$ with C independent of n, $|\hat\ell'(y)|\le C_n|y|^{1/p-1}$ for $-1\le y<0$, $\hat\ell'$ is bounded on $(-\infty,-\frac12]$, and $\hat\ell(y)\to\pi/p-\pi$ as $y\to-\infty$, with $\int_{-\infty}^{-1}|\hat\ell(y)-\pi/p+\pi|\,|y|^{-1}\,\mathrm{d}y<\infty$.*

(iii) *The function*

$$B(z):=\exp\Big(-\frac{1}{2\pi}\int_{-\infty}^{0}\hat\ell(y)\Big[\frac{1}{y-z}-\frac{1}{y-1}\Big]\,\mathrm{d}y\Big) \tag{59}$$

is analytic and zero-free on $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty,0]$, positive on $(0,\infty)$, has continuous boundary values on $(-\infty,0)$ with $B_+=B_-e^{-i\hat\ell}$, and DB extends analytically across $(-\infty,0)$. For $z\in\mathcal{Z}_n$, with C independent of n,

$$\begin{gathered}|\log B(z)-\log B(0)|\le C|z|^{1/p},\quad |(\log B)'(z)|\le C|z|^{1/p-1}\quad(|z|\le1),\\ |\log B(z)|\le C(1+\log(1+|z|)).\end{gathered} \tag{60}$$

(iv) *$F := DBK$ satisfies (O1)–(O5), with $\tilde F = \tilde D BK$ and $H_n = (\tilde D B)^{-2}$.*

Proof. (i) On the slit plane $|\arg t| < \pi/p < \pi$, so $\Gamma(t)$ has neither zeros nor poles and $\tilde D$ is analytic and zero-free. By (41), $|e^{\mp 2i\theta}| < 1$ in $\mathbb{C}_\pm$ (here $\pi p > \pi$), so D is analytic and zero-free in $\mathbb{C}_\pm$. On $(-\infty, 0)$, $t_- = \overline{t_+}$ and Γ, j are real on the real axis, so $D_- = \overline{D_+}$.

(ii) Since $|e^{-2i\theta_+}| < 1$ on $(-\infty, 0)$, $\log D_+ := -j(t_+) - \operatorname{Log}(1 - e^{-2i\theta_+})$ is a continuous logarithm, real-analytic in y, and $D_+/D_- = e^{2i \operatorname{Im} \log D_+} = e^{i\hat\ell}$. With $|t_+| = n|y|^{-1/p}$ and $\arg t_+ = -\pi/p$: for $|t_+| \ge 1$, (57) and $|\operatorname{Log}(1 - e^{-2i\theta_+})| \le 2\exp(-2\pi \sin(\pi/p)|t_+|)$ give $|\hat\ell| \le C/|t_+| = C|y|^{1/p}/n$. For $|t_+| \le 1$ the expansion (58) and $\operatorname{Log}(1 - e^{-2\pi i t}) = \log(2\pi|t|) + i(\frac{\pi}{2} + \arg t) + O(t)$ (note $\frac{\pi}{2} + \arg t_+ \in (-\frac{\pi}{2}, \frac{\pi}{2})$) show that $\hat\ell$ is bounded and

$$\hat\ell(y) = 2\big(\tfrac12 \arg t_+ - \tfrac{\pi}{2} - \arg t_+\big) + O(|t_+| \log(2/|t_+|)) = \frac{\pi}{p} - \pi + O\big(n|y|^{-1/p} \log|y|\big).$$

This gives the bounds on $\hat\ell$ and the integrability. For the derivative, $\mathrm{d}t_+/\,\mathrm{d}y = -t_+/(py)$, and $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}t}\big(j(t) + \operatorname{Log}(1 - e^{-2\pi i t})\big)$ is $O(|t|^{-2})$ for $|t| \ge 1$ and $O(|t|^{-1})$ for $|t| \le 1$; multiplied by $|t|/|y|$ this gives $|\hat\ell'(y)| \le C|y|^{1/p-1}/n$ for $|y| \le n^p$ and $|\hat\ell'(y)| \le C/|y|$ otherwise.

(iii) The integral converges absolutely, since $\hat\ell$ is bounded and the bracket is $(z-1)/((y-z)(y-1))$. By the Sokhotski–Plemelj formula (the density is real-analytic on $(-\infty, 0)$), $\log B$ has continuous boundary values and $(\log B)_+ - (\log B)_- = -i\hat\ell$. So $(DB)_+ = (DB)_-$ on $(-\infty, 0)$, and DB, being continuous across, is analytic there by Morera's theorem. B is positive on $(0, \infty)$ because the integrand is real there.

For (60), let $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$. Then $|y - z|^2 = y^2 + |z|^2 + 2|y||z|\cos(\arg z) \ge \frac12(|y| + |z|)^2$ for $y < 0$, since $|\arg z| < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}} < \pi/2$. We have $\log B(z) - \log B(0) = -\frac{z}{2\pi}\int_{-\infty}^0 \frac{\hat\ell(y)\,\mathrm{d}y}{y(y-z)}$, so by (ii), for $|z| \le 1$,

$$|\log B(z) - \log B(0)| \le C|z| \int_0^\infty \frac{\min(1, u^{1/p})}{u(u + |z|)}\,\mathrm{d}u \le C|z|\Big(\int_0^1 \frac{u^{1/p-1}\,\mathrm{d}u}{u + |z|} + 1\Big) \le C|z|^{1/p},$$

because $1/p - 1 \in (-1, 0)$. The same splitting applied to $(\log B)'(z) = -\frac{1}{2\pi}\int \hat\ell(y)(y-z)^{-2}\,\mathrm{d}y$ gives $C|z|^{1/p-1}$, and applied to the original integral gives $C(1 + \log(1 + |z|))$.

(iv) *(O1).* F is analytic and zero-free off $[0, \infty)$ by (i), (iii) and the choice of K. On $(4c, \infty)$ off the nodes, $F_+/F_- = (D_+/D_-)(K_+/K_-) = (-e^{2i\theta})(-1)$, since B is analytic there.

(O2). $\tilde F = F/\kappa_\pm = \tilde D BK$ is analytic and zero-free on $\mathbb{C}\setminus\big((-\infty, 0] \cup [4c, \infty)\big)$, and $\tilde F_+ = -\tilde F_-$ on $(4c, \infty)$ because of K. Thus $H_n = 1/((4c - z)\tilde F^2) = (\tilde D B)^{-2}$, which is positive on $(0, \infty)$, and $H_n(0^+) = B(0)^{-2}$ because $\tilde D(z) \to 1$ as $z \to 0$ in $\mathcal{Z}_n$ by (57).

(O3), (O4). $\log H_n - \log H_n(0^+) = 2j(t) - 2(\log B - \log B(0))$. For $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$, $|z| \le 1$, we have $|t| \ge n$ and $|\arg t| \le \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}/p$, so $|j(t)| \le C|z|^{1/p}/n$ and $|\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}z} j(t)| = |j'(t)||t|/(p|z|) \le C|z|^{1/p-1}/n$. Together with (60) and $\nu_p \le 1/p$, this is (O3). For $|z| \ge 1$ in $\mathcal{Z}_n$ we have $|t| \ge e^{-c_0}$, so $j(t)$ is bounded (by (57) for $|t| \ge 1$ and by continuity on the compact set $\{e^{-c_0} \le |t| \le 1,\ |\arg t| \le \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}/p\}$), and (60) gives (O4).

(O5). Fix n. Near 0 and outside the lens, $|\arg z| \ge \frac34 \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$, so $\kappa_\pm \to 1$ by (41) and $\tilde D \to 1$; K is bounded; and $\log B$ is bounded on $U(0, \delta)\setminus(-\delta, 0]$ uniformly up to the cut. For the last point split $\int \hat\ell(y)/(y - z)\,\mathrm{d}y$ into the window $|y - \operatorname{Re} z| \le |\operatorname{Re} z|/2$ and the rest. On the window write $\hat\ell(y) = \hat\ell(\operatorname{Re} z) + O(|y - \operatorname{Re} z|\,|\operatorname{Re} z|^{1/p-1})$ by (ii); the constant part integrates to $\hat\ell(\operatorname{Re} z)\operatorname{Log}(\cdot)$ with a bounded logarithm (the endpoints of the window are at comparable distances from z), and the rest is bounded; outside the window $|y - z| \ge c(|y| + |z|)$ and $|\hat\ell(y)| \le C|y|^{1/p}$ give a bounded contribution. In the lens, $\tilde F = \tilde D BK$ is bounded above and below by the same facts.

Near ∞, the same window argument on $(-\infty, -\frac{1}{2}]$, where $\hat{\ell}'$ is bounded, gives $|\log B(z)| \le C_n(1+\log|z|)$ for $|z| \ge 2$ off the cut. For $|z| \ge n^p + \delta'$ we have $|t| < 1$, and t stays away from 1, so D is bounded above and below by a power of $|z|$; hence $|F|^{\pm 1} \le C_n|z|^{m_n}$. Finally, along $z = iy$, $y \to \pm\infty$: by (58), $|D(iy)| = |t|^{-1/2}(2\pi)^{-1/2}(1+o(1)) \asymp |y|^{1/(2p)}$; $|K(iy)| \asymp |y|^{-1/2}$; and splitting $\hat{\ell} = (\pi/p - \pi)\mathbf{1}_{(-\infty,-1)} + e$, the first part contributes $-\frac{\pi/p-\pi}{2\pi}\operatorname{Log}\frac{z+1}{2}$ to $\log B$ (an explicit integral), while the second contributes a quantity with a finite limit, by dominated convergence and the integrability in (ii). So $|B(iy)| \asymp |y|^{\frac{1}{2}-\frac{1}{2p}}$, and $|F(iy)| \asymp 1$. □

6.2. **The case $p = 1$: reflection.** At $p = 1$ the cut of D disappears. This makes $p = 1$ a simplification of the case $p > 1$, not a special case.

Lemma 6.2 (Reflection)**.** *Let $p = 1$, so $t = n/z$. For $z \in \mathbb{C}_\pm$,*

$$D(z) = \frac{e^{-j(t)}}{1 - e^{\mp 2\pi i t}} = e^{j(-n/z)}. \tag{61}$$

Hence D extends analytically to $\mathbb{C}\setminus[0,\infty)$, and it is real and positive on $(-\infty, 0)$. The function $F := DK$ satisfies (O1)–(O5), with $\tilde{F} = \tilde{D}K$ and $H_n = e^{2j(n/z)}$.

Proof. Let $z \in \mathbb{C}_+$, so $\arg t \in (-\pi, 0)$ and $t \notin \mathbb{R}$. By DLMF 5.5.3 (T4), $1/\Gamma(t) = \Gamma(1-t)\sin(\pi t)/\pi$, and $\sin(\pi t)/(1-e^{-2\pi i t}) = e^{i\pi t}/(2i)$. Hence $D = \sqrt{2\pi}\, t^{t-1/2}e^{-t}\Gamma(1-t)e^{i\pi t}/(2\pi i)$. Put $u := -t = -n/z$; then $\arg u = \arg t + \pi \in (0,\pi)$, so $\ln u = \ln t + i\pi$ for the principal branches, and $t^{t-1/2}e^{i\pi t} = \exp((t-\frac{1}{2})(\ln u - i\pi) + i\pi t) = e^{i\pi/2}u^{-u-1/2}$. So $D = u^{-u-1/2}e^u\Gamma(1+u)/\sqrt{2\pi}$, and DLMF 5.5.1 ($\Gamma(1+u) = u\Gamma(u)$) together with the definition of j gives $D = e^{j(u)}$. For $z \in \mathbb{C}_-$ the same computation with $\sin(\pi t)/(1-e^{2\pi i t}) = -e^{-i\pi t}/(2i)$ and $\ln u = \ln t - i\pi$ gives the same result. Since j is analytic on $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty, 0]$ and $u \in (-\infty, 0]$ exactly when $z \in (0,\infty)$, $e^{j(-n/z)}$ is analytic on $\mathbb{C}\setminus[0,\infty)$; on $(-\infty, 0)$, $u > 0$ and $j(u)$ is real.

(O1). $F = DK$ is analytic and zero-free off $[0,\infty)$, and $F_+/F_- = (-e^{2i\theta})(-1)$ on $(4c,\infty)$ off the nodes, as for $p > 1$.

(O2). $\tilde{F} = F/\kappa_\pm = \tilde{D}K$ with $\tilde{D} = e^{-j(t)}$ analytic and zero-free on $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty, 0]$. So $H_n = \tilde{D}^{-2} = e^{2j(n/z)} > 0$ on $(0,\infty)$, and $H_n(0^+) = 1$.

(O3), (O4). On $\mathcal{Z}_n$, $|\arg t| = |\arg z| \le \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}} = 7\pi/16$. For $|z| \le 1$, $|t| \ge n$ and (57) gives $|\log H_n| = 2|j(t)| \le C|z|/n$ and $|(\log H_n)'| \le C/n$; since $\nu_1 = \frac{1}{2}$, this is (O3). For $|z| \ge 1$, $|t| \ge e^{-c_0}$ and $j(t)$ is bounded, which is (O4).

(O5). Fix n. Near 0 outside the lens, $u = -n/z$ has $|u| \to \infty$ and $|\arg u| = \pi - |\arg z| \le \pi - \frac{3}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$, so $j(u) \to 0$ by (57) and $D \to 1$; K is bounded. In the lens $\tilde{F} = \tilde{D}K$ with $\tilde{D} \to 1$. For $|z| \ge n + \delta'$ we have $|u| \le n/(n+\delta') < 1$ and $|1+u| \ge \delta'/(2n)$, and $D = u^{-u-1/2}e^u\Gamma(1+u)/\sqrt{2\pi}$ is bounded above and below by $C_n|z|^{\pm 1}$. Along $z = iy$, $D(iy) = (-iy/n)^{1/2}(2\pi)^{-1/2}(1+o(1))$ by (58), and $K(iy) = (-iy)^{-1/2}(1+o(1))$, so $F(iy) \to (2\pi n)^{-1/2}$. □

Remark 6.3 (The classical hard-edge parametrix at $p = 1$). For pure powers and $p \ne 1$, one can also build the hard-edge parametrix in the classical way, as in T2, from a square root $\tilde{W}$ of the band weight continued to a full neighbourhood of 0; for $p > 1$ its jump on $(-\delta, 0)$ is super-exponentially close to I, because $|e^{\mp 2i\theta}| = \exp(-2\pi n\sin(\pi/p)|x|^{-1/p})$ there. At $p = 1$ this particular construction fails, already for $\ell_1 \equiv 1$. On $(-\delta, 0)$, $\theta = \pi n/x$ is real, and the continuations of the lens scalar from the two half-planes differ by $\tilde{F}_+/\tilde{F}_- = (1-e^{-2i\theta})/(1-e^{2i\theta}) = -e^{-2i\theta}$ (because F has no jump there): a unimodular factor that is not close to 1. Moreover the continuation of $H_n = e^{2j(n/z)}$ across $(-\delta, 0)$ has double poles at the points $z = -n/m$, $m \in \mathbb{N}$, which accumulate at 0. Our route never uses this construction: the comparison parametrix of §7 uses only the Szegő function D_W of the band values, which

has no jump on $(-\delta, 0)$, and nothing is continued across $(-\delta, 0)$. The obstruction concerns this classical construction as written, not every quotient construction.

6.3. **The case $0 < p < 1$: seams.** For $p < 1$ the poles $t = -1, -2, \dots$ of Γ lie on the rays $\arg z = \pm\pi p$, inside the slit plane, and D has no useful continuation to the negative axis. We use D only in the inner sector, where $|\arg t| < \pi/2$, and an elementary function outside; a Cauchy integral χ over the two separating rays glues them together exactly. Put

$$\vartheta_{\text{seam}} := \tfrac{\pi p}{2}, \qquad S_{\text{in}} := \{z \neq 0 : \ |\arg z| < \vartheta_{\text{seam}}\}, \qquad S_{\text{out}} := \mathbb{C} \setminus (\overline{S_{\text{in}}} \cup \{0\}),$$
$$\Gamma_{\pm} := \{re^{\pm i\vartheta_{\text{seam}}} : \ r > 0\},$$

both seams oriented away from 0, and

$$\varpi := \tfrac{1}{2} - \tfrac{1}{2p} < 0, \qquad B_{\text{in}}(z) := (1+z)^{\varpi}, \qquad B_{\text{out}}(z) := \Big(1 - \frac{z}{2\pi n}\Big)^{1/2},$$

with principal powers; the cut $(-\infty, -1]$ of B_{in} lies in S_{out}, and the cut $[2\pi n, \infty)$ of B_{out} lies in S_{in}. The lens, the saturated regions and the top segment lie in $\mathcal{Z}_n \subset S_{\text{in}}$, since $\vartheta_{\text{w}} = 3\pi p/8 < \vartheta_{\text{seam}}$.

Lemma 6.4 (Seam scalar)**.** *Let $0 < p < 1$.*

(i) *On S_{in}, $|\arg t| < \pi/2$; $\tilde{D} = e^{-j(t)}$ is analytic and zero-free there, and $D = \kappa_{\pm}\tilde{D}$ is analytic and zero-free in $S_{\text{in}} \cap \mathbb{C}_{\pm}$.*

(ii) *On $\Gamma_{\pm}$ put, with principal logarithms,*

$$L_{\pm}(\zeta) := -j(t(\zeta)) - \operatorname{Log}\big(1 - e^{\mp 2\pi i t(\zeta)}\big) + \varpi \operatorname{Log}(1+\zeta) - \tfrac{1}{2}\operatorname{Log}\Big(1 - \frac{\zeta}{2\pi n}\Big). \tag{62}$$

Then $L_{\pm}$ is real-analytic on the open ray, $e^{L_{\pm}} = DB_{\text{in}}/B_{\text{out}}$ there, $L_{\pm}(\zeta) \to 0$ as $\zeta \to 0$, and $L_{\pm}(\zeta) = O\big(n|\zeta|^{-1/p}\log|\zeta| + n|\zeta|^{-1}\big)$ as $\zeta \to \infty$. In particular $L_{\pm}$ has no winding: it is the continuous logarithm of $DB_{\text{in}}/B_{\text{out}}$ that vanishes at both ends. Moreover $L_{-}(\bar{\zeta}) = \overline{L_{+}(\zeta)}$.

(iii) *The* seam scalar

$$\chi(z) := \frac{1}{2\pi i}\Big[\int_{\Gamma_+} \frac{L_+(\zeta)\,\mathrm{d}\zeta}{\zeta - z} - \int_{\Gamma_-} \frac{L_-(\zeta)\,\mathrm{d}\zeta}{\zeta - z}\Big] \tag{63}$$

is analytic off $\Gamma_+ \cup \Gamma_-$, real on $\mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\}$, tends to 0 at ∞, has continuous boundary values on the open seams, and $\chi_{\text{out}} - \chi_{\text{in}} = L_{\pm}$ on $\Gamma_{\pm}$, where "out" and "in" refer to the boundary values from S_{out} and S_{in}.

(iv) *The function*

$$F := DB_{\text{in}}Ke^{\chi} \text{ in } S_{\text{in}}, \qquad F := B_{\text{out}}Ke^{\chi} \text{ in } S_{\text{out}}, \tag{64}$$

extends analytically across $\Gamma_{\pm}$ and satisfies (O1)–(O5), with $\tilde{F} = \tilde{D}B_{\text{in}}Ke^{\chi}$ and $H_n = (\tilde{D}B_{\text{in}}e^{\chi})^{-2}$, $H_n(0^+) = e^{-2\chi(0)}$.

Proof. (i) $|\arg t| = |\arg z|/p < \pi/2$ on S_{in}, so $\Gamma(t)$ has no poles or zeros there; and $\pm\operatorname{Im}\theta < 0$ in $S_{\text{in}} \cap \mathbb{C}_{\pm}$ by (41).

(ii) Each term of (62) is continuous on the open ray Γ_+: j is analytic off $(-\infty, 0]$; $\arg t = -\pi/2$, so $e^{-2\pi i t} = e^{-2\pi|t|} \in (0,1)$; $1 + \zeta \notin (-\infty, 0]$ since $\arg\zeta \in (0, \pi)$; and $1 - \zeta/(2\pi n)$ has non-zero imaginary part. The exponential of the sum is $\tilde{D}\kappa_+ B_{\text{in}}/B_{\text{out}}$. As $\zeta \to 0$, $|t| \to \infty$

and each term tends to 0 (by (57) for j). As $\zeta \to \infty$, $t \to 0$ and, by (58), using $\arg t = -\pi/2$, $\arg\zeta = \vartheta_{\text{seam}}$ and $\operatorname{Log} t = \log n - \frac{1}{p}\operatorname{Log}\zeta$:

$$\begin{aligned} -j(t) &= \tfrac{1}{2}\operatorname{Log} t + \tfrac{1}{2}\log(2\pi) + O(|t|\log(2/|t|)),\\ -\operatorname{Log}(1-e^{-2\pi i t}) &= -\log(2\pi) - \operatorname{Log} t - \tfrac{i\pi}{2} + O(|t|),\\ \varpi\operatorname{Log}(1+\zeta) &= \varpi\operatorname{Log}\zeta + O(|\zeta|^{-1}),\\ -\tfrac{1}{2}\operatorname{Log}\big(1-\tfrac{\zeta}{2\pi n}\big) &= -\tfrac{1}{2}\operatorname{Log}\zeta + \tfrac{1}{2}\log(2\pi n) + \tfrac{i\pi}{2} + O(n|\zeta|^{-1}); \end{aligned}$$

the second line uses $1-e^{-2\pi i t} = 2\pi i t(1+O(t))$ and $\arg(it) = 0$, the last uses $\arg(-\zeta/(2\pi n)) = \vartheta_{\text{seam}} - \pi \in (-\pi, 0)$. The sum of the main terms is $-\frac{1}{2}\operatorname{Log} t + \frac{1}{2}\log n + (\varpi - \frac{1}{2})\operatorname{Log}\zeta = \big(\frac{1}{2p} + \varpi - \frac{1}{2}\big)\operatorname{Log}\zeta = 0$. The symmetry follows from $\overline{t(\bar\zeta)} = t(\zeta)$ and the reality of j.

(iii) By (ii), $L_\pm(\zeta)/\zeta$ is integrable on $\Gamma_\pm$ near 0 and $L_\pm(\zeta)/\zeta$ is integrable at ∞ (since $1/p > 1$), so the integrals converge and $\chi \to 0$ at ∞. The Sokhotski–Plemelj formula gives the jumps: Γ_+ is oriented outwards with S_{out} on its left, so $\chi_{\text{out}} - \chi_{\text{in}} = L_+$; on Γ_- the left side is S_{in} and the density carries a minus sign, so again $\chi_{\text{out}} - \chi_{\text{in}} = L_-$. Reality on $\mathbb{R}$ follows from the symmetry in (ii).

(iv) On $\Gamma_\pm$, $F_{\text{in}}/F_{\text{out}} = DB_{\text{in}}e^{\chi_{\text{in}}}/(B_{\text{out}}e^{\chi_{\text{out}}}) = e^{L_\pm}e^{-L_\pm} = 1$, so F is continuous, hence analytic, across the seams.

(O1). In S_{out} every factor is analytic and zero-free, and $(-\infty, 0) \subset S_{\text{out}}$. In $S_{\text{in}} \setminus [0,\infty)$ the same holds by (i). On $(4c, \infty)$, B_{in} and χ are analytic, so $F_+/F_- = (-e^{2i\theta})(-1)$.

(O2). $\tilde F = \tilde D B_{\text{in}} K e^{\chi}$ on $S_{\text{in}} \supset \mathcal{Z}_n$, analytic and zero-free off $[4c,\infty)$, with $\tilde F_+ = -\tilde F_-$ there. $H_n = (\tilde D B_{\text{in}} e^{\chi})^{-2} > 0$ on $(0,\infty)$ by (iii), and $H_n(0^+) = e^{-2\chi(0)}$, where $\chi(0) := \lim_{z\to 0}\chi(z)$ exists by Lemma 6.5.

(O3), (O4). Points of $\mathcal{Z}_n$ satisfy $|\arg z| \le 3\pi p/8$, hence $\operatorname{dist}(z, \Gamma_+ \cup \Gamma_-) \ge \sin(\pi p/8)|z|$. So Lemma 6.5(ii) applies with $\kappa = \sin(\pi p/8)$. For $|z| \le 1$: $|\log H_n - \log H_n(0^+)| \le 2(|j(t)| + |\varpi||\operatorname{Log}(1+z)| + |\chi - \chi(0)|) \le C(|z|^{1/p}/n + |z| + |z|(1 + \log\frac{1}{|z|})) \le C|z|^{1/2}$, and similarly $|(\log H_n)'| \le C(|z|^{1/p-1}/n + 1 + \log\frac{1}{|z|}) \le C|z|^{-1/2}$. Since $\nu_p = \frac{1}{2}$, this is (O3). For $|z| \ge 1$ in $\mathcal{Z}_n$, $j(t)$ is bounded, $|\operatorname{Log}(1+z)| \le C(1+\log|z|)$, and $|\chi - \chi(0)| \le C(1+\log|z|)^2$ by Lemma 6.5(ii); this is (O4).

(O5). Fix n. Near 0: in S_{in} outside the lens, $\kappa_\pm \to 1$ (as $\frac{3}{4}\vartheta_{\text{lip}}/p = 3\pi/16$ bounds $|\arg t|$ from below) and $\tilde D, B_{\text{in}} \to 1$; in S_{out}, $B_{\text{out}} \to 1$; K is bounded; and χ is bounded near 0 uniformly up to the seams by Lemma 6.5(iii). In the lens, $\tilde F$ is bounded above and below by the same facts. Near ∞: in S_{out} (which contains the imaginary axis, as $\vartheta_{\text{seam}} < \pi/2$), $F = B_{\text{out}}Ke^{\chi} \to (2\pi n)^{-1/2}$, because $B_{\text{out}}(z)K(z) = \big(\frac{-z}{2\pi n}\big)^{1/2}(-z)^{-1/2}(1+o(1))$ with consistent principal branches in S_{out}. In $S_{\text{in}} \cap \{|z| \ge n^p + \delta'\}$, $|t| < 1$ and t stays away from 1, so D, B_{in}, K and e^{χ} are bounded above and below by powers of $|z|$. □

The seams carry no weight: $L_\pm$ and χ are built from j, $e^{\mp 2\pi i t}$, B_{in} and B_{out} only, and F has no jump across them. Neither V nor Q has a jump on the seams, and the comparison parametrix of §7 has none either, since it is built from D_W. The only trace of the seams in the hard-edge analysis is the factor $e^{-2\chi}$ in H_n, which is controlled by the following lemma.

Lemma 6.5 (Corner modulus of the seam scalar)**.** *Let $0 < p < 1$ and $\kappa \in (0,1)$. There are $C = C(p,\kappa)$ and n_0 such that for $n \ge n_0$:*

(i) *$|L_\pm(\zeta)| \le C|\zeta|$ for $\zeta \in \Gamma_\pm$, $|\zeta| \le 1$; $|L_\pm(\zeta)| \le C(1+\log|\zeta|)$ for $|\zeta| \ge 1$; and $|L_\pm'(\zeta)| \le C$ for $|\zeta| \le 2$.*

(ii) *For z with $\operatorname{dist}(z,\Gamma_+\cup\Gamma_-)\ge\kappa|z|$: $|\chi(z)-\chi(0)|\le C|z|(1+\log\frac{1}{|z|})$ and $|\chi'(z)|\le C(1+\log\frac{1}{|z|})$ if $|z|\le 1$, and $|\chi(z)-\chi(0)|\le C(1+\log|z|)^2$ if $|z|\ge 1$. Here $\chi(0):=\frac{1}{2\pi i}\big[\int_{\Gamma_+}L_+(\zeta)\frac{\mathrm{d}\zeta}{\zeta}-\int_{\Gamma_-}L_-(\zeta)\frac{\mathrm{d}\zeta}{\zeta}\big]$.*

(iii) *For each fixed n, χ is bounded on $U(0,1)\setminus(\Gamma_+\cup\Gamma_-)$, uniformly up to the seams.*

Proof. (i) On Γ_+, $t=-i|t|$ with $|t|=n|\zeta|^{-1/p}$. If $|\zeta|\le 1$, then $|t|\ge n$; by (57) with $\vartheta=\pi/2$, $|j(t)|\le\frac{1}{6|t|}\le|\zeta|^{1/p}/n\le|\zeta|$; $|\operatorname{Log}(1-e^{-2\pi|t|})|\le 2e^{-2\pi n|\zeta|^{-1/p}}\le C|\zeta|$; $|\varpi\operatorname{Log}(1+\zeta)|\le C|\zeta|$; $|\operatorname{Log}(1-\zeta/(2\pi n))|\le C|\zeta|/n$. If $|\zeta|\ge 1$ and $|t|\ge 1$, then $|j(t)|\le\frac{1}{6}$; if $|t|<1$, then (58) (with a bounded remainder on $\{|t|\le 1,\operatorname{Re}t\ge 0\}$) and $|\log|t||\le\frac{1}{p}\log|\zeta|$ give $|j(t)|\le C(1+\log|\zeta|)$. Next $|\operatorname{Log}(1-e^{-2\pi|t|})|\le C(1+|\log|t||)\le C(1+\log|\zeta|)$, since $1-e^{-y}\ge(1-e^{-2\pi})y/(2\pi)$ for $0<y\le 2\pi$. Finally $|1-\zeta/(2\pi n)|$ lies between $\sin\vartheta_{\mathrm{seam}}$ and $1+|\zeta|$, because $\zeta/(2\pi n)$ lies on the ray of angle $\vartheta_{\mathrm{seam}}\in(0,\pi/2)$. For the derivative on $|\zeta|\le 2$ (where $|t|\ge n2^{-1/p}\ge 1$): $\frac{\mathrm{d}}{\mathrm{d}\zeta}j(t)=-j'(t)t/(p\zeta)=O(|t|^{-1}|\zeta|^{-1})=O(|\zeta|^{1/p-1}/n)$, which is bounded since $1/p>1$; the derivative of $\operatorname{Log}(1-e^{-2\pi it})$ is $O(|t||\zeta|^{-1}e^{-2\pi|t|})$, also bounded; the other two terms have bounded derivatives. Γ_- follows by conjugation.

(ii) For $z\notin\Gamma_\pm$, $\chi(z)-\chi(0)=\frac{z}{2\pi i}\sum_\pm(\pm1)\int_{\Gamma_\pm}\frac{L_\pm(\zeta)\,\mathrm{d}\zeta}{\zeta(\zeta-z)}$ and $\chi'(z)=\frac{1}{2\pi i}\sum_\pm(\pm1)\int_{\Gamma_\pm}\frac{L_\pm(\zeta)\,\mathrm{d}\zeta}{(\zeta-z)^2}$. Under the hypothesis, $|\zeta-z|\ge\kappa|z|$, and $|\zeta-z|\ge|\zeta|/2$ if $|\zeta|\ge 2|z|$; hence $|\zeta-z|\ge\frac{\kappa}{3}(|\zeta|+|z|)$. With (i), for $|z|\le 1$,

$$|\chi(z)-\chi(0)|\le C|z|\Big[\int_0^1\frac{\mathrm{d}\rho}{\rho+|z|}+\int_1^\infty\frac{1+\log\rho}{\rho^2}\,\mathrm{d}\rho\Big]\le C|z|\big(1+\log\tfrac{1}{|z|}\big),$$

and $|\chi'(z)|\le C[\int_0^1\rho(\rho+|z|)^{-2}\,\mathrm{d}\rho+\int_1^\infty(1+\log\rho)\rho^{-2}\,\mathrm{d}\rho]\le C(1+\log\frac{1}{|z|})$. For $|z|\ge 1$ the same splitting gives $|z|\int_0^1\frac{\mathrm{d}\rho}{|z|}+|z|\int_1^\infty\frac{(1+\log\rho)\,\mathrm{d}\rho}{\rho(\rho+|z|)}\le C(1+\log|z|)^2$.

(iii) Let $z\in U(0,1)$ be close to Γ_+, with nearest point $z^*\in\Gamma_+$, $r:=|z^*|$ (other z are covered by (ii)). Split $\int_{\Gamma_+}L_+(\zeta)\frac{\mathrm{d}\zeta}{\zeta-z}$ into the part $|\zeta-z^*|\le r/2$ and the rest. On the first part write $L_+(\zeta)=L_+(z^*)+O(|\zeta-z^*|)$ by (i): the constant contributes $L_+(z^*)$ times a logarithm whose modulus is at most $\pi+\log C$, because the two endpoints $z^*\pm\frac{r}{2}e^{i\vartheta_{\mathrm{seam}}}$ are at comparable distances from z; since $|L_+(z^*)|\le Cr$, this is bounded, and so is the Lipschitz part. On the rest, $|\zeta-z|\ge c(|\zeta|+r)$, and the contribution is at most $C\int_{\Gamma_+}|L_+(\zeta)|(|\zeta|+r)^{-1}|\,\mathrm{d}\zeta|$, which is finite for fixed n because $L_+(\zeta)=O(|\zeta|)$ at 0 and $L_+(\zeta)/\zeta$ is integrable at ∞ (Lemma 6.4(ii)). The integral over Γ_- is bounded in the same way, since $|\zeta-z|\ge c(|\zeta|+|z|)$ for $\zeta\in\Gamma_-$. □

6.4. **Common steps: Szegő functions, normalisation, parametrices.** From now on F is the outer scalar of Lemma 6.1, 6.2 or 6.4, according to p. Everything in this subsection uses only (O1)–(O5).

Szegő functions. Let $\mathcal{R}(z):=(z(z-4c))^{1/2}$, analytic off $[0,4c]$ with $\mathcal{R}(z)\sim z$ at ∞, so that $\mathcal{R}_\pm(x)=\pm i\sqrt{x(4c-x)}$ on $(0,4c)$. For a function $q=c_qq_0$ on $(0,4c)$ with $c_q\in\mathbb{C}\setminus\{0\}$, $q_0>0$ and $\log q_0\in L^1(\mathrm{d}x/\sqrt{x(4c-x)})$, put (with a fixed value of $\log c_q$)

$$D_q(z):=\exp\Big(\frac{\mathcal{R}(z)}{2\pi}\int_0^{4c}\frac{\log q(x)}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}}\frac{\mathrm{d}x}{z-x}\Big),\qquad D_q(\infty)=\exp\Big(\frac{1}{2\pi}\int_0^{4c}\frac{\log q(x)\,\mathrm{d}x}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}}\Big).\tag{65}$$

D_q is analytic and zero-free off $[0,4c]$, $D_{q_1q_2}=D_{q_1}D_{q_2}$, and $D_{c_q}=c_q^{1/2}$. Where $\log q_0$ is Hölder continuous, the Sokhotski–Plemelj formula and $\mathcal{R}_+=-\mathcal{R}_-$ give $D_{q,+}D_{q,-}=q$. Since $\frac{1}{\pi}\int_0^{4c}\frac{\mathrm{d}x}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}(z-x)}=\frac{1}{\mathcal{R}(z)}$ (the Stieltjes transform of the arcsine law, as in the proof of

Lemma 5.3), we have for every $z \notin [0,4c]$ and every number Θ

$$\log D_q(z)^2 - \Theta = \frac{\mathcal{R}(z)}{\pi} \int_0^{4c} \frac{(\log q(x) - \Theta)\,\mathrm{d}x}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}\,(z-x)}. \tag{66}$$

We use it with $\Theta = \log q(z)$, the value of an analytic continuation of $\log q$. Put $\eta_* := \min(1, 2c)$ and $Z(r) := \{z :\ 0 < |z| < r,\ |\arg z| < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}\}$.

The band weight and its Szegő function. Let W_0 be the band weight (54), $D_W := D_{W_0}$ and $D_\infty := D_W(\infty)$. Writing $\mathcal{H}_n := H_n/H_n(0^+)$,

$$D_W = \big(C_n H_n(0^+)\big)^{1/2}\, D_{x^\alpha}\, D_{4c-x}\, D_{\mathcal{H}_n}\, D_{r_n}. \tag{67}$$

All factors are defined: $\log \mathcal{H}_n$ is bounded on $(0,4c)$ by (O3)–(O4), and $|\log r_n(x)| \le C\varepsilon_\Lambda(T)(1+|\log x|)$ by Lemma 5.6(iii). The constant $C_n H_n(0^+)$ cancels in the ratio

$$\omega(z) := \frac{D_W(z)^2}{W_0(z)} = \frac{D_{x^\alpha}^2}{z^\alpha} \cdot \frac{D_{4c-x}^2}{4c-z} \cdot \frac{D_{\mathcal{H}_n}^2}{\mathcal{H}_n} \cdot \frac{D_{r_n}^2}{r_n}, \tag{68}$$

defined wherever W_0 is, i.e. on $\mathcal{Z}_n \setminus [0,4c]$.

Lemma 6.6 (Szegő function estimates)**.** *The constants below depend only on c, the stated M, and ε_1 in (iv).*

(i) *With $\Phi(z) := 2z - 4c + 2\mathcal{R}(z)$ and principal powers, $D_{x^\alpha}(z)^2 = (4cz/\Phi(z))^\alpha$ and $D_{4c-x}(z)^2 = 4c(z-4c)/\Phi(z)$. Φ is analytic and zero-free off $[0,4c]$, with continuous non-zero boundary values, $\Phi(0) = -4c$, $\Phi(4c) = 4c$. In particular $|D_{x^\alpha}(z)^2| \asymp |z|^\alpha$ and $|D_{4c-x}(z)^2| \asymp |z-4c|$ for $|z| \le 8c$, $z \notin [0,4c]$.*

(ii) *(Hölder type at 0.) Let $\nu \in (0,1]$, $M \ge 0$, $\Theta_0 \in \mathbb{C}$. Suppose $\log q$ continues analytically to $Z(\eta_*)$ and continuously to $(0,\eta_*)$, with $|\log q(z) - \Theta_0| \le M|z|^\nu$ and $|(\log q)'(z)| \le M|z|^{\nu-1}$ there, and $|\log q(x) - \Theta_0| \le M(1+|\log(4c-x)|)$ for $\frac12\eta_* \le x < 4c$. Then for $z \in Z(\frac14\eta_*) \setminus (0,\infty)$,*

$$|\log D_q(z)^2 - \log q(z)| \le CM|z|^{\min(\nu,1/2)} \log(2/|z|).$$

(iii) *(Logarithmic type at 0.) Suppose $\log q$ continues analytically to $Z(\eta_*)$ and continuously to $(0,\eta_*)$, with $|(\log q)'(z)| \le M/|z|$ there and $|\log q(x) - \log q(z)| \le M(1+|\log(x/|z|)|)$ for $z \in Z(\eta_*)$, $x \in (0,4c)$. Then $|\log D_q(z)^2 - \log q(z)| \le CM$ for $z \in Z(\frac14\eta_*) \setminus (0,\infty)$.*

(iv) *(Near 4c.) Suppose $\log q$ continues analytically to $U(4c, 2\varepsilon_1)$, with $|\log q - \Theta_1| \le M$ there and $|\log q(x) - \Theta_1| \le M(1+|\log x|)$ on $(0,4c)$. Then $|\log D_q(z)^2 - \log q(z)| \le CM$ for $z \in U(4c,\varepsilon_1) \setminus [0,4c]$.*

(v) *(Away from the band.) If $|\log q(x) - \Theta_1| \le M(1 + |\log x| + |\log(4c-x)|)$ on $(0,4c)$, then $|\log D_q(z)^2 - \Theta_1| \le C_d M$ for $\operatorname{dist}(z,[0,4c]) \ge d$.*

(vi) *(The band weight.) For $n \ge n_0$, with C independent of n: (a) $|\omega(z)|^{\pm1} \le C$ for $z \in Z(\frac14\eta_*) \setminus (0,\infty)$, in particular on the lips in $U(0,\delta)$; (b) $|\omega(z)|^{\pm1} \le C$ for $z \in U(4c,\varepsilon)\setminus[0,4c]$; (c) $|\log\omega(z)| \le C_d\big(1+\log(1+|z|)\big)^2$ for $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$ with $\operatorname{dist}(z,[0,4c]) \ge d$. Moreover, for each fixed n, $|D_W(z)|^{\pm1} \le C_{n,\eta}|z|^{\pm\alpha/2-\eta}$ for every $\eta > 0$ and $0 < |z| < \frac14\eta_*$, $z \notin [0,\infty)$.*

Proof. (i) Write $\Phi = z(1+w)^2$ with $w := \mathcal{R}(z)/z = \sqrt{1-4c/z}$, which has $\operatorname{Re} w > 0$ off $[0,4c]$. Then $4cz/\Phi = 4c/(1+w)^2$ and $4c(z-4c)/\Phi = 4c\,(w/(1+w))^2$; both $1/(1+w)$ and $w/(1+w)$ lie in the disc $|\cdot - \frac12| < \frac12$, so their squares avoid $(-\infty,0]$ and the principal powers are analytic off $[0,4c]$. On the band, $\Phi_\pm = (\sqrt{x} \pm i\sqrt{4c-x})^2$, so $\Phi_+\Phi_- = 16c^2$, the two boundary values of each expression are complex conjugates, and the product of their principal powers is $x^{2\alpha}$, respectively $(4c-x)^2$. The expressions tend to c at ∞. Hence they are the Szegő functions

squared (the quotient of two functions with the same jump, bounded at ∞ and of at most logarithmic growth at 0 and $4c$, is constant). The values of Φ at 0 and $4c$ are read off.

(ii) Fix $z \in Z(\frac14\eta_*) \setminus (0,\infty)$ and use (66) with $\Theta = \log q(z)$. Note $|\mathcal{R}(z)| \le C|z|^{1/2}$. Split $(0,4c)$ into $N_z := \{x : |x-z| < \frac12|z|\}$ and the rest. For $x \in N_z$ the segment $[x,z]$ lies in $Z(\eta_*)$ (the sector is convex since $\vartheta_{\mathrm w} < \pi/2$) and at distance $\ge \frac12|z|$ from 0, so $|\log q(x) - \log q(z)| \le M(|z|/2)^{\nu-1}|x-z|$, and the contribution is at most $C|z|^{1/2}M|z|^{\nu-1}\int_{N_z} x^{-1/2}\,\mathrm dx \le CM|z|^\nu$. Off N_z, $|x-z| \ge \frac18(x+|z|)$ (if $x \le 3|z|$ then $|x-z| \ge \frac12|z|$; otherwise $|x-z| \ge x-|z| \ge \frac12 x$). On $(0,\frac12\eta_*)$ we have $|\log q(x) - \log q(z)| \le M(x^\nu + |z|^\nu)$, and

$$|z|^{1/2}\int_0^{\eta_*/2} \frac{M(x^\nu+|z|^\nu)\,\mathrm dx}{x^{1/2}(x+|z|)} \le CM|z|^{\min(\nu,1/2)}\log(2/|z|),$$

by the substitution $x = |z|u$: the term $|z|^\nu$ gives $CM|z|^\nu$; the term x^ν gives $CM|z|^\nu$ if $\nu < \frac12$, $CM|z|^{1/2}\log(2/|z|)$ if $\nu = \frac12$, and $CM|z|^{1/2}$ if $\nu > \frac12$. On $[\frac12\eta_*, 4c)$, $|x-z| \ge \frac14\eta_*$ and $\int(1+|\log(4c-x)|)(4c-x)^{-1/2}\,\mathrm dx < \infty$ give $CM|z|^{1/2}$.

(iii) The same splitting. On N_z the derivative bound gives $|\log q(x) - \log q(z)| \le 2M|x-z|/|z|$ and a contribution CM. Off N_z the contribution is at most $CM|z|^{1/2}\int_0^{4c} \frac{(1+|\log(x/|z|)|)\,\mathrm dx}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}\,(x+|z|)}$, and the substitution $x = |z|u$ bounds the part $x \le 2c$ by $CM\int_0^\infty(1+|\log u|)u^{-1/2}(1+u)^{-1}\,\mathrm du$; the part $x \ge 2c$ is $O(M|z|^{1/2}\log(2/|z|))$.

(iv) By Cauchy's estimate $|(\log q)'| \le 2M/\varepsilon_1$ on $U(4c, \frac32\varepsilon_1)$. For $x \in (4c - \frac32\varepsilon_1, 4c)$ and $z \in U(4c,\varepsilon_1)$, $|\log q(x) - \log q(z)| \le CM|x-z|$, which cancels the kernel's singularity, and $\int(4c-x)^{-1/2}\,\mathrm dx < \infty$. For $x \le 4c - \frac32\varepsilon_1$, $|z-x| \ge \frac12\varepsilon_1$ and the integrand is $\le CM(1+|\log x|)x^{-1/2}$.

(v) In (66) with $\Theta = \Theta_1$, $|\mathcal{R}(z)/(z-x)| \le C_d$ for all $x \in [0,4c]$ when $\operatorname{dist}(z,[0,4c]) \ge d$, and the remaining integral is finite.

(vi)(a) Use the four factors of (68). The first two are bounded above and below by Lemma 6.6(i), since z^α and $(4cz/\Phi)^\alpha$ differ by a bounded factor $(4c/\Phi)^\alpha e^{2\pi i k\alpha}$. The third is bounded by Lemma 6.6(ii) with $q = \mathcal{H}_n$, $\Theta_0 = 0$, $\nu = \nu_p$ and $M = C$ from (O3)–(O4). The fourth is bounded by Lemma 6.6(iii) with $q = r_n$: by Lemma 5.6(iii) with $R = 4c$, the hypotheses hold with $M = C\varepsilon_\Lambda(\log n - \frac1p\log(4c)) \le C$, and $|(\log r_n)'(z)| = |\Lambda'(\xi)|/(p|z|)$. (b) $D^2_{4c-x}/(4c-z) = -4c/\Phi$ is bounded above and below near $4c$ by Lemma 6.6(i). For $q_1 := x^\alpha\mathcal{H}_n r_n$, Lemma 6.6(iv) applies with $M = C$: near $4c$, $\mathcal{H}_n$ and r_n are analytic with $|\log\mathcal{H}_n| \le C$ and $|\log r_n| \le C$ (O4, Lemma 5.6(iii)). (c) Lemma 6.6(v) with $q = W_0/(C_nH_n(0^+))$ bounds $\log D_W^2 - \log(C_nH_n(0^+))$, and $|\log(W_0(z)/(C_nH_n(0^+)))| \le C(1+\log(1+|z|))^2$ on $\mathcal{Z}_n$ by (O3), (O4) and Lemma 5.6(iii) with $R = e^{pc_0}n^p$ (here $|\log r_n(z)| \le \frac1p\varepsilon_\Lambda(-c_0)(\vartheta_{\mathrm w} + |\log|z||)$). For the last claim, fix n and $\eta > 0$. By Lemma 5.6(i), $|\log r_n(x)| \le C_{n,\eta} + \eta|\log x|$ for $x \in (0,4c)$, and $|r_n(z)|^{\pm1} \le C_{n,\eta}|z|^{-\eta}$ for $z \in \mathcal{Z}_n$. For $|\arg z| < \vartheta_{\mathrm w}$ the claim follows from (a) and $|W_0| \asymp |z|^\alpha|r_n|$. For $|\arg z| \ge \frac12\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$ we have $|x-z| \ge c'(x+|z|)$ for $x > 0$, and (66) with $\Theta = 0$ gives $|\log D_{\mathcal{H}_n}(z)| \le C$ and $|\log D_{r_n}(z)^2| \le C|z|^{1/2}\int_0^{4c} \frac{C_{n,\eta}+\eta|\log x|}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}(x+|z|)}\,\mathrm dx \le C_{n,\eta} + C\eta\log\frac{1}{|z|}$; together with (i) for D_{x^α} and D_{4c-x} this gives the claim (after renaming η). □

The global parametrix. Let $a(z) := ((z-4c)/z)^{1/4}$, analytic off $[0,4c]$ with $a(\infty) = 1$, and

$$P_0^\infty(z) := \begin{pmatrix} \frac{a+a^{-1}}{2} & \frac{a-a^{-1}}{2i} \\ -\frac{a-a^{-1}}{2i} & \frac{a+a^{-1}}{2} \end{pmatrix}, \qquad P^\infty := D_\infty^{\sigma_3}P_0^\infty D_W^{-\sigma_3}. \tag{69}$$

Then $\det P_0^\infty = 1$, $P_{0,+}^\infty = P_{0,-}^\infty J$ on $(0,4c)$ with $J = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ (because $a_+ = ia_-$ there), and $P_0^\infty(z) = I + O(1/z)$. Since $|a(z)|^{\pm 1} = |z-4c|^{\pm 1/4}|z|^{\mp 1/4}$,

$$|P_0^\infty(z)| \le C|z|^{-1/4}|z-4c|^{-1/4}(1+|z|)^{1/2}. \tag{70}$$

As $D_{W,+}D_{W,-} = W_0$, P^∞ has the band jump of V (Lemma 5.7(a)). In the frame of $Q := D_\infty^{-\sigma_3} V D_W^{\sigma_3}$ the global parametrix is P_0^∞, which does not involve the weight.

Lemma 6.7 (Normalisation at infinity)**.** *Let $\kappa_\infty(z) := F(z)^{-1} e^{n(g(z)-\operatorname{Log} z)}$ for $|z| > n^p + \delta'$, $z \notin \mathbb{R}$. Then κ_∞ extends to an analytic function on $\{|z| > n^p+\delta'\} \cup \{\infty\}$ with $\kappa_\infty(\infty) \neq 0$. With $C_\infty := \kappa_\infty(\infty)^{\sigma_3}$ in (50), $V(z) = I + O(1/z)$ and $Q(z) = I + O(1/z)$ as $z \to \infty$, and for $|z| > n^p + \delta' + h_0$*

$$Q(z) = k_\infty^{-\sigma_3}\big(U(z) z^{-n\sigma_3}\big) k(z)^{\sigma_3}, \qquad k := \frac{e^{n\gamma_p} D_W}{\kappa_\infty}, \tag{71}$$

where k is analytic at ∞ with $k_\infty := k(\infty) = e^{n\gamma_p} D_\infty / \kappa_\infty(\infty) \neq 0$.

Proof. On $(-\infty, -n^p - \delta')$, g and $\operatorname{Log} z$ both jump by $2\pi i$ and F has no jump (O1). On $(n^p+\delta', \infty)$, $e^{n(g-\operatorname{Log} z)}$ jumps by $e^{2\pi i n \mu^*((x,\infty))} = e^{2i\theta}$ (Lemma 5.3(i)) and so does F (O1). So κ_∞ has continuous boundary values that agree, and is analytic in $\{|z| > n^p+\delta'\}$ by Morera's theorem. By Lemma 5.3(ii) and (O5), $|\kappa_\infty(z)| \le C_n |z|^{m_n}$, so ∞ is at most a pole; since $\kappa_\infty(iy)$ is bounded and bounded away from 0 as $y \to \pm\infty$, it is a removable singularity and $\kappa_\infty(\infty) \neq 0$.

In Ω_∞, by (51), $V = C_\infty e^{-n\gamma_p\sigma_3}(Uz^{-n\sigma_3})(z^n e^{n\varphi} F)^{\sigma_3}$, and $z^n e^{n\varphi} F = e^{n\gamma_p} e^{-n(g-\operatorname{Log} z)} F = e^{n\gamma_p}/\kappa_\infty$. Hence $V = \kappa_\infty(\infty)^{\sigma_3} e^{-n\gamma_p\sigma_3}(Uz^{-n\sigma_3}) e^{n\gamma_p\sigma_3} \kappa_\infty^{-\sigma_3} = I + O(1/z)$, by Lemma 5.1. Multiplying by $D_\infty^{-\sigma_3}$ on the left and $D_W^{\sigma_3}$ on the right gives (71), and $D_W(z)/D_\infty = 1 + O(1/z)$ gives $Q = I + O(1/z)$. □

Lemma 6.8 (Lip exponentials and super-small entries)**.** *Let $s_p := \sin(\frac{3}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}/p) > 0$. For $n \ge n_0$ and $z \in \Sigma_{\mathrm{lip}}^\pm \cap U(0,\delta)$:*

(a) $|\kappa_\pm(z) - 1| \le 2\exp(-2\pi s_p n |z|^{-1/p})$;
(b) $|e^{-2n\tilde\varphi(z)}| \le \exp(-\pi s_p n |z|^{-1/p})$;
(c) $|e^{2n\varphi(z)}| \le \exp(-c_f n |z|^{1/2})$, *with* $c_f := 2\sin(\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}/2) \inf_{U(0,\delta)} |f(z)/z|^{1/2} > 0$.

Proof. On these lips $\frac{3}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} \le |\arg z| \le \frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$ (§5.6), and $\frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}/p < \pi/2$ in all cases, so $\sin(|\arg z|/p) \ge s_p$. (a) follows from (41) and $|\kappa_\pm - 1| = |e^{\mp 2i\theta}|/|1 - e^{\mp 2i\theta}|$. (b) $e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} = e^{-2n\varphi} e^{\mp 2i\theta}$ and $|\operatorname{Re}\varphi| \le C|z|^{1/2}$ (Lemma 5.4(iii)), so $|e^{-2n\tilde\varphi}| \le \exp(2Cn|z|^{1/2} - 2\pi s_p n |z|^{-1/p})$, and $2C|z|^{1/2} \le \pi s_p |z|^{-1/p}$ for $|z| \le \delta$ small. (c) By Lemma 5.4(iii), $\operatorname{Re}\varphi = -2\operatorname{Re} f^{1/2}$, and on the lip $\arg f = \mp(\pi - \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$, so $\operatorname{Re} f^{1/2} = |f|^{1/2}\sin(\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}/2)$. □

The soft edge. In $U(4c,\varepsilon)$ the jumps of Q are, by Lemma 5.7(a), (c), (d) and the conjugation by $D_W^{\sigma_3}$: J on $(4c-\varepsilon, 4c)$, $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \omega e^{2n\tilde\varphi} & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ on $(4c, 4c+\varepsilon)$ and $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & -\omega^{-1} e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ on $\Sigma_v^\pm$, with $\omega = D_W^2/W_0$ as in (68). This is the jump structure of T1(c) ([19, (6.4)]), in which their $w_0/\tilde D^2 = \tilde w/\tilde D^2$ plays the role of our W_0 (in the frame of V), and $\tilde\varphi$ is the same soft-edge phase, $\tilde\varphi = -\frac{2}{3} f_r^{3/2}$ with f_r conformal and independent of n (Lemma 5.4(iv)). The only hypotheses of that construction are that the scalar data are analytic and zero-free in the disc; here ω is analytic in $U(4c, 2\varepsilon) \setminus [4c - 2\varepsilon, 4c]$, satisfies $\omega_+\omega_- = 1$ on the band and is bounded above and below uniformly in n (Lemma 6.6(vi)(b)), and W, $\tilde F$ are analytic and zero-free in $U(4c, 2\varepsilon)$ with n-uniform bounds after division by constants ((O2)–(O4), Lemma 5.6(iii)). Written in the frame of Q,

the construction of T1(c) reads

$$\hat P_r(z) = A_r(z)\, n^{\sigma_3/6} M_{r,n}(z), \qquad A_r := P_0^\infty\, \omega^{-\sigma_3/2} N_r^{-1} f_r^{\sigma_3/4}, \tag{72}$$
$$M_{r,n}(z) := \Psi_r\big(n^{2/3} f_r(z)\big)\big(\omega(z)^{1/2} e^{n\tilde\varphi(z)}\big)^{\sigma_3},$$

where Ψ_r is the Airy model matrix of T1(c) ([19, (6.12)], there written $\sigma_2\Psi\sigma_2$), with the sectorial constants and the branch of $\omega^{1/2}$ chosen as there, and N_r is the constant matrix in its expansion $\Psi_r(\zeta) = \zeta^{-\sigma_3/4} N_r (I + O(\zeta^{-3/2})) e^{\frac{2}{3}\zeta^{3/2}\sigma_3}$. Since $\frac{2}{3}(n^{2/3}f_r)^{3/2} = -n\tilde\varphi$, the exponentials cancel in $M_{r,n}$ for $|n^{2/3}f_r| \ge 2$, which leaves $M_{r,n} = \zeta^{-\sigma_3/4} N_r (I + O(\zeta^{-3/2})) \omega^{\sigma_3/2}$; and for $|\zeta| \le 3$, $M_{r,n}$ is an entire matrix of Airy functions times bounded factors. A_r is analytic in $U(4c,\varepsilon)$ (its jumps on the band cancel, and its singularity at $4c$ is at most $|z-4c|^{-1/2}$, hence removable, as in T2), with $\det A_r = 1$ and $|A_r^{\pm 1}| \le C$ uniformly in n. In the frame of Q the global parametrix is the weight-free P_0^∞, so no constant diagonal prefactor appears in A_r: the matching holds directly in this frame: on $\partial U(4c,\varepsilon)$, $|n^{2/3}f_r| \asymp n^{2/3}$ and

$$\hat P_r (P_0^\infty)^{-1} = P_0^\infty\, \omega^{-\sigma_3/2} N_r^{-1} \big(I + O(n^{-1})\big) N_r\, \omega^{\sigma_3/2} (P_0^\infty)^{-1} = I + O(1/n),$$

since P_0^∞ and $\omega^{\pm 1/2}$ are bounded there uniformly in n.

We now collect what §§7–8 use.

Proposition 6.9 (Frame Proposition)**.** *Let $p > 0$, $1 < s < 1 + 2p$, $\alpha = (s-1-p)/p$, let ℓ_1 satisfy $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$, and let F be the outer scalar of Lemma 6.1 ($p > 1$), Lemma 6.2 ($p = 1$) or Lemma 6.4 ($p < 1$). The radii δ, ε and the contour of §5.6 may be taken as small as we wish (but fixed, independent of n). Put $Q := D_\infty^{-\sigma_3} V D_W^{\sigma_3}$. There is n_0 such that for $n \ge n_0$:*

(F1) *(Contour and jumps.) Q is analytic in $\mathbb{C}\setminus\Sigma$, $Q(z) = I + O(1/z)$ at ∞, Q has continuous boundary values on Σ minus its vertices, and $Q_+ = Q_- v$ with $\det v = 1$ and*

- *band $(0, 4c)$, oriented from left to right: $v = J = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$;*
- *lips $\Sigma_{\mathrm{lip}}^{\pm}$, oriented away from 0: $v = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \omega e^{2n\varphi} & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right) + E$, $\omega = D_W^2/W_0$, where W_0 on a lip is the analytic continuation of W_0 from the band and $E = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} \epsilon_\pm(\kappa_\pm - 1) & \omega^{-1} e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ (\kappa_\pm - 1)\omega e^{2n\varphi} & \epsilon_\mp(\kappa_\pm - 1) \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ ($\epsilon_+ = 1$, $\epsilon_- = 0$);*
- *$\Sigma_v^{\pm}$ (oriented away from the axis): $v = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & -\omega^{-1} e^{-2n\tilde\varphi} \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$; saturated segment $(4c, n^p + \delta')$: $v = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \omega e^{2n\tilde\varphi} & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$;*
- *$\Sigma^{\triangle\pm}$ (left to right): $v = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \kappa_\pm \omega e^{2n\varphi} & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$; the top segment in $\mathbb{C}_\pm$ (oriented upwards): $v = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ \mp\kappa_\pm \omega e^{2n\varphi} & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$;*
- *no jump on $(-\infty, 0)$, on $(n^p + \delta', \infty)$, or (for $p < 1$) on the seams.*

$|v^{\pm 1}| \le C$ on Σ. Σ is a finite union of C^2 arcs; $\Sigma \cap (U(0, 2\delta) \cup U(4c, 2\varepsilon))$ does not depend on n; the length of Σ is $O(n^p)$; $|\Sigma \cap U(z,\rho)| \le C\rho$ for all z, ρ; and $\|\mathcal{C}_\pm\|_{L^2(\Sigma)\to L^2(\Sigma)} \le C$.

(F2) *(Band weight.) $W_0 = C_n x^\alpha (4c - x) H_n(x) r_n(x)$ with $C_n \ne 0$ constant, $r_n(z) = \exp(\Lambda(\log n - \frac{1}{p}\log z) - \Lambda(\log n))$, and $H_n > 0$ on $(0, 4c + \varepsilon]$. H_n and r_n are analytic on $\mathcal{Z}_n$, which contains the closed sectors $\{0 < |z| \le \delta,\ |\arg z| \le \frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}\}$ and a neighbourhood of $(0, 4c + \varepsilon]$, and, uniformly in n,*

$$|\log H_n(z) - \log H_n(0^+)| \le C|z|^{\nu_p}, \quad |(\log H_n)'(z)| \le C|z|^{\nu_p - 1} \qquad (z \in \mathcal{Z}_n,\ |z| \le 1),$$
$$|\log H_n(x) - \log H_n(0^+)| \le C \qquad (0 < x \le 4c + \varepsilon).$$

The constant $C_n H_n(0^+)$ cancels in $\omega = D_W^2/W_0$; D_W is given by (65) with $q = W_0$.

(F3) *(Lips.) In $U(0,\delta)$ the lips are the preimages under $\zeta = n^2 f(z)$ of the rays $\arg\zeta = \mp(\pi - \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$ (the upper lip is mapped to the lower ray); they leave 0 at the angles $\pm\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$ and satisfy $\frac{3}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} \le |\arg z| \le \frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$; the Bessel rays are $\arg\zeta = \pm(\pi - \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$.*

(F4) *(Super-small entries.) $|E(z)| \le C\exp(-n|z|^{-1/p}/C)$ on the lips in $U(0,\delta)$.*

(F5) *(Parametrices away from 0.) P_0^∞ is given by (69): $\det P_0^\infty = 1$, $P_{0,+}^\infty = P_{0,-}^\infty J$ on $(0,4c)$, and (70) holds. On $\Sigma \setminus (U(0,\delta)\cup U(4c,\varepsilon)\cup[0,4c])$, $|v - I| \le Ce^{-n/C}$. In $U(4c,\varepsilon)$, $\hat P_r = D_\infty^{-\sigma_3} P_r D_W^{\sigma_3}$ of (72) has exactly the jumps v, $\det\hat P_r = 1$, $\hat P_r (P_0^\infty)^{-1} = I + O(1/n)$ uniformly on $\partial U(4c,\varepsilon)$, and $\hat P_r = A_r n^{\sigma_3/6} M_{r,n}$ with $A_r^{\pm1}$ analytic and bounded uniformly in n, f_r conformal and independent of n, and $M_{r,n}$ satisfying (B2), (B3) of Lemma B.2 with $\mathcal{P} = I$ and $\zeta = n^{2/3} f_r(z)$.*

(F6) *(Hard-edge map.) f is conformal on a neighbourhood of $\overline{U(0,\delta)}$, independent of n and of the weight, real on $(-\delta,\delta)$, $f(0) = 0$, $f'(0) < 0$, $f = (\varphi \pm i\pi)^2/4$ in $U(0,\delta)\cap\mathbb{C}_\pm$; $\operatorname{Re}\varphi < 0$ on the lips and $|e^{2n\varphi}| \le e^{-n|z|^{1/2}/C}$ on the lips in $U(0,\delta)$.*

(F7) *(A priori bound.) $Q_\pm$ and $(Q^{-1})_\pm$ belong to $I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\Sigma))$. For each fixed n and every $\eta > 0$, $|Q(z)| \le C_{n,\eta}(1 + |z|^{-|\alpha|/2-\eta})$ for $z \notin \Sigma$.*

(F8) *(Extraction.) For $|z| > n^p + \delta' + h_0$, $Q = k_\infty^{-\sigma_3}(Uz^{-n\sigma_3})k^{\sigma_3}$ with a scalar k analytic at ∞, $k(\infty) = k_\infty \ne 0$ (71). Consequently, with $Q = I + Q_1/z + Q_2/z^2 + \dots$, $(Q_1)_{12}(Q_1)_{21} = n^{2p}b_n^2$ and $\mathsf{a}(Q) = (Q_2)_{12}/(Q_1)_{12} - (Q_1)_{22} = n^p a_n$ (by Lemma 5.1 and the invariance Lemma 8.1).*

Proof. (F1). The jumps are those of Lemma 5.7 conjugated by $D_W^{\sigma_3}$, which has no jump off $[0,4c]$; on the band $D_{W,-}^{-\sigma_3}\left(\begin{smallmatrix}0 & W_0\\ -1/W_0 & 0\end{smallmatrix}\right)D_{W,+}^{\sigma_3} = J$ because $D_{W,+}D_{W,-} = W_0$; on the seams there is no jump by Lemma 6.4(iv). The behaviour at ∞ is Lemma 6.7. Boundedness of $v^{\pm1}$ (note $\det v = 1$): on the band $v = J$; on the lips in $U(0,\delta)$ by Lemma 6.6(vi)(a) and Lemma 6.8; on the remaining arcs it follows from the bounds in (F5) below, from Lemma 6.6(vi)(b) in $U(4c,\varepsilon)$, and from $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi \le 0$ on $(4c,4c+\varepsilon)$, $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi \ge 0$ on Σ_v near $4c$ (Lemma 5.4(iv)). The arcs inside $\{\operatorname{Re} z \le 4c+1\}$ do not depend on n; the rest of Σ consists of pieces of the three lines $\operatorname{Im} z \in \{0, \pm h_0\}$ and the top segment. Hence $|\Sigma\cap U(z,\rho)| \le C\rho$. For the Cauchy operator, split $\Sigma = \Sigma_1\cup\Sigma_2\cup\Sigma_3$ according to $\operatorname{Re} z \le 4c+1$, $4c+1 < \operatorname{Re} z < 4c+3$, $\operatorname{Re} z \ge 4c+3$ ($n \ge n_0$). The blocks between $\Sigma_1\cup\Sigma_2$ and itself are bounded because this curve is fixed and Carleson (T3). $\Sigma_2\cup\Sigma_3$ is contained in a translate of the fixed curve consisting of three horizontal half-lines ending on a vertical segment of length $2h_0$, and the Cauchy operator is translation invariant, so these blocks are bounded uniformly in n. The blocks between Σ_1 and Σ_3 have kernels bounded by $|s-z|^{-1}$ with $|s-z| \ge 2$, and $\int_{\Sigma_1}\int_{\Sigma_3}|s-z|^{-2}|\,ds||\,dz| \le C$, so they are Hilbert–Schmidt with a uniform bound.

(F2). This is (54) and (O2)–(O4); the sectors lie in $\mathcal{Z}_n$ because $\frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} < \vartheta_{\mathrm{w}}$, and $|\log H_n - \log H_n(0^+)| \le C$ on $[1,4c+\varepsilon]$ by (O4). The cancellation is (68).

(F3). This is the construction of §5.6.

(F4). By Lemma 6.8(a), (b), Lemma 6.6(vi)(a) and $|e^{2n\varphi}| \le 1$, every entry of E is at most $C\exp(-\pi s_p n|z|^{-1/p})$.

(F5). The properties of P_0^∞ were shown above. We bound $|v - I|$ arc by arc, using Lemma 6.6(vi)(c) for ω (all these arcs have distance $\ge d > 0$ from $[0,4c]$, except the parts near $4c$, where (vi)(b) applies). *Lips outside $U(0,\delta)$:* this part of the lips is compact and does not meet $[0,4c]$, so $\operatorname{Re}\varphi \le -c'$ there (Lemma 5.4(i)), $|\operatorname{Im}\theta| \ge c'n$ (by (41), since $|\arg z|$ is bounded below and $|z| \le 4c + h_0$), and $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi \ge c'$ by the choice of the lips; so all entries of $v - I$ are $O(e^{-c'n})$. *Σ_v outside $U(4c,\varepsilon)$:* $\operatorname{Re}\tilde\varphi \ge c'$. *Saturated segment beyond $4c+\varepsilon$:* $|e^{2n\tilde\varphi}| = e^{2n(\gamma_p - U^*(x))}$ is at most $e^{-c'n}$ for $x \le x_0$ and at most x^{-n} for $x \ge x_0$ (Lemma 5.3(iii)),

while $|\omega| \le \exp(C(1+\log(1+x))^2)$ and $\log x \le C\log n$; so $|v-I| \le Ce^{-c'n}$. *$\Sigma^{\triangle\pm}$ and the top segment:* for $z = x \pm iy$ with $x > 4c$, $\operatorname{Re} g(z) \ge U^*(x)$, so $\operatorname{Re}\varphi(z) \le \gamma_p - U^*(x)$, which is $\le -c'$ for $x \ge 4c+\varepsilon$ and $\le -\frac{1}{2}\log x$ for $x \ge x_0$; near $x = 4c$ the bound $\operatorname{Re}\varphi \le -c'$ on $\Sigma^{\triangle\pm}$ follows from Lemma 5.4(i) by compactness. Moreover $|\operatorname{Im}\theta(x \pm ih_0)| \ge c'h_0 n\, x^{-1-1/p}$, so $|\kappa_\pm| \le Cn^p$ on these arcs (and on the top segment, where t is close to 1, $|1-e^{\mp 2i\theta}| \ge c'n^{-p}$). With $|\omega| \le \exp(C\log^2 n)$ this gives $|v-I| \le Cn^p e^{C\log^2 n}e^{-c'n} \le Ce^{-c'n/2}$, and $\le Cn^{-pm/4}$ on the top segment. The statements about $\hat{P}_r$ are the construction (72) above, with T1(c); (B2) and (B3) with $\mathcal{P} = I$ are the two descriptions of $M_{r,n}$ given there.

(F6). Lemma 5.4(i), (iii) and Lemma 6.8(c); f is built from μ^* alone.

(F7). This is Proposition C.3 and Corollary C.4 of Appendix C.

(F8). The first statement is Lemma 6.7. By Lemma 5.1, $Uz^{-n\sigma_3} = I + U_1/z + \dots$ satisfies (38), and both functionals are invariant under $X \mapsto k_\infty^{-\sigma_3} X k^{\sigma_3}$ for a scalar k analytic at ∞: the constant conjugation multiplies the $(1,2)$ and $(2,1)$ entries by reciprocal factors, and if $k/k_\infty = 1 + k_1/z + O(z^{-2})$, then right multiplication by $(k/k_\infty)^{\sigma_3}$ changes $(X_2)_{12}$ by $-k_1(X_1)_{12}$ and $(X_1)_{22}$ by $-k_1$, and leaves $(X_1)_{12}$, $(X_1)_{21}$ unchanged (Lemma 8.1). □

Remarks on the Frame Proposition. (1) Everything in (F1)–(F8) that depends on the geometry is the outer scalar (through H_n in (F2)), the lip angle ϑ_{lip} in (F3), and the exponent in (F4); the rest is literally the same for all $p > 0$. (2) Neither V nor Q has a jump on $(-\infty, 0)$, and the comparison parametrix of §7 is built from D_W, which uses band values only. So nothing is ever continued across $(-\delta, 0)$; this is why Remark 6.3 does not affect $p = 1$. (3) For $\ell_1 \equiv 1$ we have $\Lambda \equiv 0$, $r_n \equiv 1$ and $\varepsilon_\Lambda \equiv 0$; the proposition then describes the pure power $\sigma_{p,s}$.

7. The hard edge: comparison with a Bessel model

After Sections 5 and 6 the orthogonal polynomials of σ_{p,s,ℓ_1} are encoded in a matrix Q, normalised at infinity, whose jumps are listed in the Frame Proposition (Proposition 6.9). Away from the two endpoints 0 and $4c$ of the band these jumps are those of an explicit global parametrix, up to exponentially small errors. At the soft edge $4c$ the standard Airy construction applies. This section treats the hard edge 0. We compare Q with an explicitly solvable *comparison problem* and show that the two have the same first two moments at infinity up to $O(1/n)$; Section 8 then reads off a_n and b_n.

Why the usual local parametrix fails. The band weight is $W_0 = C_n x^\alpha (4c-x) H_n(x) r_n(x)$, and the slowly varying factor enters through $r_n(z) = \ell_1(nz^{-1/p})/\ell_1(n)$. In the logarithmic variable $\xi = \log n - (\log z)/p$ the point $z = 0$ corresponds to $\xi = +\infty$, where $\Lambda = \log \ell_1 \circ \exp$ has no expansion: r_n is analytic off $(-\infty, 0]$ but it is neither analytic at 0 nor of Fisher–Hartwig type. The Bessel parametrix of T2 needs a function $\tilde{W}$ with $\tilde{W}_+\tilde{W}_- = W_0$ on the band which is continued around 0 across $(-\delta, 0)$. Continuing $r_n^{1/2}$ from the upper and from the lower half-plane produces two values on $(-\delta, 0)$ whose ratio is $\exp\big(\frac{1}{2}(\Lambda(\xi - i\pi/p) - \Lambda(\xi + i\pi/p))\big) = 1 + O(\varepsilon_\Lambda)$, and for $p \le 1$ the continuation even leaves the strip on which Λ is assumed to be analytic. The size $O(\varepsilon_\Lambda)$ tends to 0 with no rate in n. Conjugated by the Bessel model at the scale $|z| \asymp n^{-2}$ it becomes $O(n\varepsilon_\Lambda)$, which is not small, so a quotient (small-norm) argument does not close. A Bessel order that drifts with n removes only the power-like part $z^{-\Lambda'(\log n)/p}$ of r_n and leaves a remainder of the same kind. This is the situation of [2, Remark 4.10].

The remedy, due to Conway and Deift. We never continue the weight across $(-\delta, 0)$. Instead we build the Bessel parametrix with $\tilde{W} := D_W$, the Szegő function of the whole band weight. Since D_W is analytic off $[0, 4c]$ and $D_{W,+}D_{W,-} = W_0$, the resulting matrix has exactly the band jump of Q and no jump on $(-\delta, 0)$. It differs from Q only on the lips of the lens, where the true jump contains D_W^2/W_0 and the model jump contains the constant $c_\pm = e^{\mp i\pi\alpha}$. We show

that $D_W^2/W_0 - c_\pm$ is small in the supremum norm, uniformly on the lips but without any rate (Lemma 7.3). That is all a Neumann series needs, provided the resolvent of the comparison problem is bounded uniformly in n (Proposition 7.4, Theorem 7.5). The effect on the moments is then computed by the difference formula of Conway and Deift. The factor $1/n$ comes from *Bessel localisation*: the mismatch carries the factor $e^{2n\varphi}$, which confines it to $|z| \lesssim n^{-2}$ up to a tail, and there the comparison solution has size $n^{1/2}|n^2 z|^{-|\alpha|/2}$; this turns a mismatch of size $\varepsilon_n' = o(1)$ into an error $O(\varepsilon_n'/n)$ (Proposition 7.6).

The comparison argument of this section is that of Conway and Deift [2, Theorem 4.7 and Proposition 4.9]. What we add is a comparison model built from the Szegő function of the full weight, a uniform resolvent bound for a Bessel edge of any order $|\alpha| < 1$, and the treatment of an arbitrary slowly varying factor. Two further differences are of a technical nature. Our comparison problem is not a second orthogonality problem but an explicit matrix: the global parametrix together with the two local parametrices. The matching errors on the two circles are then simply part of the comparison, which spares a separate small-norm argument and gives the $O(1/n)$ terms as explicit integrals. And the restriction $|\alpha| < 1$ is used in exactly three places: a power-weighted Cauchy bound with exponents $\pm\alpha/2$ (Lemma A.1); the integrability of $|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|}$ on a ray (Hilbert–Schmidt bounds in Appendix B, and Bessel localisation in Proposition 7.6); and the square integrability of the comparison solution, which is of size $|z|^{-|\alpha|/2}$ at 0, on the contour, which the L^2 framework of Conway and Deift requires. This is consistent with the remark of Deift and Piorkowski [6, §1] that at exponent 1 the corresponding step "requires a different proof".

The section is organised as follows. Section 7.1 fixes conventions and lists what is used from Proposition 6.9. Section 7.2 derives the local form of the Bessel model (Lemma 7.1). Section 7.3 builds the comparison parametrix (Lemma 7.2) and the comparison problem. Section 7.4 proves the lip mismatch estimate (Lemma 7.3). Section 7.5 states the two resolvent bounds, and Section 7.6 the effect of the mismatch on the moments (Proposition 7.6).

7.1. **Conventions and input from the frame.** Throughout this section $p > 0$, $1 < s < 1 + 2p$, $\alpha = (s - 1 - p)/p \in (-1, 1)$, and $\ell_1 = e^{\Lambda(\log\cdot)}$ satisfies $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$. All matrices are 2×2, $|\cdot|$ is a fixed matrix norm, e_1, e_2 are the standard basis vectors and

$$J := \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad M = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & i \\ i & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad c_\pm := e^{\mp i\pi\alpha}.$$

Constants C may depend on p, s, ℓ_1 and on the radii δ, ε below, but never on n or on the point z; they may change from line to line. Exponentially small factors are written $e^{-n/C}$. Powers and logarithms are principal unless said otherwise. The Cauchy transform $\mathcal{C}$, its boundary values $\mathcal{C}_\pm$, the operator $\mathcal{C}_v f = \mathcal{C}_-(f(v - I))$ and the class $I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$ are as in T3.

We work in the frame of $Q := D_\infty^{-\sigma_3} V D_W^{\sigma_3}$. A matrix X in the frame of V corresponds to $D_\infty^{-\sigma_3} X D_W^{\sigma_3}$; in particular the global parametrix $P^\infty = D_\infty^{\sigma_3} P_0^\infty D_W^{-\sigma_3}$ becomes P_0^∞, which does not involve the weight. We use the following items of Proposition 6.9, for $n \geq n_0$ and fixed radii $\delta, \varepsilon > 0$ which we may take as small as we wish.

- (F1) The contour Σ of Q is a finite union of C^2 arcs, oriented, with the band $(0, 4c)$ oriented from left to right and the lips of the lens in $U(0, \delta)$ oriented away from 0. $Q \to I$ at infinity and $Q_+ = Q_- v$ on Σ, with $v^{\pm 1}$ bounded uniformly in n. Inside $U(0, \delta)$ the contour consists of the band and two lips, with

$$v = J \text{ on } (0, \delta), \qquad v = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ (D_W^2/W_0)e^{2n\varphi} & 1 \end{pmatrix} + E \text{ on the lips,} \tag{73}$$

where W_0 on a lip is the analytic continuation of W_0 from the band and E collects the super-small entries of (F4); there is no jump on $(-\delta,0)$ (and, for $p<1$, none on the seams). The part $\Sigma\cap(U(0,2\delta)\cup U(4c,2\varepsilon))$ does not depend on n. The arc length of Σ is $O(n^p)$, and Σ is a Carleson curve with constants independent of n: $|\Sigma\cap U(z,\rho)|\le C\rho$ for all z,ρ, and $\|\mathcal{C}_\pm\|_{L^2(\Sigma)\to L^2(\Sigma)}\le C$.

- (F2) $W_0=C_nx^\alpha(4c-x)H_n(x)r_n(x)$, where $r_n(z)=\exp\big(\Lambda(\log n-\frac{1}{p}\log z)-\Lambda(\log n)\big)$, $H_n>0$ is analytic on $(0,4c+\varepsilon)$, and $\log H_n-\log H_n(0^+)$ is Hölder of exponent ν_p at 0, uniformly in n, in the sense of (89) below. The constant C_n cancels in D_W^2/W_0. D_W is the Szegő function of W_0 on $[0,4c]$:

$$D_W(z)=\exp\Big(\frac{\mathcal{R}(z)}{2\pi}\int_0^{4c}\frac{\log W_0(x)}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}}\frac{\mathrm{d}x}{z-x}\Big),\qquad \mathcal{R}(z):=\big(z(z-4c)\big)^{1/2}\sim z\ (z\to\infty). \tag{74}$$

- (F3) In $U(0,\delta)$ the lips are the preimages under $\zeta=n^2f(z)$ of the rays $\arg\zeta=\mp(\pi-\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$ (the upper lip is mapped to the lower ray), and they leave 0 at the angles $\pm\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$; here $\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}=\pi/3$ for $p\ge1$ and $\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}=\pi p/4$ for $p<1$ (Table 1).
- (F4) The entries collected in E satisfy $|E(z)|\le C\exp(-n|z|^{-1/p}/C)\,|z|^{-C}$ on the lips in $U(0,\delta)$.
- (F5) The global parametrix is

$$P_0^\infty(z)=\begin{pmatrix}\frac{a(z)+a(z)^{-1}}{2} & \frac{a(z)-a(z)^{-1}}{2i}\\ -\frac{a(z)-a(z)^{-1}}{2i} & \frac{a(z)+a(z)^{-1}}{2}\end{pmatrix},\qquad a(z)=\Big(\frac{z-4c}{z}\Big)^{1/4}; \tag{75}$$

it is analytic in $\mathbb{C}\setminus[0,4c]$, $\det P_0^\infty=1$, $P_{0,+}^\infty=P_{0,-}^\infty J$ on $(0,4c)$, and $|P_0^\infty(z)|\le C|z|^{-1/4}|z-4c|^{-1/4}(1+|z|)^{1/2}$. On $\Sigma\setminus\big(U(0,\delta)\cup U(4c,\varepsilon)\cup[0,4c]\big)$ one has $|v-I|\le Ce^{-n/C}$. In $U(4c,\varepsilon)$ there is an Airy parametrix, which in the frame of Q we write $\hat P_r=D_\infty^{-\sigma_3}P_rD_W^{\sigma_3}$: it has exactly the jumps v of Q in $U(4c,\varepsilon)$, $\det\hat P_r=1$, $\hat P_r(P_0^\infty)^{-1}=I+O(1/n)$ uniformly on $\partial U(4c,\varepsilon)$, and it has the two-scale structure (105) of Appendix B.

- (F6) f is conformal on a neighbourhood of $\overline{U(0,\delta)}$, independent of n and of the weight, real on $(-\delta,\delta)$, with $f(0)=0$, $f'(0)<0$, and $f=(\varphi\pm i\pi)^2/4$ in $U(0,\delta)\cap\mathbb{C}_\pm$; moreover $\Re\varphi<0$ on the lips.
- (F7) $Q_\pm\in I+\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\Sigma))$; for fixed n, $|Q(z)|\le C_n(1+|z|^{-|\alpha|/2-\eta})$ off Σ for every small $\eta>0$.
- (F8) The extraction identities $(Q_1)_{12}(Q_1)_{21}=n^{2p}b_n^2$ and $\mathsf{a}(Q)=n^pa_n$, which rest on Lemma 8.1.

Since $f'(0)<0$ and f is real on $(-\delta,\delta)$, f maps $U(0,\delta)\cap\mathbb{C}_\pm$ into $\mathbb{C}_\mp$, the band $(0,\delta)$ into $(-\infty,0)$ and $(-\delta,0)$ into $(0,\infty)$; and $|f(z)|\ge|z|/C$, $|f'|+|f'|^{-1}\le C$ on $U(0,\delta)$. Shrinking δ if necessary, we may and do assume that on the lips in $U(0,\delta)$

$$\tfrac34\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}\le|\arg z|\le\tfrac54\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}. \tag{76}$$

Finally put $\nu_p:=\min(1/p,\frac12)$, $T_n:=\log n-\frac1p\log\max(4c,\delta)$ and

$$\varepsilon_n':=n^{-2\nu_p}\log n+\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)\ \longrightarrow\ 0. \tag{77}$$

7.2. **The Bessel model and its local form.** Let Ψ_α be the Bessel model of T2, built on the three rays $\arg\zeta=\pm(\pi-\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$ and $\arg\zeta=\pi$ (angle freedom, T2(b); for $p\ge1$ these are the rays of [10, §6]). We orient them as in T2(a): all three rays point towards the origin, with the $+$ side on the left. Thus Ψ_α is given by (6.23) of T2 in the sector $|\arg\zeta|<\pi-\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$ and by the Hankel formulas in the two thin sectors, it has the jumps (6.16)–(6.18) on the three rays, and

it satisfies the large-ζ expansion (6.28). We have $\det\Psi_\alpha \equiv 1$: in the central sector this is the Wronskian identity of T4, and the jump matrices have determinant 1.

In the central sector $|\arg 2\zeta^{1/2}| < \pi/2$, so all Bessel functions there are principal branches (T4, §10.25(ii)); and (6.28) remains valid for the rays at $\pm(\pi-\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$, since the Bessel and Hankel functions in (6.23)–(6.25) are then evaluated in closed subsectors of the sectors of validity of the large-argument expansions T4, (10.40.1)–(10.40.5); for instance $|\arg 2\zeta^{1/2}| \le \frac{1}{2}(\pi-\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}) < \frac{1}{2}\pi$ in the central sector.

Lemma 7.1 (local form of the Bessel model)**.** *Let $\alpha \in (-1,1)$ and let $\mathcal{S}_\pm$ denote the thin sectors $\pi - \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} < \pm\arg\zeta < \pi$.*

(i) *If $\alpha \neq 0$, there is an entire matrix function $\hat\Psi_\alpha$ with $\det\hat\Psi_\alpha = -2i\sin\pi\alpha$ such that*

$$\Psi_\alpha(\zeta) = \hat\Psi_\alpha(\zeta)\,\zeta^{\alpha\sigma_3/2}\,\mathsf{S}, \qquad \mathsf{S} := \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -\frac{i}{2\sin\pi\alpha} \\ 0 & \frac{i}{2\sin\pi\alpha} \end{pmatrix},$$

in $|\arg\zeta| < \pi - \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$, while in $\mathcal{S}_\pm$ the constant S is replaced by S times a constant jump matrix of Ψ_α.

(ii) *If $\alpha = 0$, there is an entire $\hat\Psi_0$ with $\det\hat\Psi_0 = 1$ such that*

$$\Psi_0(\zeta) = \hat\Psi_0(\zeta)\begin{pmatrix} 1 & \kappa\log\zeta \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \kappa = -\frac{i}{2\pi},$$

in $|\arg\zeta| < \pi - \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$, while in $\mathcal{S}_\pm$ the right-hand side is multiplied on the right by a constant jump matrix.

(iii) *Consequently, for $0 < |\zeta| \le 3$ off the rays,*

$$|\Psi_\alpha(\zeta)^{\pm1}| \le C|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|/2}, \qquad |\Psi_\alpha(\zeta)e_2e_1^{\mathsf T}\Psi_\alpha(\zeta)^{-1}| \le C|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|} \qquad (\alpha\neq 0),$$

and the same with $|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|/2}$, $|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|}$ replaced by $1+|\log|\zeta||$ and $(1+|\log|\zeta||)^2$ if $\alpha = 0$. The same bounds hold for the boundary values on the rays.

Proof. We expand the entries of (6.23) by the power series T4(10.25.2) and read off the singular factors.

(i) Let $\nu = \pm\alpha$. By (10.25.2) with $x = 2\zeta^{1/2}$ we have $(\frac{1}{2}x)^{\nu+2k} = \zeta^{\nu/2+k}$, hence

$$I_\nu(2\zeta^{1/2}) = \zeta^{\nu/2}E_\nu(\zeta), \qquad 2\pi i\zeta^{1/2}I_\nu'(2\zeta^{1/2}) = \pi i\zeta^{\nu/2}\sum_{k\ge0}\frac{(\nu+2k)\zeta^k}{k!\,\Gamma(\nu+k+1)} =: \zeta^{\nu/2}F_\nu(\zeta),$$

with $E_\nu(\zeta) = \sum_k \zeta^k/(k!\Gamma(\nu+k+1))$; E_ν and F_ν are entire because $1/\Gamma$ is entire. Write $g_\nu := (E_\nu, F_\nu)^{\mathsf T}$, so that the first column of (6.23) is $\zeta^{\alpha/2}g_\alpha$. By (10.27.4), $\frac{i}{\pi}K_\alpha = \frac{i}{2\sin\pi\alpha}(I_{-\alpha}-I_\alpha)$, and differentiating, $-2\zeta^{1/2}K_\alpha'(2\zeta^{1/2}) = \frac{i}{2\sin\pi\alpha}\cdot 2\pi i\zeta^{1/2}(I_{-\alpha}'-I_\alpha')(2\zeta^{1/2})$ (both sides equal $-\frac{\pi}{\sin\pi\alpha}\zeta^{1/2}(I_{-\alpha}'-I_\alpha')$). So the second column of (6.23) is $\frac{i}{2\sin\pi\alpha}(\zeta^{-\alpha/2}g_{-\alpha}-\zeta^{\alpha/2}g_\alpha)$, and

$$\Psi_\alpha = \begin{pmatrix} g_\alpha & g_{-\alpha}\end{pmatrix}\begin{pmatrix} \zeta^{\alpha/2} & -\frac{i}{2\sin\pi\alpha}\zeta^{\alpha/2} \\ 0 & \frac{i}{2\sin\pi\alpha}\zeta^{-\alpha/2}\end{pmatrix} = \hat\Psi_\alpha\,\zeta^{\alpha\sigma_3/2}\mathsf{S}, \qquad \hat\Psi_\alpha := \begin{pmatrix} g_\alpha & g_{-\alpha}\end{pmatrix}.$$

Since $\det\Psi_\alpha = 1$ and $\det\mathsf{S} = i/(2\sin\pi\alpha)$, $\det\hat\Psi_\alpha = -2i\sin\pi\alpha \neq 0$. In a thin sector, Ψ_α is the continuation of the central formula multiplied on the right by a constant jump matrix, because the jumps of Ψ_α are constant and $\hat\Psi_\alpha\zeta^{\alpha\sigma_3/2}\mathsf{S}$ is analytic in $\mathbb{C}\setminus(-\infty,0]$.

(ii) By (10.31.2), $K_0(x) = -(\ln\frac{x}{2}+\gamma)I_0(x) + S_0(\frac{1}{4}x^2)$ with S_0 entire. At $x = 2\zeta^{1/2}$, $\ln\frac{x}{2} = \frac{1}{2}\log\zeta$, so $\frac{i}{\pi}K_0(2\zeta^{1/2}) = -\frac{i}{2\pi}\log\zeta\cdot E_0(\zeta) + (\text{entire})$. Differentiating the same identity, $-2\zeta^{1/2}K_0'(2\zeta^{1/2}) = I_0(2\zeta^{1/2}) + (\frac{1}{2}\log\zeta+\gamma)\,2\zeta^{1/2}I_0'(2\zeta^{1/2}) - 2\zeta S_0'(\zeta)$, and $2\zeta^{1/2}I_0'(2\zeta^{1/2}) = F_0(\zeta)/(\pi i)$. Hence the second column equals $\kappa\log\zeta\cdot g_0(\zeta) + h(\zeta)$ with $\kappa = -i/(2\pi)$ and h

entire, and $\Psi_0 = (g_0 \;\; h)\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & \kappa\log\zeta \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$; $\det(g_0\ h) = \det\Psi_0 = 1$. The thin sectors are treated as in (i).

(iii) On $|\zeta| \le 3$ the entire factors and their inverses are bounded, and the constant matrices are bounded. The middle factors satisfy $|\zeta^{\pm\alpha\sigma_3/2}| \le C|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|/2}$, respectively $|\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & \kappa\log\zeta \\ 0 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)^{\pm1}| \le C(1+|\log|\zeta||)$. For the rank-one product write

$$\Psi_\alpha e_2 e_1^{\mathsf T}\Psi_\alpha^{-1} = \hat\Psi_\alpha\,\zeta^{\alpha\sigma_3/2}(\mathsf S_j e_2)(e_1^{\mathsf T}\mathsf S_j^{-1})\zeta^{-\alpha\sigma_3/2}\,\hat\Psi_\alpha^{-1};$$

the entries of the middle matrix are constants times $1, \zeta^{\alpha}, \zeta^{-\alpha}$, whence the bound $C|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|}$; for $\alpha = 0$ the same computation gives entries of size $(1+|\log|\zeta||)^2$. □

The model in the normalisation used below. Put

$$\Phi_\alpha(\zeta) := \sigma_3\Psi_\alpha(\zeta)\sigma_3\, e^{-2\zeta^{1/2}\sigma_3}. \tag{78}$$

This is the left-endpoint model of T2(c) with the exponential factor attached; it does not depend on n. Orient the three rays $\Gamma_\alpha := (-\infty,0]\cup\{\arg\zeta = \pm(\pi-\vartheta_{\rm lip})\}$ *away* from the origin. Reversing the orientation of a ray interchanges its $\pm$ sides, and $\sigma_3 J^{-1}\sigma_3 = J$, $\sigma_3\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ x & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)^{-1}\sigma_3 = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ x & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, and $e^{2w\sigma_3}\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ x & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)e^{-2w\sigma_3} = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ xe^{-4w} & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$. With (6.16)–(6.18) this gives:

$$\Phi_{\alpha,+} = \Phi_{\alpha,-}J \text{ on } (-\infty,0), \qquad \Phi_{\alpha,+} = \Phi_{\alpha,-}\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ e^{\mp i\pi\alpha}e^{-4\zeta^{1/2}} & 1 \end{pmatrix} \text{ on } \arg\zeta = \mp(\pi-\vartheta_{\rm lip}). \tag{79}$$

On $(-\infty,0)$ we used that the two boundary values $w_\pm$ of $\zeta^{1/2}$ satisfy $w_+ = -w_-$, so that $e^{2w_-\sigma_3}Je^{-2w_+\sigma_3} = J$. Moreover $\det\Phi_\alpha = 1$, and Φ_α has the two-scale structure

$$\Phi_\alpha(\zeta) = \zeta^{-\sigma_3/4}\Theta_\infty(\zeta), \quad \Theta_\infty = (2\pi)^{-\sigma_3/2}\big(M^{-1}+O(\zeta^{-1/2})\big), \quad |\Theta_\infty^{\pm1}| \le C \quad (|\zeta|\ge 2), \tag{80}$$

$$\Phi_\alpha(\zeta) = \hat A(\zeta)\,\mathcal P(\zeta)\,\Theta_0(\zeta), \quad |\Theta_0^{\pm1}| \le C \qquad (|\zeta|\le 3), \tag{81}$$

where $\hat A = \sigma_3\hat\Psi_\alpha\sigma_3$ is entire with entire inverse, $\Theta_0 = \sigma_3\mathsf S_j\sigma_3 e^{-2\zeta^{1/2}\sigma_3}$ in the j-th sector, and $\mathcal P(\zeta) = \zeta^{\alpha\sigma_3/2}$ for $\alpha \ne 0$, $\mathcal P(\zeta) = I - \kappa(\log\zeta)e_1e_2^{\mathsf T}$ for $\alpha = 0$. Indeed (80) follows from (6.28), since $\sigma_3M\sigma_3 = M^{-1}$ and the exponential factors cancel; the bound on Θ_∞^{-1} holds for large $|\zeta|$ by the expansion and for $2 \le |\zeta| \le R$ because $\det\Theta_\infty = 1$ and Θ_∞ is bounded. (81) is Lemma 7.1 conjugated by σ_3.

7.3. **The comparison parametrix and the comparison problem.** We first relate $e^{n\varphi}$ to the Bessel variable $\zeta = n^2 f(z)$. In $U(0,\delta)\cap\mathbb C_+$ both $(\varphi+i\pi)/2$ and the principal root $f^{1/2}$ are analytic (the latter because f avoids $(-\infty,0]$ there), and their squares agree by (F6). So $(\varphi+i\pi)/2 = \pm f^{1/2}$ with a fixed sign. On the upper lip $\Re\varphi < 0$ while $\Re f^{1/2} > 0$, so the sign is $-$. The lower half-disc is treated in the same way, and we obtain, with $\zeta^{1/2} = nf^{1/2}$,

$$e^{n\varphi(z)} = (-1)^n e^{-2\zeta^{1/2}}, \qquad e^{2n\varphi(z)} = e^{-4\zeta^{1/2}} \qquad (z\in U(0,\delta)\setminus[0,\delta)). \tag{82}$$

On the lips $\arg\zeta = \mp(\pi-\vartheta_{\rm lip})$, so $\Re\zeta^{1/2} = |\zeta|^{1/2}\sin(\vartheta_{\rm lip}/2)$ and

$$|e^{2n\varphi(z)}| = e^{-4\sin(\vartheta_{\rm lip}/2)|\zeta|^{1/2}} \le e^{-n|z|^{1/2}/C} \qquad \text{on the lips in } U(0,\delta). \tag{83}$$

Following T2(c) with $\tilde W$ replaced by D_W, define in $U(0,\delta)$

$$\tilde P_0 := (-1)^n E_n\,\sigma_3\Psi_\alpha(n^2f)\sigma_3\,D_W^{-\sigma_3}e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}, \qquad E_n := D_\infty^{\sigma_3}P_0^\infty M f^{\sigma_3/4}(2\pi n)^{\sigma_3/2}. \tag{84}$$

In the frame of Q this becomes, by (82),

$$\hat P_0 := D_\infty^{-\sigma_3}\tilde P_0 D_W^{\sigma_3} = \hat E_n\,\Phi_\alpha(n^2f), \qquad \hat E_n := P_0^\infty M f^{\sigma_3/4}(2\pi n)^{\sigma_3/2} = A_0\,(2\pi n)^{\sigma_3/2}, \tag{85}$$

where $A_0 := P_0^\infty M f^{\sigma_3/4}$. Note that $\hat P_0$ contains neither D_W nor any other trace of the weight.

Lemma 7.2 (the comparison parametrix)**.** (i) *A_0 extends to an analytic function on $U(0,\delta)$ with $\det A_0 = 1$. It depends neither on n nor on the weight, and $|A_0^{\pm1}| \le C$ there. In particular E_n is analytic in $U(0,\delta)$, $\det E_n = 1$, and $D_\infty^{-\sigma_3} E_n (2\pi n)^{-\sigma_3/2} = A_0$.*

(ii) *$\hat P_0$ is analytic in $U(0,\delta)\setminus\Sigma$, $\det \hat P_0 = 1$, and*

$$\hat P_{0,+} = \hat P_{0,-} J \text{ on } (0,\delta), \qquad \hat P_{0,+} = \hat P_{0,-} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ c_\pm e^{2n\varphi} & 1 \end{pmatrix} \text{ on the lips in } U(0,\delta)\cap\mathbb{C}_\pm;$$

it has no jump on $(-\delta,0)$. Equivalently, $\tilde P_0$ has the band jump of V, no jump on $(-\delta,0)$ (nor on the seams if $p<1$), and the lip jump $\left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ c_\pm e^{2n\varphi}/D_W^2 & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right)$.

(iii) *Uniformly for $\frac12\delta \le |z| \le \delta$ off Σ, $\hat P_0(z) P_0^\infty(z)^{-1} = I + O(1/n)$, and $|\hat P_0^{\pm1}(z)| \le C$.*

Proof. (i) On $(0,\delta)$, $P_{0,+}^\infty = P_{0,-}^\infty J$, and since f is negative there and maps $\mathbb{C}_+$ to $\mathbb{C}_-$, $f_+^{\sigma_3/4} = f_-^{\sigma_3/4}\mathrm{diag}(-i,i)$. A direct computation gives $M^{-1}JM = \mathrm{diag}(i,-i)$, so $A_{0,+} = P_{0,-}^\infty J M f_-^{\sigma_3/4}\mathrm{diag}(-i,i) = P_{0,-}^\infty M\,\mathrm{diag}(i,-i)\mathrm{diag}(-i,i) f_-^{\sigma_3/4} = A_{0,-}$. On $(-\delta,0)$ both P_0^∞ and $f^{1/4}$ are analytic. So A_0 is analytic in $U(0,\delta)\setminus\{0\}$. At 0, $|P_0^\infty| \le C|z|^{-1/4}$ by (F5) and $|f^{\pm1/4}| \le C|z|^{\pm1/4}$, so $|A_0(z)| \le C|z|^{-1/2}$; an isolated singularity with this growth is removable. This is the removability argument of T2(c), applied to a matrix that involves only P_0^∞, M and f, and therefore neither n nor the weight; in particular the hypothesis of [10] that the weight be analytic at the endpoint plays no role. $\det A_0 = 1$ since each factor has determinant 1, and A_0^{-1} is the adjugate of A_0. Shrinking δ slightly, $A_0^{\pm1}$ are bounded on $U(0,\delta)$.

(ii) $\hat E_n$ is analytic, so the jumps of $\hat P_0$ are those of $\zeta \mapsto \Phi_\alpha(\zeta)$ at $\zeta = n^2 f(z)$. The map $z \mapsto n^2 f(z)$ is conformal, hence preserves the sides of an oriented curve; it maps the band (left to right) onto part of $(-\infty,0)$ traversed away from 0, the lips (away from 0) onto the rays at $\mp(\pi - \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})$ traversed away from 0, and $(-\delta,0)$ into $(0,\infty)$, where Φ_α is analytic. So (79) and (82) give the stated jumps. For $\tilde P_0 = D_\infty^{\sigma_3}\hat P_0 D_W^{-\sigma_3}$, conjugation by the diagonal matrix $D_W^{-\sigma_3}$ turns J into the band jump of V because $D_{W,+}D_{W,-} = W_0$, turns the lip jump into the stated one, and creates no jump on $(-\delta,0)$ because D_W is analytic off $[0,4c]$.

(iii) For $\frac12\delta \le |z| \le \delta$ we have $|\zeta| = n^2|f(z)| \ge n^2\delta/C \ge 2$. By (80) and $(n^2 f)^{-\sigma_3/4} = n^{-\sigma_3/2} f^{-\sigma_3/4}$,

$$\begin{aligned}\hat P_0 &= A_0 (2\pi n)^{\sigma_3/2}(n^2 f)^{-\sigma_3/4}(2\pi)^{-\sigma_3/2}\big(M^{-1} + O(n^{-1})\big) \\ &= P_0^\infty M f^{\sigma_3/4} f^{-\sigma_3/4}\big(M^{-1} + O(n^{-1})\big) = P_0^\infty\big(I + O(n^{-1})\big),\end{aligned}$$

and P_0^∞, $(P_0^\infty)^{-1}$ are bounded on the annulus. Both claims follow. □

The comparison problem. Let $\Sigma_\circ := \partial U(0,\delta) \cup \partial U(4c,\varepsilon)$, with both circles oriented clockwise (so that their + side is the outside), and $\hat\Sigma := \Sigma \cup \Sigma_\circ$. Define

$$\tilde Q(z) := \begin{cases} \hat P_0(z), & z \in U(0,\delta), \\ \hat P_r(z), & z \in U(4c,\varepsilon), \\ P_0^\infty(z), & \text{otherwise}, \end{cases} \qquad z \notin \hat\Sigma. \tag{86}$$

Then $\tilde{Q}$ is analytic off $\hat{\Sigma}$, $\det \tilde{Q} = 1$, $\tilde{Q} \to I$ at infinity, and $\tilde{Q}_+ = \tilde{Q}_- \tilde{v}$ on $\hat{\Sigma}$ with

$$\tilde{v} = \begin{cases} J & \text{on } (0, 4c), \\ \left(\begin{smallmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ c_\pm e^{2n\varphi} & 1 \end{smallmatrix}\right) & \text{on the lips in } U(0,\delta) \cap \mathbb{C}_\pm, \\ v & \text{on } \Sigma \cap U(4c, \varepsilon), \\ I & \text{on } \Sigma \setminus \big(U(0,\delta) \cup U(4c,\varepsilon) \cup [0,4c]\big), \\ \tilde{Q}_{\text{in}}^{-1} \tilde{Q}_{\text{out}} & \text{on } \Sigma_\circ, \end{cases} \tag{87}$$

by Lemma 7.2(ii), (F5), and the fact that P_0^∞ has only the band jump J. Here $\tilde{Q}_{\text{in}}$, $\tilde{Q}_{\text{out}}$ are the values from inside and outside the circle. We extend v by I to $\Sigma_\circ$; Q has no jump there. We call the problem "$\tilde{Q}_+ = \tilde{Q}_- \tilde{v}$ on $\hat{\Sigma}$, $\tilde{Q} \to I$" the *comparison problem*; it is solved explicitly by (86).

The two problems differ in three places. On the circles, $v - \tilde{v} = I - \tilde{Q}_{\text{in}}^{-1} \tilde{Q}_{\text{out}} = O(1/n)$, by Lemma 7.2(iii) and (F5). On $\Sigma \setminus (U(0,\delta) \cup U(4c,\varepsilon) \cup [0,4c])$, $|v - \tilde{v}| \le Ce^{-n/C}$ by (F5). On the lips in $U(0,\delta)$, $v - \tilde{v} = d_n e_2 e_1^{\mathsf{T}} + E$ with

$$d_n(z) := \Big(\frac{D_W(z)^2}{W_0(z)} - c_\pm \Big) e^{2n\varphi(z)}. \tag{88}$$

This last difference is the subject of the next subsection.

7.4. **The lip mismatch.** The Hölder hypothesis on H_n from (F2) is used in the following form: for z in the closed sectors $\{0 < |z| \le \delta,\ |\arg z| \le \frac{5}{4}\vartheta_{\text{lip}}\}$ (to which H_n continues analytically from the band, from each side) and for $x \in (0, 4c]$,

$$|\log H_n(z) - \log H_n(0^+)| \le C|z|^{\nu_p}, \qquad |\log H_n(x) - \log H_n(0^+)| \le C, \tag{89}$$

uniformly in n. (For $p > 1$ this is the Hölder endpoint bound for the Binet-cut and Stirling factors; for $p = 1$ $\log H_n$ is smooth at 0; for $p < 1$ it follows from the corner bound for the seam scalar, which gives $C|z|(1 + \log(1/|z|)) \le C|z|^{1/2}$.)

Lemma 7.3 (lip mismatch)**.** *For $n \ge n_0$ and z on the lips in $U(0,\delta)$,*

$$\Big| \frac{D_W(z)^2}{W_0(z)} - c_\pm \Big| \le C\big(|z|^{\nu_p} \log(2/|z|) + \varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n) \big). \tag{90}$$

Consequently $\sup_{\text{lips}} |d_n| \le C\varepsilon_n'$, *and*

$$\|v - \tilde{v}\|_{L^\infty(\hat{\Sigma})} \le C\big(\varepsilon_n' + n^{-1}\big) \longrightarrow 0. \tag{91}$$

The convergence in (91) has no rate beyond that of $\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)$, about which nothing is assumed.

The proof treats the three factors of W_0 separately. The first two are standard; the third, the slowly varying factor, is handled by a scale-invariant path integral in the logarithmic variable, which is the point of the lemma.

Proof. Step 0: reduction to three ratios. For a positive function q on $(0, 4c)$ with $\log q$ integrable against $\mathrm{d}x/\sqrt{x(4c-x)}$ let D_q be given by (74) with W_0 replaced by q. Then $D_{q_1 q_2} = D_{q_1} D_{q_2}$, and $D_q^2 = q$ for a positive constant q. Write $W_0 = C_n H_n(0^+) \cdot x^\alpha \cdot q_2 \cdot r_n$ with $q_2(x) := (4c - x) H_n(x)/H_n(0^+)$. Then on a lip

$$\frac{D_W^2}{W_0} = \frac{D_{x^\alpha}(z)^2}{z^\alpha} \cdot \frac{D_{q_2}(z)^2}{q_2(z)} \cdot \frac{D_{r_n}(z)^2}{r_n(z)}, \tag{92}$$

where z^α, $q_2(z)$, $r_n(z)$ are the continuations from the band. For q analytic near a point z off $[0,4c]$, the identity $\frac{\mathcal{R}(z)}{\pi}\int_0^{4c}\frac{\mathrm{d}x}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}(z-x)}=1$ gives

$$\log\frac{D_q(z)^2}{q(z)}=\frac{\mathcal{R}(z)}{\pi}\int_0^{4c}\big(\log q(x)-\log q(z)\big)\frac{\mathrm{d}x}{\sqrt{x(4c-x)}\,(z-x)}. \tag{93}$$

On the lips in $U(0,\delta)$, by (76),

$$|\mathcal{R}(z)|\le C|z|^{1/2},\qquad |z-x|\ge \sin(\tfrac{3}{8}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}})\,(x+|z|)\quad (x\ge 0), \tag{94}$$

the second because $|z-x|^2\ge(1-\cos\arg z)(x^2+|z|^2)\ge\frac12(1-\cos\arg z)(x+|z|)^2$.

Step 1: the factor x^α. Let $\Upsilon(z):=(z^{1/2}+(z-4c)^{1/2})^2$. It is analytic and non-zero off $[0,4c]$ (on $(-\infty,0)$ both roots change sign and Υ does not), $\Upsilon(z)\sim 4z$ at infinity, and $\Upsilon_\pm(x)=(x^{1/2}\pm i(4c-x)^{1/2})^2$ on the band, so $\Upsilon_+\Upsilon_-=16c^2$. The function $4cz/\Upsilon$ is analytic and non-zero on the simply connected set $\hat{\mathbb{C}}\setminus[0,4c]$, positive on $\mathbb{R}\setminus[0,4c]$, and its two boundary values on the band are complex conjugate with product x^2. Taking the logarithm that is real on $\mathbb{R}\setminus[0,4c]$, the function $F:=(4cz/\Upsilon)^{\alpha/2}$ satisfies $F_+F_-=x^\alpha$, is finite and non-zero at infinity, and $|\log F|=O(\log(1/|z|))$ near 0, $O(1)$ near $4c$. The same holds for D_{x^α}. The difference $g:=\log D_{x^\alpha}-\log F$ satisfies $g_++g_-=0$ on the band, so $g/\mathcal{R}$ has no jump there; its singularities at 0 and $4c$ are $O(|z-z_0|^{-1/2}\log)$, hence removable, and $g/\mathcal{R}\to 0$ at infinity. So $g\equiv 0$ and

$$D_{x^\alpha}(z)^2=\Big(\frac{4cz}{\Upsilon(z)}\Big)^\alpha.$$

Near 0, $\Upsilon(z)=-4c\,(1+O(|z|^{1/2}))$ in both half-planes, so $4cz/\Upsilon=(-z)(1+O(|z|^{1/2}))$, and both logarithms are real on $(-\delta,0)$. Hence $D^2_{x^\alpha}=(-z)^\alpha(1+O(|z|^{1/2}))$, and since $(-z)^\alpha=e^{\mp i\pi\alpha}z^\alpha$ in $\mathbb{C}_\pm$,

$$\frac{D_{x^\alpha}(z)^2}{z^\alpha}=c_\pm\big(1+O(|z|^{1/2})\big).$$

Step 2: the factor q_2. By (89), $|\log q_2(x)-\log q_2(z)|\le C(x^{\nu_p}+|z|^{\nu_p})$ for $x\le 2c$, and $\le C(1+|\log(4c-x)|)$ for $2c\le x<4c$. Insert this in (93) and use (94). The part $x\ge 2c$ contributes $C|z|^{1/2}\int_{2c}^{4c}(1+|\log(4c-x)|)(4c-x)^{-1/2}\,\mathrm{d}x\le C|z|^{1/2}$. For the part $x\le 2c$ substitute $x=|z|u$:

$$C|z|^{1/2}\int_0^{2c}\frac{(x^{\nu_p}+|z|^{\nu_p})\,\mathrm{d}x}{x^{1/2}(x+|z|)}=C|z|^{\nu_p}\int_0^{2c/|z|}\frac{(u^{\nu_p}+1)\,\mathrm{d}u}{u^{1/2}(1+u)}\le C|z|^{\nu_p}\log(2/|z|),$$

since the integral converges at infinity if $\nu_p<\frac12$ and grows like $\log(1/|z|)$ if $\nu_p=\frac12$. So $|\log(D^2_{q_2}/q_2)|\le C|z|^{\nu_p}\log(2/|z|)$.

Step 3: the slowly varying factor. Here $\log r_n(z)=\Lambda(\xi(z))-\Lambda(\log n)$ with $\xi(z)=\log n-\frac1p\log z$. Fix z on an upper lip and $x\in(0,4c]$, and join z to x by the arc of radius $|z|$ from $\arg z$ to 0, followed by the segment between $|z|$ and x. Every point z' of this path has $|z'|\le\max(\delta,4c)$ and $0\le\arg z'\le\frac54\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$, so

$$\Re\xi(z')\ge T_n,\qquad |\Im\xi(z')|\le\frac{5\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}}{4p}\le\vartheta_p,$$

the last inequality being $\frac{5\pi}{12p}<\frac{\pi}{p}$ for $p>1$, $\frac{5\pi}{12}<\frac{\pi}{2}$ for $p=1$ and $\frac{5\pi}{16}<\frac{\pi}{2}$ for $p<1$. So the image of the path lies in $S_{\vartheta_p}\cap\{\Re\xi\ge T_n\}$, where $|\Lambda'|\le\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)$. Its length in the ξ-variable is

$(\arg z + |\log(x/|z|)|)/p$. Therefore

$$|\log r_n(x) - \log r_n(z)| \le \frac{\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)}{p}\big(\pi + |\log(x/|z|)|\big). \tag{95}$$

This bound is invariant under $x \mapsto tx$, $z \mapsto tz$. Inserting it in (93) with (94), the part $x \le 2c$ is at most

$$C\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)|z|^{1/2}\int_0^{2c}\frac{(\pi + |\log(x/|z|)|)\,\mathrm{d}x}{x^{1/2}(x+|z|)} \le C\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)\int_0^\infty \frac{(\pi+|\log u|)\,\mathrm{d}u}{u^{1/2}(1+u)} = C'\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n),$$

and the part $x \ge 2c$ is at most $C\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)|z|^{1/2}\log(4c/|z|) \le C\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)$. The lower lips are the mirror image. So $|\log(D_{r_n}^2/r_n)| \le C\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)$.

Step 4: conclusion. By (92) and Steps 1–3, $D_W^2/W_0 = c_\pm e^w$ with $|w| \le C(|z|^{1/2} + |z|^{\nu_p}\log(2/|z|) + \varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)) \le C_0$; since $|e^w - 1| \le e^{C_0}|w|$, $|c_\pm| = 1$ and $|z|^{1/2} \le |z|^{\nu_p}$, (90) follows. By (83),

$$|d_n(z)| \le C\big(|z|^{\nu_p}\log(2/|z|) + \varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)\big)e^{-n|z|^{1/2}/C} \le C\varepsilon_n',$$

because with $t = n|z|^{1/2}$ the first term is $t^{2\nu_p}n^{-2\nu_p}(\log 2 + 2\log n - 2\log t)e^{-t/C} \le Cn^{-2\nu_p}\log n$. On the lips E is at most $Ce^{-n/C}$ by (F4), since $\exp(-n|z|^{-1/p}/C)|z|^{-C} \le C'e^{-n/C'}$ for $|z| \le \delta$. Together with the bounds on the circles and on the rest of Σ stated at the end of Section 7.3 this gives (91). □

For $\ell_1 \equiv 1$ we have $\varepsilon_\Lambda \equiv 0$, and Lemma 7.3 reduces to its Hölder part.

7.5. **Uniform invertibility.** The comparison problem is explicit, but its solution is unbounded near 0 at the Bessel scale: on $|\zeta| \le 2$ it has size $n^{1/2}|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|/2}$. The following proposition says that, nevertheless, the singular integral operator attached to it is boundedly invertible on L^2, uniformly in n.

Proposition 7.4 (uniform resolvent bound for the comparison problem)**.** *There are n_0 and C such that for $n \ge n_0$:*

(i) $\tilde Q_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\hat\Sigma))$ *and* $\tilde Q_\pm^{-1} \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\hat\Sigma))$*;*

(ii) $\|\mathcal{C}_\pm\|_{L^2(\hat\Sigma)\to L^2(\hat\Sigma)} \le C$*, and* $1 - \mathcal{C}_{\tilde v}$ *is invertible on* $L^2(\hat\Sigma)$ *with* $\|(1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})^{-1}\| \le C$*.*

The proof is in Appendix B. We describe its structure, and where $|\alpha| < 1$ enters.

Reduction. By the easy half of T3(e), which we re-prove, it suffices to solve the inhomogeneous problem $m_+ = m_-\tilde v + \mathfrak{g}$, $m_\pm \in \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$, with $\|m_\pm\| \le C\|\mathfrak{g}\|$, for $\mathfrak{g}$ in a dense subspace of $L^2(\hat\Sigma)$, and to show that the homogeneous problem has only the trivial solution. Uniqueness follows from T3(b) once (i) is known. For existence we use the explicit candidate $m := \mathcal{C}(\mathfrak{g}\tilde Q_+^{-1})\tilde Q$, which satisfies $m_+ - m_-\tilde v = \mathfrak{g}$ by the jump relation $\mathcal{C}_+ - \mathcal{C}_- = 1$.

The uniform bound. Away from the two discs $\tilde Q^{\pm 1}$ is bounded and the bound $\|m_\pm\| \le C\|\mathfrak{g}\|$ reduces to the boundedness of $\mathcal{C}_\pm$. Near 0 we write $\tilde Q = A_0(2\pi)^{\sigma_3/2}n^{\sigma_3/2}\Phi_\alpha(n^2 f)$ and pass to the variable ζ. The analytic prefactor contributes commutator terms with bounded kernels, which are Hilbert–Schmidt with norms $O(1)$; this uses $\int_{|\zeta|\le 3}|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|}|\,\mathrm{d}\zeta| < \infty$ on each ray, i.e. $|\alpha| < 1$. What remains is a model operator on a star of three rays. For $|\zeta| \ge 2$ it is the Cauchy operator conjugated by $|\zeta|^{\pm 1/4}$; for $|\zeta| \le 3$ it is the Cauchy operator conjugated by $|\zeta|^{\pm\alpha/2}$ (Lemma A.1 with $\beta = \pm\alpha/2$, which requires $|\beta| < \frac12$, i.e. $|\alpha| < 1$), or, at $\alpha = 0$, the Cauchy operator plus a logarithmic commutator (Lemma A.2). All these operators are dilation invariant, so their norms do not depend on n. The soft edge is treated in the same way, with the Airy model in place of Φ_α; it involves no α.

Membership in $\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$. The candidate m is a Cauchy integral times $\tilde{Q}$, and one has to check that it is itself the Cauchy integral of its jump. We check this only for data $\mathfrak{g}$ that are C^1 on the arcs of $\hat{\Sigma}$ and vanish near its vertices. Then m is continuous up to the contour away from the vertices, of size $O(|z|^{-|\alpha|/2})$ at 0, and Cauchy's integral formula, applied on the complement of the contour and of small discs around the vertices, gives $m = \mathcal{C}(m_+ - m_-)$. The uniform bound then extends the inverse from this dense class to all of L^2. The same argument applied to $\tilde{Q}^{\pm 1} - I$ gives (i); this is where the square integrability of $|z|^{-|\alpha|/2}$ on the contour, i.e. $|\alpha| < 1$, is used.

Theorem 7.5 (uniform resolvent bound for the true problem)**.** *Extend v by I to $\Sigma_\circ$. There is n_1 such that for $n \geq n_1$ the operator $1 - \mathcal{C}_v$ is invertible on $L^2(\hat{\Sigma})$ and $\|(1-\mathcal{C}_v)^{-1}\| \leq 2C$, with C from Proposition 7.4. Moreover $Q_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\hat{\Sigma}))$ and $Q_- = (1-\mathcal{C}_v)^{-1} I$.*

Proof. Since $\mathcal{C}_v f - \mathcal{C}_{\tilde{v}} f = \mathcal{C}_-(f(v-\tilde{v}))$, Proposition 7.4(ii) and (91) give $\|\mathcal{C}_v - \mathcal{C}_{\tilde{v}}\| \leq C(\varepsilon'_n + n^{-1})$, which is at most $1/(2C)$ for large n. The Neumann-series step T3(d) of Conway and Deift then gives the bound. Here only the convergence $\varepsilon'_n \to 0$ is used, not its rate.

By (F7), $Q - I = \mathcal{C}_\Sigma(Q_+ - Q_-)$. On $\Sigma_\circ$ the function Q has no jump, and it is bounded there by (F7) (the circles stay away from 0), so its values on $\Sigma_\circ$ are the boundary values of the same Cauchy integral, now regarded on $\hat{\Sigma}$ with density 0 on $\Sigma_\circ$. Hence $Q_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\hat{\Sigma}))$. Then $Q_- - I = \mathcal{C}_-(Q_+ - Q_-) = \mathcal{C}_-(Q_-(v-I))$, i.e. $(1-\mathcal{C}_v)Q_- = I$ in $L^2(\hat{\Sigma})$ ($\hat{\Sigma}$ has finite length, so $I \in L^2(\hat{\Sigma})$), and $Q_- = (1-\mathcal{C}_v)^{-1} I$. □

7.6. **The effect of the mismatch on the moments.** Write $Q = I + Q_1/z + Q_2/z^2 + O(z^{-3})$ and $P_0^\infty = I + P_1/z + P_2/z^2 + O(z^{-3})$ at infinity; outside the discs $\tilde{Q} = P_0^\infty$, so $\tilde{Q}_k = P_k$. The circle terms

$$\Xi_k := -\frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{\Sigma_\circ} s^{k-1} \big(\tilde{Q}_{\mathrm{in}}(s)\tilde{Q}_{\mathrm{out}}(s)^{-1} - I\big)\,\mathrm{d}s \qquad (k = 1, 2) \tag{96}$$

are $O(1/n)$ by Lemma 7.2(iii) and (F5); they are the first-order corrections of the comparison problem itself.

Proposition 7.6 (the mismatch moves the moments by $O(\varepsilon'_n/n)$)**.** *For $n \geq n_1$,*

$$Q_1 = P_1 + \Xi_1 + O\big(\varepsilon'_n/n + n^{-2}\big),$$
$$Q_2 = P_2 + \Xi_2 + (Q_1 - P_1)P_1 + O\big(\varepsilon'_n/n + n^{-2}\big).$$

The lip mismatch d_n contributes $O(\varepsilon'_n/n)$; the remaining errors come from the interaction of the circle terms with themselves and are $O(n^{-2})$. In particular $Q_k = P_k + O(1/n)$ for $k = 1, 2$.

Proof. We apply T3(b) and its consequence (18) with $A = Q$, $B = \tilde{Q}$, $v_A = v$, $v_B = \tilde{v}$ on $\hat{\Sigma}$, $p = q = 2$. The hypotheses hold: $v, \tilde{v}^{\pm 1} \in L^\infty$, $Q_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$ by Theorem 7.5, and $\tilde{Q}_\pm^{\pm 1} \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$ by Proposition 7.4(i). With $\mathfrak{h} := Q_-(v - \tilde{v})\tilde{v}^{-1}\tilde{Q}_-^{-1}$, (18) reads

$$Q_1 - P_1 = -\frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_{\hat{\Sigma}} \mathfrak{h}\,\mathrm{d}s, \qquad Q_2 - P_2 = -\frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_{\hat{\Sigma}} s\,\mathfrak{h}\,\mathrm{d}s + (Q_1 - P_1)P_1.$$

Split $(v - \tilde{v})\tilde{v}^{-1} = \Delta_1 + \Delta_2 + \Delta_3$, where $\Delta_1 := d_n e_2 e_1^{\mathsf{T}}$ on the lips in $U(0, \delta)$ (we used $e_1^{\mathsf{T}}\tilde{v}^{-1} = e_1^{\mathsf{T}}$ there), $\Delta_2 := \tilde{v}^{-1} - I$ on $\Sigma_\circ$, and Δ_3 is the rest: $E\tilde{v}^{-1}$ on the lips and $v - I$ on $\Sigma \setminus (U(0,\delta) \cup U(4c, \varepsilon) \cup [0, 4c])$. Then $\|\Delta_3\|_{L^\infty} \leq Ce^{-n/C}$, on a set of length $O(n^p)$. Write $Q_- = \tilde{Q}_- + (Q_- - \tilde{Q}_-)$.

Pointwise bounds on the lips. On the lips in $U(0,\delta)$ we have, by (85) and (82),

$$\tilde Q_-\Delta_1\tilde Q_-^{-1}=\Big(\frac{D_W^2}{W_0}-c_\pm\Big)e^{-4\zeta^{1/2}}\,A_0(2\pi)^{\sigma_3/2}\Big[n^{\sigma_3/2}\Phi_{\alpha,-}e_2e_1^{\mathsf T}\Phi_{\alpha,-}^{-1}n^{-\sigma_3/2}\Big](2\pi)^{-\sigma_3/2}A_0^{-1}.$$

If $|\zeta|\ge 2$, then $n^{\sigma_3/2}\Phi_\alpha=f^{-\sigma_3/4}\Theta_\infty$ by (80), so the bracket is at most $C|f|^{-1/2}\le C|z|^{-1/2}$, and $|e^{-4\zeta^{1/2}}|\le e^{-n|z|^{1/2}/C}$ by (83). If $|\zeta|\le 2$, the identity

$$\Phi_\alpha e_2e_1^{\mathsf T}\Phi_\alpha^{-1}=-e^{4\zeta^{1/2}}\sigma_3\Psi_\alpha e_2e_1^{\mathsf T}\Psi_\alpha^{-1}\sigma_3$$

and Lemma 7.1(iii) bound the bracket times $e^{-4\zeta^{1/2}}$ by $Cn|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|}$. With $\mathfrak m_n(z):=|z|^{\nu_p}\log(2/|z|)+\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)$ from (90),

$$|\tilde Q_-\Delta_1\tilde Q_-^{-1}|\le C\mathfrak m_n(z)\cdot\begin{cases}n|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|}, & |\zeta|\le 2,\\ |z|^{-1/2}e^{-n|z|^{1/2}/C}, & |\zeta|\ge 2.\end{cases}\tag{97}$$

In the same way, $\Phi_\alpha e_2=\zeta^{-\sigma_3/4}\Theta_\infty e_2$ and $e_1^{\mathsf T}\Phi_\alpha^{-1}=e_1^{\mathsf T}\Theta_\infty^{-1}\zeta^{\sigma_3/4}$ for $|\zeta|\ge 2$, and $|\Phi_\alpha^{\pm1}|\le C|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|/2}$ for $|\zeta|\le 2$, give

$$|d_n\tilde Q_-e_2|+|d_ne_1^{\mathsf T}\tilde Q_-^{-1}|\le C\mathfrak m_n(z)\cdot\begin{cases}n^{1/2}|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|/2}, & |\zeta|\le 2,\\ |z|^{-1/4}e^{-n|z|^{1/2}/C}, & |\zeta|\ge 2.\end{cases}\tag{98}$$

For $\alpha=0$, replace $|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|}$ by $(1+|\log|\zeta||)^2$ and $|\zeta|^{-|\alpha|/2}$ by $1+|\log|\zeta||$.

Bessel localisation. We integrate (97) along the lips, on which $|\,\mathrm dz|\le C\,\mathrm d|z|$ and $|\zeta|\ge n^2|z|/C$. The region $|\zeta|\le 2$ lies in $|z|\le Cn^{-2}$, where $\mathfrak m_n\le C\varepsilon_n'$; its contribution is at most

$$C\varepsilon_n'\int_0^{Cn^{-2}} n\,(n^2r/C)^{-|\alpha|}\,\mathrm dr=\frac{C\varepsilon_n'}{n}\int_0^C u^{-|\alpha|}\,\mathrm du=O(\varepsilon_n'/n),$$

because $|\alpha|<1$. In the region $|\zeta|\ge 2$ substitute $t=nr^{1/2}$:

$$\begin{aligned}\int_0^\delta \mathfrak m_n(r)r^{-1/2}e^{-nr^{1/2}/C}\,\mathrm dr&=\frac2n\int_0^{n\delta^{1/2}}\mathfrak m_n(t^2/n^2)e^{-t/C}\,\mathrm dt\\&\le\frac{C}{n}\big(\varepsilon_\Lambda(T_n)+n^{-2\nu_p}\log n\big)=O(\varepsilon_n'/n).\end{aligned}$$

So $\int|\tilde Q_-\Delta_1\tilde Q_-^{-1}||\,\mathrm ds|=O(\varepsilon_n'/n)$; the same computation applied to the square of (98) gives

$$\|d_n\tilde Q_-e_2\|_{L^2}^2+\|d_ne_1^{\mathsf T}\tilde Q_-^{-1}\|_{L^2}^2=O(\varepsilon_n'^2/n).\tag{99}$$

(For $\alpha=0$ the factor $\int_0^C u^{-|\alpha|}\,\mathrm du$ becomes $\int_0^C(1+|\log u|)^2\,\mathrm du<\infty$.)

The other main terms. On $\Sigma_\circ$, $\tilde Q_-\Delta_2\tilde Q_-^{-1}=\tilde Q_{\mathrm{in}}\tilde Q_{\mathrm{out}}^{-1}-I$, whose integrals are exactly the circle terms Ξ_k. The term Δ_3 contributes $O(e^{-n/C})$: on $\Sigma\setminus(U(0,\delta)\cup U(4c,\varepsilon))$, $\tilde Q^{\pm1}=(P_0^\infty)^{\pm1}$ is bounded and $|s|\le Cn^p$, and on the lips $|E||\tilde Q_-||\tilde Q_-^{-1}|\le C\exp(-n|z|^{-1/p}/C)|z|^{-C}n^C$, whose integral is $O(e^{-n/C})$.

The correction term. By Theorem 7.5 and T3(c) applied to both problems, $Q_-=I+\mathcal C_vQ_-$ and $\tilde Q_-=I+\mathcal C_{\tilde v}\tilde Q_-$, so $(1-\mathcal C_v)(Q_--\tilde Q_-)=\mathcal C_-(\tilde Q_-(v-\tilde v))$ and

$$\|Q_--\tilde Q_-\|_{L^2}\le 2C\,\|\mathcal C_-\|\,\|\tilde Q_-(v-\tilde v)\|_{L^2}\le C\big(\|d_n\tilde Q_-e_2\|_{L^2}+n^{-1}+e^{-n/C}\big)\le C\big(\varepsilon_n'n^{-1/2}+n^{-1}\big),$$

using (99), the bound $O(1/n)$ for $v-\tilde v$ on the circles (where $\tilde Q_-$ is bounded), and Δ_3. Similarly $\|(v-\tilde v)\tilde v^{-1}\tilde Q_-^{-1}\|_{L^2}\le C(\varepsilon_n'n^{-1/2}+n^{-1})$. By the Cauchy–Schwarz inequality,

$$\Big|\int(Q_--\tilde Q_-)(v-\tilde v)\tilde v^{-1}\tilde Q_-^{-1}\,\mathrm ds\Big|\le C\big(\varepsilon_n'n^{-1/2}+n^{-1}\big)^2\le C\big(\varepsilon_n'^2/n+n^{-2}\big).$$

The factor s in the second moment is bounded on the lips and the circles, and costs at most n^p on the rest, where everything is exponentially small. Collecting terms gives the proposition. □

Remark 7.7 (what is not proved). Proposition 7.6 isolates the non-Fisher–Hartwig part of the hard edge: relative to the comparison problem, the lip mismatch moves Q_1 and Q_2 by $O(\varepsilon'_n/n)$. The comparison problem itself depends on ℓ_1 at order $1/n$. At the hard edge it does not: $\tilde{Q}_{\mathrm{in}}\tilde{Q}_{\mathrm{out}}^{-1} = \hat{P}_0(P_0^{\infty})^{-1}$ on $\partial U(0,\delta)$ involves only α, f and c. But at the soft edge the Airy parametrix contains the weight through D_W, so the circle terms Ξ_k may depend on ℓ_1. We do not analyse them, and we make no claim that $b_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell_1})/b_n(\sigma_{p,s}) - 1 = O(\varepsilon_\Lambda/n)$. The $O(1/n)$ in Theorem 4 is absolute, not relative.

Remark 7.8 (the case $\alpha \geq 1$). For $\alpha \geq 1$ the comparison frame fails at three places. The solution $\tilde{Q}$ is of size $n^{1/2}|\zeta|^{-\alpha/2}$ at the Bessel scale and is not square integrable on the lips near 0, so T3(b) does not apply with $p = q = 2$; Lemma A.1 needs $|\beta| = \alpha/2 < \frac{1}{2}$; and the integral $\int_0^2 u^{-\alpha}\,du$ in the Bessel localisation diverges. (Since $s > 1$, always $\alpha > -1$.) This is why the base window $|\alpha| < 1$ is combined with the Christoffel shift (Theorem 3). It is consistent with the remark of Deift and Piorkowski [6, §1] that, for a weight vanishing to first order at an endpoint, "the crucial Theorem 4.7 in [CD] requires a different proof in this case: now one needs to control the behaviour of the Cauchy operator acting on spaces with Muckenhoupt weights". An analysis of the weight itself for $\alpha \geq 1$ remains open (Section 10).

8. Extraction: proof of Theorem 4

The recurrence coefficients are read off from the first two coefficients at infinity. For a matrix function X that is analytic near infinity with

$$X(z) = I + \frac{X_1}{z} + \frac{X_2}{z^2} + O(z^{-3}) \qquad (z \to \infty)$$

we put

$$\Pi(X) := (X_1)_{12}(X_1)_{21}, \qquad \mathsf{a}(X) := \frac{(X_2)_{12}}{(X_1)_{12}} - (X_1)_{22} \tag{100}$$

(the second whenever $(X_1)_{12} \neq 0$; this is the functional of (35)). By (17) (see also Lemma 5.1), the matrix Y of degree n in (16) satisfies $\Pi(Yz^{-n\sigma_3}) = b_n^2$ and $\mathsf{a}(Yz^{-n\sigma_3}) = a_n$. We stress the indexing, since it matters for any statement about the $1/n$ terms: both functionals come from the *same* matrix of degree n, a_n is the coefficient of P_n in xP_n, and $b_n^2 = h_n/h_{n-1}$ couples P_{n-1} and P_n, as in (10). So the ratio $a_n/(2b_n)$ in Theorem 4 pairs the diagonal entry at P_n with the off-diagonal entry between P_{n-1} and P_n.

Lemma 8.1 (invariance of the extraction functionals). (i) *Let $X = I + X_1/z + X_2/z^2 + O(z^{-3})$, and let k be a scalar function, analytic and non-zero near infinity, with $k(z) = k_\infty\big(1 + k_1/z + k_2/z^2 + O(z^{-3})\big)$, $k_\infty \neq 0$. Then $\hat{X} := k_\infty^{-\sigma_3} X k^{\sigma_3}$ satisfies $\hat{X} \to I$, $\Pi(\hat{X}) = \Pi(X)$ and $\mathsf{a}(\hat{X}) = \mathsf{a}(X)$. Conversely, if C is a constant matrix and $CXk^{\sigma_3} \to I$, then $C = k_\infty^{-\sigma_3}$.*
(ii) ((38)) *Let $U(z) = n^{p\sigma_3}Y(z/n^p)$. Then $\Pi(Uz^{-n\sigma_3}) = n^{2p}b_n^2$ and $\mathsf{a}(Uz^{-n\sigma_3}) = n^p a_n$.*

Proof. (i) Put $Z_j := k_\infty^{-\sigma_3} X_j k_\infty^{\sigma_3}$; then $(Z_j)_{12} = k_\infty^{-2}(X_j)_{12}$, $(Z_j)_{21} = k_\infty^2(X_j)_{21}$, and the diagonal entries are unchanged. Since $k^{\sigma_3} = k_\infty^{\sigma_3}\operatorname{diag}\big(1 + k_1 z^{-1} + k_2 z^{-2},\, 1 - k_1 z^{-1} + (k_1^2 - k_2)z^{-2}\big) + O(z^{-3})$,

$$\hat{X}_1 = Z_1 + k_1\sigma_3, \qquad \hat{X}_2 = Z_2 + Z_1\operatorname{diag}(k_1, -k_1) + \operatorname{diag}(k_2, k_1^2 - k_2).$$

Hence $(\hat X_1)_{12}(\hat X_1)_{21} = (Z_1)_{12}(Z_1)_{21} = \Pi(X)$, and with $(\hat X_2)_{12} = (Z_2)_{12} - k_1(Z_1)_{12}$ and $(\hat X_1)_{22} = (X_1)_{22} - k_1$,

$$\mathsf{a}(\hat X) = \frac{(Z_2)_{12}}{(Z_1)_{12}} - k_1 - (X_1)_{22} + k_1 = \frac{(X_2)_{12}}{(X_1)_{12}} - (X_1)_{22} = \mathsf{a}(X).$$

If $CXk^{\sigma_3} \to I$ then $Ck_\infty^{\sigma_3} = I$.

(ii) With $x = z/n^p$ we have $z^{-n\sigma_3} = x^{-n\sigma_3} n^{-pn\sigma_3}$, so $Uz^{-n\sigma_3} = n^{pn\sigma_3}\big(Y(x)x^{-n\sigma_3}\big)n^{-pn\sigma_3} = I + n^p\, n^{pn\sigma_3} Y_1 n^{-pn\sigma_3} z^{-1} + n^{2p}\, n^{pn\sigma_3} Y_2 n^{-pn\sigma_3} z^{-2} + O(z^{-3})$, where Y_1, Y_2 are the coefficients of $Yx^{-n\sigma_3}$. The conjugation by $n^{pn\sigma_3}$ cancels in Π and in the quotient defining a, so $\Pi(Uz^{-n\sigma_3}) = n^{2p}\Pi(Yx^{-n\sigma_3}) = n^{2p} b_n^2$ and $\mathsf{a}(Uz^{-n\sigma_3}) = n^p \mathsf{a}(Yx^{-n\sigma_3}) = n^p a_n$ by (17). □

All transformations of Sections 5 and 6 act, in a neighbourhood of infinity, by a constant diagonal matrix on the left and by k^{σ_3} on the right, where k is a scalar analytic and non-zero at infinity: the product of z^n, the outer scalar, the factor $e^{-n(g-\log z)}$ (whose combination is analytic at infinity, Section 6), and D_W/D_∞. Lemma 8.1 therefore gives the extraction identities (F8),

$$(Q_1)_{12}(Q_1)_{21} = n^{2p} b_n^2, \qquad \mathsf{a}(Q) = n^p a_n.$$

Only the existence of the expansion of k at infinity is used, for each fixed n; no uniformity in n is needed. For the factor D_W/D_∞ this is the finiteness of the $1/z$ coefficient of $\log D_W$, which by (74) is an integral of $\log W_0$ against a bounded multiple of $\mathrm{d}x/\sqrt{x(4c-x)}$; it is finite because $|\log r_n(x)| \le C_n(1 + |\log x|)$ and $\log H_n$ is bounded on $(0, 4c]$.

Proof of Theorem 4. Let $p > 0$, $1 < s < 1 + 2p$ and let ℓ_1 satisfy $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$. For $n \ge n_1$, Proposition 7.6 gives $Q_1 = P_1 + O(1/n)$ and $Q_2 = P_2 + O(1/n)$, where P_1, P_2 are the coefficients of the global parametrix (75). We compute them. With $a(z) = (1 - 4c/z)^{1/4}$,

$$a = 1 - \frac{c}{z} - \frac{3c^2}{2z^2} + O(z^{-3}), \qquad a^{-1} = 1 + \frac{c}{z} + \frac{5c^2}{2z^2} + O(z^{-3}),$$

so $\frac12(a + a^{-1}) = 1 + \frac{c^2}{2z^2} + O(z^{-3})$ and $\frac{1}{2i}(a - a^{-1}) = \frac{ic}{z} + \frac{2ic^2}{z^2} + O(z^{-3})$. Hence

$$(P_1)_{12} = ic, \quad (P_1)_{21} = -ic, \quad (P_1)_{22} = 0, \quad (P_2)_{12} = 2ic^2,$$

and $\Pi(P_0^\infty) = c^2$, $\mathsf{a}(P_0^\infty) = 2c$. (If the off-diagonal entries of P_0^∞ carry the opposite signs, or if a is replaced by a^{-1}, these two values are unchanged.) By (F8),

$$n^{2p} b_n^2 = (Q_1)_{12}(Q_1)_{21} = \big(ic + O(\tfrac1n)\big)\big(-ic + O(\tfrac1n)\big) = c^2\big(1 + O(\tfrac1n)\big),$$

so $n^p b_n = c(1 + O(1/n))$ since $b_n > 0$. Since $(Q_1)_{12} = ic + O(1/n) \ne 0$ for large n,

$$n^p a_n = \mathsf{a}(Q) = \frac{2ic^2 + O(1/n)}{ic + O(1/n)} - O(\tfrac1n) = 2c\big(1 + O(\tfrac1n)\big),$$

and therefore $a_n/(2b_n) = 1 + O(1/n)$. The constants depend on p, s and ℓ_1. Here $c = c(p)$ is the constant of (3), because the band of the equilibrium measure is $[0, 4c(p)]$ (Proposition 2.5). □

Remark 8.2 (why $c(p)$). The limits come entirely from the global parametrix: $\Pi(P_0^\infty) = c^2$ and $\mathsf{a}(P_0^\infty) = 2c$ are the recurrence data of the arcsine (Chebyshev) problem on $[0, 4c]$, whose Jacobi matrix has diagonal $2c$ and off-diagonal c. The length $4c$ of the band is fixed by the saturation of the constrained equilibrium problem (Proposition 2.5). The weight, including the slowly varying factor, affects only the $O(1/n)$ terms, through the circle terms and the lip mismatch of Proposition 7.6.

9. Numerical illustrations

The computations in this section are floating-point computations; they illustrate the theorems and play no role in their proofs. They were carried out with scripts that will be made available as supplementary material (repository URL and commit hash: to be supplied before submission).

What is shown. Table 2 compares the slowly varying factor $\ell(k) = \exp\sqrt{\log(k+e)}$, which satisfies $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$ for every $p > 0$, with the pure power $\ell \equiv 1$, in the three geometries $p = \frac{1}{2}$, $p = 1$ and $p = 2$, all with $s = 2$. By Theorems 1(iii) and 2, the four quantities

$$n\Big(\frac{n^p b_n}{c(p)} - 1\Big) \qquad \text{and} \qquad n\Big(\frac{a_n}{2b_n} - 1\Big),$$

for ℓ and for $\ell \equiv 1$, stay bounded. The Bessel orders are $\alpha = 1$, 0 and $-\frac{1}{2}$. The first case lies outside the window $|\alpha| < 1$ of Theorem 4 and is reached only through the shift (Theorem 3, from $s = \frac{3}{2}$, where $\alpha = 0$). The second is the case $\alpha = 0$, which needs the logarithmic form of the Bessel model. The third lies inside the window.

How the numbers were computed. The recurrence coefficients cannot be computed from the atoms $k \le K$ alone. The spectral weight of P_n near the hard edge sits at indices $k \asymp n^{1+2/p}$, which is about 10^{16} for $p = \frac{1}{2}$ and $n = 1600$, far beyond any truncation. Without a tail the truncated measure has a soft edge at its smallest atom, and its coefficients obey a different law; for example, for $p = \frac{1}{2}$, $s = \frac{3}{2}$, the same ℓ and the atoms $k \le 2{\cdot}10^5$ alone, $n(n^p b_n/c(p){-}1)$ equals -1.81, -13.3 and -105.9 at $n = 100$, 400 and 1600. This is a property of the truncation, not a counterexample. We therefore used the atoms $k \le K$ exactly, together with a Gauss–Legendre quadrature of the continuous tail $\int_{K+1/2}^{T} t^{-s}\ell(t)\,\delta_{t-p}\,\mathrm{d}t$ on logarithmic panels (ratio 1.02, eight nodes per panel), with $T = 10^{48}$ for $p = \frac{1}{2}$ and $T = 10^{16}$ for $p = 1, 2$. The Jacobi matrix of the resulting discrete measure was computed by an updating (RKPW-type) algorithm in extended (long double) precision. Each entry was computed for $K = 10^5$ and $K = 2 \cdot 10^5$, and for $K = 2 \cdot 10^5$ with T reduced by a factor 10^4. The largest change of any tabulated entry under these variations is 10^{-7} for $p = \frac{1}{2}$, $2 \cdot 10^{-8}$ for $p = 1$ and $2 \cdot 10^{-11}$ for $p = 2$, so all digits shown are stable. As a further check, the column $\ell \equiv 1$ at $p = 2$ agrees in every digit shown with the closed form of Remark 1.8.

What the table shows. All entries stay bounded, as the theorems require. For the pure powers the two normalised deviations approach $-(s-1)/2 = -\frac{1}{2}$ and $-p/2$ in all three geometries. For ℓ the deviation of $n^p b_n$ is smaller in absolute value, and the difference from the pure power drifts slowly towards 0, roughly like $\frac{1}{2}\Lambda'(\log n)$ with $\Lambda(\xi) = \sqrt{\log(e^\xi + e)}$; see §10.1. The factor ℓ has almost no effect on $a_n/(2b_n)$ at order $1/n$.

10. Further remarks and open problems

10.1. **The $1/n$ term.** Theorems 1(iii) and 2 give the rate $O(1/n)$ but not the coefficient of $1/n$. The computations of Section 9, and similar ones for other s (for $p = \frac{1}{2}$, $s \in \{1.5, 1.75, 2, 2.5\}$; for $p = 1$, $s \in \{2, 2.5, 3\}$), suggest the following.

Conjecture 10.1. (a) *For every $p > 0$ and $s > 1$, the pure powers satisfy*

$$\frac{n^p b_n(\sigma_{p,s})}{c(p)} = 1 - \frac{s-1}{2n} + o\Big(\frac{1}{n}\Big), \qquad \frac{a_n(\sigma_{p,s})}{2b_n(\sigma_{p,s})} = 1 - \frac{p}{2n} + o\Big(\frac{1}{n}\Big).$$

(b) *If ℓ satisfies $(\mathrm{A}_{\vartheta_p})$ with $\ell(k) = \exp\Lambda(\log k)$, then*

$$\frac{n^p b_n(\sigma_{p,s,\ell})}{c(p)} = 1 - \frac{s - 1 - \Lambda'(\log n)}{2n} + o\Big(\frac{\Lambda'(\log n)}{n}\Big) \qquad \textit{whenever} \quad n\Lambda'(\log n) \to \infty.$$

	$n\big(n^p b_n/c(p)-1\big)$		$n\big(a_n/(2b_n)-1\big)$	
n	$\ell(k)=e^{\sqrt{\log(k+e)}}$	$\ell\equiv 1$	$\ell(k)=e^{\sqrt{\log(k+e)}}$	$\ell\equiv 1$
$p=\frac12$, $s=2$, $\alpha=1$ (reached through the shift)				
100	-0.4039	-0.5069	-0.2442	-0.2408
200	-0.4069	-0.5052	-0.2470	-0.2453
400	-0.4101	-0.5039	-0.2484	-0.2477
800	-0.4133	-0.5028	-0.2492	-0.2488
1600	-0.4163	-0.5020	-0.2496	-0.2494
$p=1$, $s=2$, $\alpha=0$				
50	-0.3821	-0.4934	-0.4954	-0.4950
100	-0.3893	-0.4967	-0.4978	-0.4975
200	-0.3958	-0.4983	-0.4989	-0.4987
400	-0.4015	-0.4992	-0.4994	-0.4994
800	-0.4065	-0.4996	-0.4997	-0.4997
$p=2$, $s=2$, $\alpha=-\frac12$				
50	-0.3794	-0.4938	-0.9756	-0.9780
100	-0.3868	-0.4969	-0.9878	-0.9889
200	-0.3936	-0.4984	-0.9939	-0.9944
400	-0.3995	-0.4992	-0.9970	-0.9972
800	-0.4046	-0.4996	-0.9985	-0.9986

TABLE 2. Normalised deviations from the pointwise law for $\sigma_{p,2,\ell}$, computed in extended precision from the atoms $k\le K$ and a quadrature of the continuous tail; all entries are stable under doubling of K and under a change of the tail cut-off (see the text). The limits $-(s-1)/2$ and $-p/2$ in the columns $\ell\equiv 1$ are observed, not proved. The slow drift of the first column is the effect of $\Lambda'(\log n)$ (§10.1). Source: supplementary script `table2`.

Part (a) holds for $(p,s)=(2,2)$, by the closed form of Remark 1.8 (granted the identification made there). Part (b) says that, at order $1/n$, a slowly varying factor acts like a change of the exponent s by the local logarithmic derivative $\Lambda'(\log n)$, i.e. like a hard-edge Bessel order that drifts with n. In Table 2 the difference between the first two columns is 0.91 to 0.99 times $\frac12\Lambda'(\log n)$, and this ratio increases with n in all three geometries. The $1/n$ coefficient behaves well under the shift: by the identities of Section 3, (a) at s implies (a) at $s+p$ provided the chain-sequence parameters of Section 3 have increments $n^p u_n-(n-1)^p u_{n-1}=o(1/n)$, a condition we can only check numerically. Within our method, (b) amounts to computing the main term of the comparison estimate of Section 7 (as Conway and Deift do for their weight [2, (5.5)]), which would need a Bessel parametrix with a drifting order.

10.2. **Other routes at $p=1$.** At $p=1$ the nodes $1/k$ become $\pm k^{-1/2}$ in the variable $y=\pm x^{1/2}$, which is the variable of [19]. We also carried out the analysis in that symmetric frame, where 0 is an interior point of the band with a Fisher–Hartwig exponent $s-\frac32$. The comparison method then needs this exponent in $(-\frac12,\frac12)$, so it covers only $1<s<2$; the loss is an effect of the frame, since $L^2(|\,\mathrm{d}y|)$ on a symmetric contour corresponds to $L^2(|x|^{-1/2}|\,\mathrm{d}x|)$ in x. Folding the symmetric problem gives a second proof of Theorem 4 at $p=1$ for $1<s<3$. It shares the decisive comparison step at $\alpha=0$ with Section 7, so it is not independent where it matters, and we do not include it. Finally, for pure powers and $p\neq 1$ the classical route also

works: one can glue a local Bessel parametrix built from a continuation of the band weight and conclude by a small-norm argument. At $p = 1$ that construction fails (Remark 6.3); the comparison argument is not affected, because it uses only boundary values of D_W and never continues the weight across $(-\delta, 0)$.

10.3. **Rough weights.** The announcement in §1.3 shows that the pointwise law can fail for weights $k^{-s}e^{f(k)}$ with $|f| \le \varepsilon$, although the averaged law holds for them. Two questions remain. First, between slow variation and arbitrary bounded oscillation there is a range of regularity conditions on f for which we do not know the answer. A simple test case is $f(k) = \varepsilon \sin \log k$: its increments $f(k+1) - f(k)$ tend to 0, but e^f is not slowly varying, so Theorem 1 does not apply. Second, for bounded rough f one may ask whether the law holds along a subsequence of density one; we do not know.

10.4. **Other nodes, larger Bessel orders, and zeta zeros.** Our nodes are exact powers k^{-p}. For nodes $x_k = f(k)$ with f regularly varying of index $-p$ the averaged law is known [15], but the pointwise law is open. Heuristically one expects $b_n/f(n) \to c(p)$ under smooth regular variation of f, and failure under rough displacements of the nodes, in analogy with the weights.

For Bessel orders $\alpha \ge 1$ we pass through the shift (Theorem 3). An RH analysis of the weight itself for $\alpha \ge 1$ would require a different comparison frame (Remark 7.8); it would be needed to compute the $1/n$ term directly in that range.

A natural measure outside our scope is built from the ordinates γ_k of the non-trivial zeros of the Riemann zeta function, taken as given real numbers with multiplicity, for instance with atoms $1/(\gamma_k^2 + \frac{1}{4})$. Its atoms are not of the form k^{-p} times a slowly varying factor with regular spacing: the fluctuations of the gaps $\gamma_{k+1} - \gamma_k$ act like a rough perturbation of the nodes, which is the kind of perturbation that the discussion above suggests can destroy pointwise laws. Moreover, the pointwise law for this measure would imply the averaged one, and we expect, from work in preparation, that the averaged law there carries information on the multiplicities of the ordinates that we do not know how to prove. We therefore regard this case as a barrier for the present methods rather than as a target.

Appendix A. Two L^2 bounds on a star of arcs

The uniform resolvent bound of Appendix B reduces, at the two edges, to two operators on a star of arcs through a point: a Cauchy operator conjugated by a power weight, and a Cauchy operator with a logarithmic commutator. Both are dilation invariant, which is what makes the bounds uniform in n. We prove them here.

Setting. A *star* is a set $\Gamma = \bigcup_{j=1}^{m} \gamma_j([0, R_j])$ of finitely many C^2 arcs γ_j, parametrised by arc length, with $\gamma_j(0) = 0$, pairwise disjoint except at 0, and with distinct tangent directions $\gamma_j'(0) = e^{i\theta_j}$. Each arc carries an orientation, and $\mathcal{C}_\pm$ are the boundary values of $\mathcal{C}$ on Γ as in T3. By compactness and transversality there are $K, c_1 > 0$ with

$$|\gamma_j'(\rho) - e^{i\theta_j}| \le K\rho, \qquad |\gamma_j(\rho) - \gamma_i(r)| \ge c_1(\rho + r)\ (i \ne j), \qquad |\gamma_j(\rho) - \gamma_j(r)| \ge c_1|\rho - r|. \tag{101}$$

A finite union of C^2 arcs is a Carleson curve, so $\mathcal{C}_\pm$ are bounded on $L^2(\Gamma)$ by T3(a). For $\lambda > 0$ the dilation $(U_\lambda \mathfrak{h})(z) := \lambda^{-1/2}\mathfrak{h}(z/\lambda)$ is unitary from $L^2(\Gamma)$ onto $L^2(\lambda\Gamma)$, and since $\mathrm{d}s/(s - z)$ is invariant under $(s, z) \mapsto (\lambda s, \lambda z)$, U_λ intertwines the Cauchy operators of Γ and $\lambda\Gamma$. The same holds for the operators below, whose kernels are $\mathrm{d}s/(s - z)$ times a function of $(s/|s|,\ z/|z|,\ |z|/|s|)$.

We use one elementary bound repeatedly. Let $\mathfrak{k}$ be measurable on $(0,\infty)$ with

$$\|\mathfrak{k}\|_* := \int_0^\infty |\mathfrak{k}(u)| u^{-1/2}\,\mathrm{d}u < \infty, \qquad (K\mathfrak{h})(r) := \int_0^\infty \mathfrak{k}(\rho/r)\mathfrak{h}(\rho)\frac{\mathrm{d}\rho}{r}.$$

Then

$$\|K\mathfrak{h}\|_{L^2(0,\infty)} \le \|\mathfrak{k}\|_*\,\|\mathfrak{h}\|_{L^2(0,\infty)}. \tag{102}$$

Indeed $(K\mathfrak{h})(r) = \int_0^\infty \mathfrak{k}(u)\mathfrak{h}(ru)\,\mathrm{d}u$, and $\|\mathfrak{h}(\cdot\,u)\|_{L^2} = u^{-1/2}\|\mathfrak{h}\|_{L^2}$, so (102) is Minkowski's integral inequality. (Equivalently, the Mellin symbol of K is bounded by $\|\mathfrak{k}\|_*$ on the line $\Re s = \frac12$, cf. T4, (1.14.38)–(1.14.40).) Operators with kernels that are bounded on a bounded set are Hilbert–Schmidt, and we use that without comment.

Lemma A.1 (power-weighted Cauchy operator on a star)**.** *Let Γ be a star and $|\beta| < \frac12$. Then the operators*

$$\mathfrak{h} \;\longmapsto\; |z|^\beta\,\mathcal{C}_\pm\big(|s|^{-\beta}\mathfrak{h}\big)(z)$$

are bounded on $L^2(\Gamma)$, with a norm N_β that depends only on β and Γ. The same bound holds on $\lambda\Gamma$ for every $\lambda > 0$, on every subset $\Gamma' \subset \lambda\Gamma$ (functions supported on, and evaluated on, Γ'), and for the weights z^β, $s^{-\beta}$ (any fixed continuous branches of the argument on each arc) in place of $|z|^\beta$, $|s|^{-\beta}$, with N_β multiplied by $e^{4\pi|\beta|}$.

Proof. The plan is to split off the plain Cauchy operator, which is bounded, and to compare the remainder, which has a kernel regular on the diagonal, with its analogue on the star of tangent rays.

Write $T_\pm\mathfrak{h} := |z|^\beta\mathcal{C}_\pm(|s|^{-\beta}\mathfrak{h}) = \mathcal{C}_\pm\mathfrak{h} + R\mathfrak{h}$, where

$$(R\mathfrak{h})(z) = \frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_\Gamma \Big(\frac{|z|^\beta}{|s|^\beta} - 1\Big)\frac{\mathfrak{h}(s)\,\mathrm{d}s}{s-z}.$$

The kernel of R is bounded near the diagonal of each arc (see below), so $R\mathfrak{h}$ has no boundary-value ambiguity, and it suffices to bound R. In arc-length coordinates, $z = \gamma_i(r)$, $s = \gamma_j(\rho)$, the kernel of R is

$$\mathfrak{r}_{ij}(\rho,r) = \frac{1}{2\pi i}\Big(\frac{|\gamma_i(r)|^\beta}{|\gamma_j(\rho)|^\beta} - 1\Big)\frac{\gamma_j'(\rho)}{\gamma_j(\rho)-\gamma_i(r)}.$$

Its flat analogue, on the star of rays $\{\rho e^{i\theta_j}\}$, is $\mathfrak{k}_{ij}(\rho/r)/r$ with

$$\mathfrak{k}_{ij}(u) := \frac{1}{2\pi i}\,\frac{(u^{-\beta}-1)\,e^{i\theta_j}}{ue^{i\theta_j} - e^{i\theta_i}}.$$

For $i \ne j$ we have $|ue^{i\theta_j} - e^{i\theta_i}| \ge \sin(|\theta_i-\theta_j|/2)(1+u)$, and for $i = j$ the quotient $(u^{-\beta}-1)/(u-1)$ is continuous at $u = 1$. So $|\mathfrak{k}_{ij}(u)| \le C(1+u^{-\beta})$ for $u \le 2$ and $|\mathfrak{k}_{ij}(u)| \le C(u^{-\beta}+1)u^{-1}$ for $u \ge 2$, and $\|\mathfrak{k}_{ij}\|_* < \infty$ precisely because $-\frac12 < \beta < \frac12$: near 0 the integrand is $O(u^{-1/2-\max(\beta,0)})$, near infinity $O(u^{-3/2-\min(\beta,0)})$. By (102) the flat operator is bounded on L^2 of the rays, hence on L^2 of the segments $[0,R_j]$.

The difference $\mathfrak{r}_{ij}(\rho,r) - \mathfrak{k}_{ij}(\rho/r)/r$ is a sum of two terms. Put $w_j(\rho) := (|\gamma_j(\rho)|/\rho)^\beta$; by (101) and $\gamma_j \in C^2$, w_j is C^1 on $[0,R_j]$ and bounded above and below. The first term is

$$\frac{1}{2\pi i}\Big(\frac{r}{\rho}\Big)^\beta\Big(\frac{w_i(r)}{w_j(\rho)} - 1\Big)\frac{\gamma_j'(\rho)}{\gamma_j(\rho)-\gamma_i(r)};$$

since $|w_i(r)-w_j(\rho)| \le C|\rho-r|$ for $i=j$ and $\le C(\rho+r)$ for $i\neq j$, (101) bounds it by $C(r/\rho)^\beta$. The second term is $\frac{1}{2\pi i}((r/\rho)^\beta-1)\,\mathfrak{e}_{ij}(\rho,r)$ with

$$\mathfrak{e}_{ij}(\rho,r) := \frac{\gamma_j'(\rho)}{\gamma_j(\rho)-\gamma_i(r)} - \frac{e^{i\theta_j}}{\rho e^{i\theta_j}-re^{i\theta_i}}.$$

We claim $|\mathfrak{e}_{ij}| \le C$. For $i\neq j$ both denominators are at least $c(\rho+r)$, and the numerator of the difference, $\gamma_j'(\rho)(\rho e^{i\theta_j}-re^{i\theta_i}) - e^{i\theta_j}(\gamma_j(\rho)-\gamma_i(r))$, is $O(\rho(\rho+r))+O(\rho^2+r^2)$ by (101). For $i=j$ the flat term is $1/(\rho-r)$, and $\gamma_j(\rho)-\gamma_j(r) = (\rho-r)(\gamma_j'(\rho)+O(\rho-r))$, so $\gamma_j'(\rho)/(\gamma_j(\rho)-\gamma_j(r)) = (\rho-r)^{-1}(1+O(\rho-r))$, which gives $\mathfrak{e}_{jj}=O(1)$. Here the factor $\gamma_j'(\rho)$, i.e. the arc-length element $\mathrm{d}s=\gamma_j'(\rho)\,\mathrm{d}\rho$, must be kept: without it the difference is only $O(r/|\rho-r|)$ on a single arc. Hence the difference kernel is at most $C(1+(r/\rho)^\beta)$, and $\iint_{[0,R]^2}(1+(r/\rho)^{2\beta})\,\mathrm{d}\rho\,\mathrm{d}r<\infty$ for $|\beta|<\frac12$: it is Hilbert–Schmidt.

So R is bounded on $L^2(\Gamma)$ (arc length makes the parametrisation unitary), and so is $T_\pm$. Dilation invariance gives the bound on $\lambda\Gamma$. Restriction to Γ' is a compression. Finally $z^\beta = |z|^\beta e^{i\beta\arg z}$ with $|\arg z|\le 2\pi$, so the complex weights differ from the absolute ones by multiplication operators of norm at most $e^{2\pi|\beta|}$ on either side. □

Lemma A.2 (logarithmic commutator on a star)**.** *Let Γ be a star and fix on each arc a continuous branch $\mathrm{l}(z)=\log|z|+i\arg z$ of the logarithm. Then the operator*

$$(L\mathfrak{h})(z) := \frac{1}{2\pi i}\int_\Gamma \big(\mathrm{l}(z)-\mathrm{l}(s)\big)\frac{\mathfrak{h}(s)\,\mathrm{d}s}{s-z}$$

is bounded on $L^2(\Gamma)$, with the same norm on $\lambda\Gamma$ for every $\lambda>0$ and on subsets.

Proof. The kernel is regular on the diagonal, since l is Lipschitz in arc length away from 0 and the factor $\mathrm{l}(z)-\mathrm{l}(s)$ vanishes at $s=z$; we split it into the part with $\log|z|-\log|s|$ and the part with $\arg z-\arg s$.

The modulus part. On the star of rays its kernel is $\mathfrak{k}_{ij}(\rho/r)/r$ with

$$\mathfrak{k}_{ij}(u) = -\frac{1}{2\pi i}\,\frac{\log u\; e^{i\theta_j}}{ue^{i\theta_j}-e^{i\theta_i}}.$$

This has no singularity at $u=1$ even for $i=j$ ($\log u/(u-1)\to 1$), and $|\mathfrak{k}_{ij}(u)|u^{-1/2}$ is $O(|\log u|u^{-1/2})$ at 0 and $O(|\log u|u^{-3/2})$ at infinity, so $\|\mathfrak{k}_{ij}\|_*<\infty$ and (102) applies. On the curved star the difference from the flat kernel is

$$\frac{1}{2\pi i}\Big[(\lambda_i(r)-\lambda_j(\rho))\frac{\gamma_j'(\rho)}{\gamma_j(\rho)-\gamma_i(r)} + \log\frac{r}{\rho}\;\mathfrak{e}_{ij}(\rho,r)\Big],$$

with $\lambda_j(\rho):=\log(|\gamma_j(\rho)|/\rho)$, a C^1 function on $[0,R_j]$. As in the proof of Lemma A.1 this is $O(1+|\log(r/\rho)|)$, and $\iint_{[0,R]^2}(1+\log^2(r/\rho))\,\mathrm{d}\rho\,\mathrm{d}r<\infty$.

The argument part. Its kernel is $\frac{i}{2\pi i}(\arg\gamma_i(r)-\arg\gamma_j(\rho))\gamma_j'(\rho)/(\gamma_j(\rho)-\gamma_i(r))$. For $i=j$, $\arg\gamma_j(\rho)=\theta_j+O(\rho)$ is C^1 on $[0,R_j]$, so by (101) the kernel is bounded. For $i\neq j$ the numerator is bounded and the denominator is at least $c_1(\rho+r)$, so the kernel is at most $C/(\rho+r) = C\,\mathfrak{k}(\rho/r)/r$ with $\mathfrak{k}(u)=(1+u)^{-1}$, $\|\mathfrak{k}\|_*=\pi$.

Both parts are bounded on $L^2(\Gamma)$. The kernel depends on (s,z) only through $s/|s|$, $z/|z|$ and $|z|/|s|$, so the operator commutes with U_λ and the bound holds on $\lambda\Gamma$. □

Remark A.3. For Γ a union of rays the curvature terms vanish, and Lemma A.1 reduces to the boundedness of the Mellin multiplier $\int_0^\infty u^{s-1}\,\mathrm{d}u/(u-e^{i\phi_{ij}})$ on $\Re s=\frac12-\beta$; on a single ray its principal value is $-\pi\cot(\pi s)$ (from T4, (5.12.3) and (5.5.3)), which is bounded on that line exactly when $0<\frac12-\beta<1$. This explains the role of the condition $|\beta|<\frac12$.

Appendix B. Proof of Proposition 7.4

We use the notation of Section 7. In particular $\hat\Sigma = \Sigma \cup \Sigma_\circ$, $\tilde Q$ is the explicit solution (86) of the comparison problem with jump $\tilde v$, and $n \ge n_0$. Write $\mathfrak{d}(z) := \operatorname{dist}(z, \hat\Sigma)$. We first collect three facts about Cauchy integrals (§B.1), then prove a uniform bound for the singular integral operator near an edge where $\tilde Q$ has a two-scale structure (§B.2), and finally assemble the proof (§B.3).

B.1. Three facts about Cauchy integrals.

In this subsection Γ is a bounded, finite union of oriented C^2 arcs with $|\Gamma \cap U(z,\rho)| \le A\rho$ for all $z \in \mathbb{C}$, $\rho > 0$, and $\mathcal{V}$ is the finite set of endpoints and intersection points of the arcs. We say that a function F analytic in $\mathbb{C} \setminus \Gamma$ is *continuous up to* Γ if near every point of $\Gamma \setminus \mathcal{V}$ its restriction to each side of Γ extends continuously to the arc; $F_\pm$ then denote these extensions. We use only Cauchy's integral formula, Green's formula and the facts of T3(a).

Lemma B.1. (a) *For $\mathfrak{h} \in L^2(\Gamma)$ and $z \notin \Gamma$, $|\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{h}(z)| \le \pi^{-1} A^{1/2} \|\mathfrak{h}\|_{L^2} \operatorname{dist}(z,\Gamma)^{-1/2}$.*

(b) *Let $\mathfrak{k}$ be C^1 (in arc length) on each arc and vanish near $\mathcal{V}$. Then $\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k}$ is analytic near each point of $\mathcal{V}$ and continuous up to Γ, and $(\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k})_+ - (\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k})_- = \mathfrak{k}$ on $\Gamma \setminus \mathcal{V}$. In particular $(\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k})_\pm = \mathcal{C}_\pm \mathfrak{k}$.*

(c) *Let F be analytic in $\mathbb{C} \setminus \Gamma$ and continuous up to Γ, with $F_\pm \in L^2(\Gamma)$, $F(z) = O(1/z)$ as $z \to \infty$, and $\rho \sup\{|F(z)| : |z - z_0| = \rho,\ z \notin \Gamma\} \to 0$ as $\rho \to 0$ for every $z_0 \in \mathcal{V}$. Then $F = \mathcal{C}(F_+ - F_-)$ in $\mathbb{C} \setminus \Gamma$; hence $F_\pm = \mathcal{C}_\pm(F_+ - F_-)$, i.e. $F_\pm \in \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\Gamma))$.*

Proof. (a) By Cauchy–Schwarz it suffices to show $\int_\Gamma |s-z|^{-2}|\,ds| \le 4A/\mathfrak{d}$ with $\mathfrak{d} = \operatorname{dist}(z,\Gamma)$. Split Γ into the shells $2^k\mathfrak{d} \le |s-z| < 2^{k+1}\mathfrak{d}$, $k \ge 0$; the k-th contributes at most $A 2^{k+1}\mathfrak{d}\,(2^k\mathfrak{d})^{-2}$, and the sum is $4A/\mathfrak{d}$.

(b) Analyticity near $\mathcal{V}$ is clear, since $\mathfrak{k}$ vanishes there. By a partition of unity we may assume that $\mathfrak{k}$ is supported in a compact sub-arc of the interior of one arc γ. Choose an open disc D which meets Γ only in an open sub-arc of γ containing that support and which γ cuts into two parts, D_+ on the left and D_- on the right. Using normal coordinates along γ (which are C^1 because γ is C^2), extend $\mathfrak{k}$ to a C^1 function K on $\mathbb{C}$ with compact support in D and $K|_\gamma = \mathfrak{k}$. Green's formula on D_+ (the Cauchy–Pompeiu formula) gives, since the positively oriented boundary of D_+ runs along γ in its own direction and $K = 0$ on ∂D,

$$\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k}(z) = K(z)\mathbf{1}_{D_+}(z) + \Omega(z), \qquad \Omega(z) := \frac{1}{\pi}\iint_{D_+} \frac{\bar\partial K(w)}{w - z}\,dA(w), \qquad z \notin \Gamma.$$

Since $\bar\partial K$ is bounded with compact support and $|w-z|^{-1}$ is locally integrable uniformly in z, Ω is continuous on $\mathbb{C}$. So $\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k}$ is continuous up to γ from both sides, with $(\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k})_+ - (\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k})_- = K = \mathfrak{k}$. As continuous extensions, these are the non-tangential limits $\mathcal{C}_\pm\mathfrak{k}$ of T3.

(c) Fix $z \notin \Gamma$. For small ρ and large R apply Cauchy's integral formula to F on the open set $U(0,R) \setminus \big(\Gamma \cup \bigcup_{z_0 \in \mathcal{V}} \overline{U(z_0,\rho)}\big)$, whose boundary consists of the two sides of the arcs of Γ outside the small discs, the circles $|s - z_0| = \rho$ and the circle $|s| = R$; F is continuous on the closure (taken separately on the two sides of each arc). The two sides of an arc contribute $\frac{1}{2\pi i}\int (F_+ - F_-)(s)\,ds/(s-z)$, the left side being traversed in the direction of the arc. As $\rho \to 0$ the small circles contribute at most $\sum_{z_0} 2\rho \sup_{|s-z_0|=\rho} |F(s)|/|z - z_0| \to 0$ (for $\rho \le |z-z_0|/2$), and the arc integrals converge to $\mathcal{C}(F_+ - F_-)(z)$ because $F_+ - F_- \in L^2(\Gamma) \subset L^1(\Gamma)$. As $R \to \infty$ the large circle contributes $O(1/R)$. Hence $F(z) = \mathcal{C}(F_+ - F_-)(z)$. Taking boundary values from either side, $F_\pm = \mathcal{C}_\pm(F_+ - F_-)$ wherever the non-tangential limits $\mathcal{C}_\pm$ exist, i.e. almost everywhere. □

B.2. **The model block.** The following lemma covers both edges. At the hard edge it is applied with $\varpi_n = n^2$, at the soft edge with $\varpi_n = n^{2/3}$.

Lemma B.2 (uniform bound near an edge)**.** *Let $z_0 \in \mathbb{C}$, $0 < r_1 < r_0$, $\varpi_n \geq 1$, and let f_0 be conformal on a neighbourhood of $\overline{U(z_0, r_0)}$, independent of n, with $f_0(z_0) = 0$. Assume that $\hat{\Sigma} \cap U(z_0, r_0)$ consists of finitely many C^2 arcs from z_0 with distinct tangents and is independent of n, and put $\Sigma_1 := \hat{\Sigma} \cap U(z_0, r_1)$, $\Gamma_1 := f_0(\Sigma_1)$ (a star with vertex 0, in the sense of Appendix A). Assume that for $z \in U(z_0, r_0) \setminus \hat{\Sigma}$, with $\zeta := \varpi_n f_0(z)$,*

$$\tilde{Q}(z) = A(z)\, \varpi_n^{\sigma_3/4} M_n(z),$$

where, with a constant C_1 independent of n, and with the same statements for the boundary values on $\hat{\Sigma}$:

- (B1) *$A^{\pm 1}$ are analytic on $U(z_0, r_0)$ and $|A^{\pm 1}| \leq C_1$;*
- (B2) *if $|\zeta| \geq 2$, then $M_n(z) = \zeta^{-\sigma_3/4} \Theta_\infty(z)$ with $|\Theta_\infty^{\pm 1}(z)| \leq C_1$;*
- (B3) *if $|\zeta| \leq 3$, then $M_n(z) = \hat{A}(\zeta) \mathcal{P}(\zeta) \Theta_0(z)$, where $\hat{A}$ does not depend on n, $\hat{A}^{\pm 1}$ are analytic on $|\zeta| < 4$ with $|\hat{A}^{\pm 1}| \leq C_1$, $|\Theta_0^{\pm 1}(z)| \leq C_1$, and either $\mathcal{P}(\zeta) = \zeta^{\beta \sigma_3}$ with $|\beta| < \frac{1}{2}$, or $\mathcal{P}(\zeta) = I + \hat{\kappa} (\log \zeta) e_1 e_2^{\mathsf{T}}$ with a constant $\hat{\kappa}$.*

Then the operators $\mathfrak{g} \mapsto 1_{\Sigma_1} \mathcal{C}_\pm (\mathfrak{g} 1_{\Sigma_1} \tilde{Q}_+^{-1}) \tilde{Q}_\pm$ are bounded on $L^2(\Sigma_1)$ uniformly in n, and $\int_{\Sigma_1} (|\tilde{Q}_\pm|^2 + |\tilde{Q}_\pm^{-1}|^2) |\,\mathrm{d}s| \leq C$.

Proof. We remove the analytic prefactor A at the cost of a Hilbert–Schmidt error, pass to the variable ζ, and split the resulting operator according to $|\zeta| \leq 3$ and $|\zeta| \geq 2$. Throughout, C depends on C_1, f_0, r_0, r_1, β and the geometry, but not on n.

Weights. Put $\Xi(z) := |f_0(z)|^{-1/4}$ if $|\zeta| \geq 2$ and $\Xi(z) := \varpi_n^{1/4} \omega(\zeta)$ if $|\zeta| < 2$, where $\omega(\zeta) = |\zeta|^{-|\beta|}$, respectively $\omega(\zeta) = 1 + |\log|\zeta||$ in the logarithmic case. Since $\varpi_n^{\sigma_3/4} \zeta^{-\sigma_3/4} = f_0^{-\sigma_3/4}$, (B2)–(B3) give

$$|\varpi_n^{\sigma_3/4} M_n(z)| + |M_n(z)^{-1} \varpi_n^{-\sigma_3/4}| \leq C\, \Xi(z), \qquad |M_n(z)^{\pm 1}| \leq C \omega(\zeta) \ (|\zeta| \leq 3). \tag{103}$$

On Σ_1 we have $|\,\mathrm{d}z| \leq C |\,\mathrm{d}\zeta|/\varpi_n$, $|f_0(z)| \geq |z - z_0|/C$, and Γ_1 satisfies an Ahlfors bound $|\Gamma_1 \cap U(\zeta, t)| \leq Ct$, as does $\varpi_n \Gamma_1$ with the same constant. Hence

$$\int_{\Sigma_1} \Xi^2 |\,\mathrm{d}z| \leq C \int_{\Sigma_1} |z - z_0|^{-1/2} |\,\mathrm{d}z| + C \varpi_n^{1/2} \varpi_n^{-1} \int_{\varpi_n \Gamma_1 \cap \{|\zeta| \leq 2\}} \omega(\zeta)^2 |\,\mathrm{d}\zeta| \leq C, \tag{104}$$

since $2|\beta| < 1$. With (103) and (B1) this gives the bound on $\int_{\Sigma_1} |\tilde{Q}_\pm^{\pm 1}|^2$.

Step 1: the prefactor. For $s, z \in U(z_0, r_1)$ write $A(s)^{-1} A(z) = I + (s - z) \mathfrak{k}_A(s, z)$; by Cauchy's estimates on the convex set $U(z_0, r_1)$, $|\mathfrak{k}_A| \leq C$. Then

$$\mathcal{C}(\mathfrak{g} \tilde{Q}_+^{-1})(z) \tilde{Q}(z) = \mathcal{C}(\mathfrak{g} M_{n,+}^{-1})(z) M_n(z) + \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{\Sigma_1} \mathfrak{g}(s) \big[M_{n,+}(s)^{-1} \varpi_n^{-\sigma_3/4}\big] \mathfrak{k}_A(s, z) \big[\varpi_n^{\sigma_3/4} M_n(z)\big]\, \mathrm{d}s.$$

By (103) the kernel of the second term is at most $C\, \Xi(s) \Xi(z)$, so by (104) it is Hilbert–Schmidt with norm at most C.

Step 2: the variable ζ. Let $\mathfrak{k}_0(s, z) := f_0'(s)/(f_0(s) - f_0(z)) - 1/(s - z)$, which is analytic and bounded on $U(z_0, r_1)^2$. Then $\mathrm{d}s/(s - z) = \mathrm{d}\zeta_s/(\zeta_s - \zeta_z) - \mathfrak{k}_0(s, z)\, \mathrm{d}s$. The term with $\mathfrak{k}_0$ is a scalar kernel times $M_{n,+}(s)^{-1} M_n(z) = [M_{n,+}(s)^{-1} \varpi_n^{-\sigma_3/4}][\varpi_n^{\sigma_3/4} M_n(z)]$, hence Hilbert–Schmidt with norm at most C as in Step 1. The main term is $\mathcal{S}\mathfrak{h} := \mathcal{C}^{\varpi_n \Gamma_1}(\mathfrak{h} \Phi_+^{-1}) \Phi$ with $\Phi(\zeta) := M_n(z)$ and $\mathfrak{h}(\zeta) = \mathfrak{g}(z)$; as $|f_0'|^{\pm 1} \leq C$, the map $\mathfrak{g} \mapsto \mathfrak{h}$ changes L^2 norms by the

factor $\varpi_n^{1/2}$ up to constants, the same on input and output, so it suffices to bound $\mathcal{S}$ on $L^2(\varpi_n\Gamma_1)$ uniformly. The conformal map preserves the sides of the contour, so $\pm$ boundary values correspond.

Step 3: splitting in ζ. Let $S := \{|\zeta| \le 3\}$, $B := \{|\zeta| \ge 2\}$, $N := \{2 \le |\zeta| \le 3\}$. The pairs (ζ', ζ) (source, target) are partitioned into $S \times S$; $(B \times B) \setminus (N \times N)$; $\{|\zeta'| < 2, |\zeta| > 3\}$; and $\{|\zeta'| > 3, |\zeta| < 2\}$. Accordingly $\mathcal{S} = 1_S\mathcal{S}1_S + \big(1_B\mathcal{S}1_B - 1_N\mathcal{S}1_N\big) + 1_{\{|\zeta|>3\}}\mathcal{S}1_{\{|\zeta|<2\}} + 1_{\{|\zeta|<2\}}\mathcal{S}1_{\{|\zeta|>3\}}$, and we bound each part.

$S \times S$. Here $\Phi = \hat{A}\mathcal{P}\Theta_0$. Write $\hat{A}(\zeta')^{-1}\hat{A}(\zeta) = I + (\zeta' - \zeta)\hat{\mathfrak{k}}(\zeta', \zeta)$ with $|\hat{\mathfrak{k}}| \le C$ on $\{|\zeta|, |\zeta'| \le 3\}$. The resulting commutator kernel is $\Theta_{0,+}(\zeta')^{-1}\mathcal{P}_+(\zeta')^{-1}\hat{\mathfrak{k}}\,\mathcal{P}(\zeta)\Theta_0(\zeta)$, of size at most $C\omega(\zeta')\omega(\zeta)$, and $\int_{\varpi_n\Gamma_1\cap S}\omega^2|\,\mathrm{d}\zeta| \le C$: Hilbert–Schmidt with norm $\le C$. The remaining part is $\mathfrak{h} \mapsto \big[\mathcal{C}(\mathfrak{h}'\mathcal{P}_+^{-1})\mathcal{P}\big]\Theta_0$ with $\mathfrak{h}' := \mathfrak{h}\Theta_{0,+}^{-1}$. If $\mathcal{P} = \zeta^{\beta\sigma_3}$, its first column is $\zeta^{\beta}\mathcal{C}(\zeta'^{-\beta}\mathfrak{h}'e_1)$ and its second column is $\zeta^{-\beta}\mathcal{C}(\zeta'^{\beta}\mathfrak{h}'e_2)$; both are bounded on $L^2(\varpi_n\Gamma_1 \cap S)$ by Lemma A.1 with exponents $\pm\beta$, uniformly in n by dilation invariance. If $\mathcal{P}$ is logarithmic, $\mathcal{P}_+(\zeta')^{-1}\mathcal{P}(\zeta) = I + \hat{\kappa}(\log\zeta - \log_+\zeta')e_1e_2^{\mathsf{T}}$, and the second term is the logarithmic commutator of Lemma A.2 applied to $\mathfrak{h}'e_1$ (the branches $\log_\pm$ on the arc $(-\infty, 0)$ differ by the constant $2\pi i$, which adds a multiple of the Cauchy operator).

$(B \times B) \setminus (N \times N)$. On B, $\Phi = \zeta^{-\sigma_3/4}\Theta_\infty$, so $1_B\mathcal{S}1_B$ is Θ_∞ times the operator $\mathfrak{h}'' \mapsto \mathcal{C}(\mathfrak{h}''\zeta'^{\sigma_3/4})\zeta^{-\sigma_3/4}$, with $\mathfrak{h}'' = \mathfrak{h}\Theta_{\infty,+}^{-1}$; this is Lemma A.1 with $\beta = \mp\frac{1}{4}$. On N the matrices $\Phi^{\pm1}$ are bounded, so $1_N\mathcal{S}1_N$ is bounded by $\|\mathcal{C}_\pm\|$ on $\varpi_n\Gamma_1$ (Lemma A.1 with $\beta = 0$).

The separated parts. If $|\zeta'| < 2$ and $|\zeta| > 3$, then $|\zeta - \zeta'| \ge |\zeta|/3$, $|\Phi(\zeta')^{-1}| \le C\omega(\zeta')$ and $|\Phi(\zeta)| \le C|\zeta|^{1/4}$. The kernel is at most $C\omega(\zeta')|\zeta|^{-3/4}$, and $\int_{|\zeta'|<2}\omega^2\int_{|\zeta|>3}|\zeta|^{-3/2}|\,\mathrm{d}\zeta||\,\mathrm{d}\zeta'| \le C$ by the Ahlfors bound. The other part is symmetric. □

The two instances. At the hard edge, $z_0 = 0$, $r_0 = \delta$, $r_1 = \frac{3}{4}\delta$, $f_0 = f$, $\varpi_n = n^2$, $A = A_0(2\pi)^{\sigma_3/2}$ (Lemma 7.2(i)) and $M_n(z) = \Phi_\alpha(n^2 f(z))$; (B2) and (B3) are (80) and (81), with $\beta = \alpha/2$, or the logarithmic case if $\alpha = 0$. Here $|\beta| < \frac{1}{2}$ is exactly $|\alpha| < 1$. At the soft edge we use the structure of the Airy parametrix provided by (F5): in $U(4c, \varepsilon)$,

$$\hat{P}_r(z) = A_r(z)\, n^{\sigma_3/6} M_{r,n}(z), \qquad \zeta = n^{2/3} f_r(z), \tag{105}$$

with f_r conformal, independent of n, $f_r(4c) = 0$, $A_r^{\pm1}$ analytic and bounded uniformly in n, and $M_{r,n}$ satisfying (B2) and (B3) with $\mathcal{P} = I$; here $\hat{A}$ is the entire matrix of Airy functions of the model, and Θ_∞, Θ_0 contain the exponential factors $e^{\pm\frac{2}{3}\zeta^{3/2}\sigma_3}$, the sectorial constants and the bounded factor $(D_W/W_r)^{\sigma_3}$ of T1(c). So Lemma B.2 applies with $\varpi_n = n^{2/3}$, $r_0 = \varepsilon$, $r_1 = \frac{3}{4}\varepsilon$; no α is involved.

B.3. **Proof of Proposition 7.4.** *Step 0: the contour.* $\hat{\Sigma}$ is a finite union of C^2 arcs with $|\hat{\Sigma} \cap U(z, \rho)| \le A\rho$, A independent of n: this holds for Σ by (F1) and for the two fixed circles. We show $\|\mathcal{C}_\pm\|_{L^2(\hat{\Sigma})} \le C$. The operator splits into blocks according to source and target in Σ or $\Sigma_\circ$. The block $\Sigma \to \Sigma$ is bounded by (F1), and $\Sigma_\circ \to \Sigma_\circ$ is the Cauchy operator of two fixed circles. For the mixed blocks let $\Sigma_{\mathrm{loc}} := \Sigma \cap (U(0, 2\delta) \cup U(4c, 2\varepsilon))$, which is independent of n; on the fixed curve $\Sigma_{\mathrm{loc}} \cup \Sigma_\circ$ the Cauchy operator is bounded by T3(a). The rest of Σ has distance at least $\min(\delta, \varepsilon)$ from $\Sigma_\circ$, and there the kernel is Hilbert–Schmidt: $\int_{\Sigma_\circ}\int_{\Sigma\setminus\Sigma_{\mathrm{loc}}}|s - z|^{-2}|\,\mathrm{d}s||\,\mathrm{d}z| \le |\Sigma_\circ|\,4A/\min(\delta, \varepsilon)$ by the proof of Lemma B.1(a).

Step 1: part (i). Fix n. By (81), $|\tilde{Q}^{\pm1}(z)| \le C_n|z|^{-|\alpha|/2}$ near 0 (with $C_n(1 + |\log|z||)$ if $\alpha = 0$). By (105) and (B3) with $\mathcal{P} = I$, $\tilde{Q}^{\pm1}$ is bounded near $4c$. Elsewhere $\tilde{Q}^{\pm1}$ is bounded, and it is continuous up to $\hat{\Sigma}$ in the sense of §B.1, being built from explicit functions that are continuous up to the arcs from each side. Since $|\alpha| < 1$, the boundary values of $\tilde{Q}^{\pm1} - I$

lie in $L^2(\hat\Sigma)$; and $\rho\sup_{|z|=\rho}|\tilde Q^{\pm1}(z)-I| = O(\rho^{1-|\alpha|/2})\to 0$, while at the other vertices the corresponding quantity is $O(\rho)$. Finally $\tilde Q^{\pm1}-I=O(1/z)$ at infinity. Lemma B.1(c), applied for fixed n, gives $\tilde Q_\pm^{\pm1}\in I+\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\hat\Sigma))$. This is part (i).

Step 2: reduction. Let $\mathcal{D}$ be the space of functions on $\hat\Sigma$ that are C^1 on each arc and vanish near the vertices; it is dense in $L^2(\hat\Sigma)$, and $\mathfrak{f}(\tilde v-I)\in\mathcal{D}$ for $\mathfrak{f}\in\mathcal{D}$, because $\tilde v$ is smooth on the arcs away from the vertices. Suppose that

(R1) for every $\mathfrak{g}\in\mathcal{D}$ there is m with $m_\pm\in\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$, $m_+=m_-\tilde v+\mathfrak{g}$ and $\|m_\pm\|\le C_2\|\mathfrak{g}\|$, with C_2 independent of n and $\mathfrak{g}$;
(R2) if $m_\pm\in\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$ and $m_+=m_-\tilde v$, then $m=0$.

Then $1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v}$ is invertible on $L^2(\hat\Sigma)$ with $\|(1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})^{-1}\|\le 1+C_2\|\tilde v-I\|_\infty$. This is the easy half of T3(e). Indeed, for $\mathfrak{f}\in\mathcal{D}$ solve (R1) with $\mathfrak{g}:=\mathfrak{f}(\tilde v-I)$ and put $\mu:=m_-+\mathfrak{f}$. Then $\mu(\tilde v-I)=m_-\tilde v-m_-+\mathfrak{f}(\tilde v-I)=m_+-m_-$; as $m_\pm\in\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$, $m_-=\mathcal{C}_-(m_+-m_-)=\mathcal{C}_-(\mu(\tilde v-I))$, so $\mu-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v}\mu=\mathfrak{f}$ and $\|\mu\|\le(1+C_2\|\tilde v-I\|_\infty)\|\mathfrak{f}\|$. The map $\mathfrak{f}\mapsto\mu$ extends by continuity to a bounded operator $\mathcal{R}$ on $L^2(\hat\Sigma)$ with $(1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})\mathcal{R}=1$, since $1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v}$ is bounded. Conversely, if $\mu=\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v}\mu$, then $m:=\mathcal{C}(\mu(\tilde v-I))$ satisfies $m_\pm\in\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$, $m_-=\mu$ and $m_+=\mu\tilde v=m_-\tilde v$, so $m=0$ by (R2) and $\mu=0$. Hence $1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v}$ is injective with right inverse $\mathcal{R}$, and $(1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})^{-1}=\mathcal{R}$.

Step 3: uniqueness. Let $m_\pm\in\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$ with $m_+=m_-\tilde v$. Put $A:=\tilde Q+m$ and $B:=\tilde Q$. Then $A_+=A_-\tilde v$, $A_\pm\in I+\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$, $B_\pm^{-1}\in I+\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$ by Step 1, and $\tilde v^{\pm1}\in L^\infty$. By T3(b) with $v_A=v_B=\tilde v$, $AB^{-1}=I$, i.e. $m=0$. This is (R2).

Step 4: the explicit solution and the uniform bound. Let $\mathfrak{g}\in\mathcal{D}$. Then $\mathfrak{k}:=\mathfrak{g}\tilde Q_+^{-1}\in\mathcal{D}$, since $\tilde Q_+^{-1}$ is smooth on the arcs away from the vertices. Put $m:=\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k}\cdot\tilde Q$. By Lemma B.1(b), m is continuous up to $\hat\Sigma$ and $m_+-m_-\tilde v=\big((\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k})_+-(\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k})_-\big)\tilde Q_+=\mathfrak{g}$.

To bound $\|m_\pm\|_{L^2}$ uniformly, let $\Sigma_A:=\hat\Sigma\cap U(0,\frac34\delta)$, $\Sigma_B:=\hat\Sigma\cap U(4c,\frac34\varepsilon)$ and $\Sigma_R:=\hat\Sigma\setminus(U(0,\frac12\delta)\cup U(4c,\frac12\varepsilon))$. On Σ_R the matrices $\tilde Q^{\pm1}$ are bounded uniformly in n: outside the discs $\tilde Q=P_0^\infty$ by (75); in $\frac12\delta\le|z|\le\delta$ by Lemma 7.2(iii); in $\frac12\varepsilon\le|z-4c|\le\varepsilon$ by (B2) for the Airy instance, since $|\zeta|\ge2$ there. Partition the source–target pairs into $\Sigma_A\times\Sigma_A$, $\Sigma_B\times\Sigma_B$, $(\Sigma_R\times\Sigma_R)\setminus(\Sigma_A\times\Sigma_A\cup\Sigma_B\times\Sigma_B)$ and the rest. The first two blocks are bounded by Lemma B.2. The third is $1_{\Sigma_R}T1_{\Sigma_R}-1_{\Sigma_R\cap\Sigma_A}T1_{\Sigma_R\cap\Sigma_A}-1_{\Sigma_R\cap\Sigma_B}T1_{\Sigma_R\cap\Sigma_B}$ with $T\mathfrak{g}=\mathcal{C}_\pm(\mathfrak{g}\tilde Q_+^{-1})\tilde Q_\pm$, and each term is bounded by Step 0 since $\tilde Q^{\pm1}$ is bounded on Σ_R. In the remaining pairs one point lies in $U(0,\frac12\delta)$ (or $U(4c,\frac12\varepsilon)$) and the other outside $U(0,\frac34\delta)$ (resp. $U(4c,\frac34\varepsilon)$), so $|s-z|\ge\frac14\min(\delta,\varepsilon)$. The kernel is at most $C|\tilde Q_+^{-1}(s)||\tilde Q(z)||s-z|^{-1}$, and its Hilbert–Schmidt norm is bounded by the L^2 bounds of Lemma B.2 on the discs, the boundedness of $\tilde Q^{\pm1}$ on Σ_R, and $\int_{|s-z|\ge t}|s-z|^{-2}|\,\mathrm{d}s|\le 4A/t$. Hence $\|m_\pm\|\le C_2\|\mathfrak{g}\|$ with C_2 independent of n and of $\mathfrak{g}\in\mathcal{D}$.

Step 5: $m_\pm\in\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$. We apply Lemma B.1(c) to $F:=m$, for fixed n. Since $\mathfrak{k}$ vanishes near the vertices, $\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k}$ is analytic and bounded near each vertex, and $\mathcal{C}\mathfrak{k}=O(1/z)$ at infinity; hence $|m|\le C_n|\tilde Q|$ near each vertex, so that $\rho\sup_{|z-z_0|=\rho}|m|=O(\rho^{1-|\alpha|/2})\to0$ (by Step 1), $m=O(1/z)$ at infinity, and $m_\pm\in L^2(\hat\Sigma)$ by Step 4. Lemma B.1(c) gives $m_\pm\in\partial\mathcal{C}(L^2)$. This proves (R1).

Working with data in $\mathcal{D}$ avoids any analysis of m at the vertex 0, where $\tilde Q$ is unbounded: for such data the singular factor $\tilde Q$ only multiplies a function that is analytic near 0, and the uniform estimate of Step 4, which is where the structure at 0 enters, extends the inverse to all of L^2.

Steps 2–5 (with (R2) from Step 3) prove part (ii) of Proposition 7.4, with $\|(1-\mathcal{C}_{\tilde v})^{-1}\|\le 1+C_2\sup_n\|\tilde v-I\|_\infty$, which is finite because $\tilde v^{\pm1}$ is bounded uniformly in n (on the lips $|c_\pm e^{2n\varphi}|\le1$, on the circles $\tilde v=I+O(1/n)$, elsewhere $\tilde v\in\{I,J\}$ or $\tilde v=v$). □

Appendix C. The a priori bound at the hard edge

The comparison argument of §7 applies Theorem 4.4 of Conway and Deift (T3) to Q. Its hypothesis is $Q_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\Sigma))$: the boundary values of $Q - I$ must be Cauchy integrals of L^2 functions. We never solve a Riemann–Hilbert problem for Q; Q is built from the orthogonal polynomials, and we only have to check that it is not too singular at the vertices of Σ. The only delicate vertex is the hard edge 0, where infinitely many nodes accumulate. There we bound the Cauchy sums in Y directly (Lemma C.1), except in thin sectors around the band, where the poles are removed by R and a contour argument is needed (Lemma C.2). Throughout this appendix $n \ge n_0$ is *fixed*, and constants may depend on n.

Recall from Lemma 5.1 that

$$U_{j2}(z) = \sum_{k\ge 1} \frac{w(X_k)\,U_{j1}(X_k)}{z - X_k} \qquad (j = 1, 2), \qquad w(X_k) = n^p w_k, \tag{106}$$

and that U_{11}, U_{21} are polynomials. Put $\varphi_1 := \frac{1}{2}\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$.

Lemma C.1 (Sum bound)**.** *For every $\eta > 0$ there is C (depending on n and η) such that $|U_{j2}(z)| \le C|z|^{-\eta}(1 + |z|^\alpha)$ for $0 < |z| \le 1$, $\varphi_1 \le |\arg z| \le \pi$.*

Proof. For such z and $X > 0$, $|z - X| \ge \sin\varphi_1 \max(|z|, X)$. By Lemma 2.1 (or Lemma 5.6(i)), $w_k \le C_\eta k^{-s+\eta}$, and U_{j1} is bounded on $[0, n^p]$. Let $K := n|z|^{-1/p}$, so that $X_k \ge |z|$ if and only if $k \le K$. Then

$$|U_{j2}(z)| \le C \sum_{k\le K} \frac{k^{-s+\eta}}{(n/k)^p} + \frac{C}{|z|} \sum_{k>K} k^{-s+\eta} \le C\big(1 + K^{1+p-s+\eta} + \log K\big) + C|z|^{-1}K^{1-s+\eta}.$$

Since $K^{1+p-s} = n^{1+p-s}|z|^\alpha$ and $|z|^{-1}K^{1-s} = n^{1-s}|z|^\alpha$ (recall $(s-1)/p - 1 = \alpha$), and $K^\eta = n^\eta |z|^{-\eta/p}$, the claim follows after renaming η. □

Lemma C.2 (Lens sectors)**.** *For every $\eta > 0$ there are $b \in (0, \delta)$ and C such that $|R_{j2}(z)| \le C|z|^{-\eta}(1 + |z|^\alpha)$ for $0 < |z| \le b/2$, $0 < |\arg z| < \varphi_1$, and also for $z \in \Omega_{\mathrm{b}} \cap U(0, b/2)$.*

Proof. Take z with $0 < \arg z < \varphi_1$; the case $\arg z < 0$ is the mirror image. In Ω_{b}^+, $R_{j2} = U_{j2} - U_{j1} W e^{-2i\theta}\kappa_+$ by (49). Put

$$\mathcal{K}_j(s) := \frac{U_{j1}(s)W(s)}{e^{2i\theta(s)} - 1}, \qquad s \in G := \{s :\ r < |s| < b,\ |\arg s| < \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}\},$$

where b and r are chosen with $t(b), t(r) \in \mathbb{N} + \frac{1}{2}$, and $r < \frac{1}{2}|z|$, $|z| < \frac{1}{2}b$. Note $e^{-2i\theta}\kappa_+ = 1/(e^{2i\theta} - 1)$, so $R_{j2}(z) = U_{j2}(z) - \mathcal{K}_j(z)$. The function $\mathcal{K}_j$ is meromorphic on a neighbourhood of $\overline{G}$: W is analytic there (Lemma 5.5), and $e^{2i\theta} = 1$ only where $t \in \mathbb{Z}$, i.e. at the nodes (the points with $t \in -\mathbb{N}$ have $|\arg s| = \pi p > \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$). At a node, $e^{2i\theta(s)} - 1 = 2i\theta'(X_k)(s - X_k)(1 + O(s - X_k))$, so $\operatorname{Res}_{X_k} \mathcal{K}_j = U_{j1}(X_k)W(X_k)/(2i\theta'(X_k)) = w(X_k)U_{j1}(X_k)$. The residue theorem on ∂G (positively oriented) and (106) give

$$R_{j2}(z) = \sum_{X_k \notin G} \frac{w(X_k)U_{j1}(X_k)}{z - X_k} - \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{\partial G} \frac{\mathcal{K}_j(s)\,\mathrm{d}s}{s - z}. \tag{107}$$

We bound the terms. (1) The nodes with $X_k \ge b$ are finitely many and at distance $\ge b/2$ from z; those with $X_k \le r$ contribute at most $\frac{2}{|z|}\sum_{X_k \le r} w(X_k)|U_{j1}(X_k)|$, which tends to 0 as $r \to 0$. (2) On the ray $\arg s = \vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$, $|e^{2i\theta} - 1|^{-1} = |e^{-2i\theta}|/|1 - e^{-2i\theta}| \le 2\exp(-2\pi n|s|^{-1/p}\sin(\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}/p))$ by (41), which beats $|W(s)| \le C|s|^{\alpha-\eta}$ (Lemmas 5.2, 5.6(ii)); and $|s - z| \ge |s|\sin(\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} - \varphi_1)$. So

this part is bounded. (3) On the ray $\arg s = -\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$ we write $1/(e^{2i\theta}-1) = -1 - e^{2i\theta}/(1-e^{2i\theta})$, where now $|e^{2i\theta}| < 1$ is super-small, so $\mathcal{K}_j = -U_{j1}W + (\text{bounded})$. Since $|s-z| \ge c'(|s|+|z|)$,

$$\int_0^b \frac{|W(\rho e^{-i\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}})|\,\mathrm{d}\rho}{\rho+|z|} \le C\int_0^b \frac{\rho^{\alpha-\eta}\,\mathrm{d}\rho}{\rho+|z|} \le C|z|^{-\eta}(1+|z|^{\alpha}),$$

because $\alpha-\eta > -1$. (4) On the arcs $|s| = r$ and $|s| = b$, $|t| \in \mathbb{N}+\frac12$. For such $t = u+iv$ we have $|e^{2\pi i t}-1| \ge c' > 0$: if $|v| \ge \frac14$ this is clear, and if $|v| < \frac14$ then u is at distance at least $\frac38$ from $\mathbb{Z}$, so $|e^{2\pi i t}-1| = 2e^{-\pi v}|\sin \pi t| \ge 2e^{-\pi/4}\sin(3\pi/8)$. Hence $|\mathcal{K}_j| \le C|W| \le C|s|^{\alpha-\eta}$ there. The arc $|s| = r$ has length $\le 2\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} r$ and $|s-z| \ge \frac12|z|$, so its contribution is $\le Cr^{1+\alpha-\eta}/|z| \to 0$ as $r \to 0$; the arc $|s| = b$ contributes a bounded amount. Letting $r \to 0$ in (107) proves the bound for $0 < \arg z < \varphi_1$. For $z \in \Omega_{\mathrm{b}} \cap U(0, b/2)$ with $\varphi_1 \le |\arg z| < \frac54\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}}$, $R_{j2} = U_{j2} - U_{j1}We^{\mp 2i\theta}\kappa_{\pm}$ is bounded by Lemma C.1 plus a super-small term. □

Proposition C.3 (A priori bound)**.** *Fix $n \ge n_0$. Then $\det Q \equiv 1$, and:*

(i) *for every $\eta > 0$ there is $C_{n,\eta}$ with $|Q(z)| \le C_{n,\eta}|z|^{-|\alpha|/2-\eta}$ for $z \in U(0,\delta)\setminus\Sigma$;*
(ii) *Q is bounded on every bounded set at positive distance from 0, and $Q(z) \to I$ as $z \to \infty$;*
(iii) *Q has continuous boundary values on Σ minus its vertices.*

The same holds for Q^{-1}.

Proof. $\det U = \det Y = 1$ (Lemma 5.1), and every other factor in (51) and in $Q = D_\infty^{-\sigma_3} V D_W^{\sigma_3}$ has determinant 1; so $\det Q = 1$ and Q^{-1} has the same entries up to sign and order.

(i) Let $\eta > 0$ and $|z| < \min(\delta, b/2)$ (the annulus $b/2 \le |z| < \delta$ is covered by (ii)). Write $Q = E_\infty\, U\, M\, D_W^{\sigma_3}$ with the constant $E_\infty := D_\infty^{-\sigma_3} C_\infty e^{-n\gamma_p\sigma_3}$ and M from (51). We use: $|e^{\pm n\varphi}| \le e^{Cn|z|^{1/2}} \le C$ (Lemma 5.4(iii)); $|F|^{\pm1} \le C$ outside the lens and $|\tilde F|^{\pm1} \le C$ in the lens near 0 (O5); $|D_W(z)|^{\pm1} \le C|z|^{\pm\alpha/2-\eta}$ (Lemma 6.6(vi)); $|1/W(z)| \le C|z|^{-\alpha-\eta}$ in the lens (Lemmas 5.2, 5.6(ii)); and U_{j1} bounded.

Outside the lens ($z \in \Omega_\infty$), $|\arg z| \ge \frac34\vartheta_{\mathrm{lip}} > \varphi_1$ and $M = e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}F^{\sigma_3}$. The first column of Q is a constant times $U_{\cdot1}e^{n\varphi}FD_W$, of size $\le C|z|^{\alpha/2-\eta}$; the second is a constant times $U_{\cdot2}e^{-n\varphi}F^{-1}D_W^{-1}$, of size $\le C|z|^{-\eta}(1+|z|^{\alpha})|z|^{-\alpha/2-\eta}$ by Lemma C.1. Both are $\le C|z|^{-|\alpha|/2-2\eta}$.

In the lens $\Omega_{\mathrm{b}}^{\pm}$, $UM = R\,e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}A_\pm\tilde F^{\sigma_3}$, and $e^{n\varphi\sigma_3}A_\pm = \left(\begin{smallmatrix} e^{n\varphi} & 0 \\ \mp e^{n\varphi}/W & e^{-n\varphi}\end{smallmatrix}\right)$. The first column of R is that of U, and the second is bounded by Lemma C.2. Hence the first column of Q is at most $C(1+|z|^{-\alpha-\eta}|z|^{-\eta}(1+|z|^{\alpha}))|z|^{\alpha/2-\eta} \le C|z|^{-|\alpha|/2-3\eta}$, and the second is at most $C|z|^{-\eta}(1+|z|^{\alpha})|z|^{-\alpha/2-\eta} \le C|z|^{-|\alpha|/2-2\eta}$. Renaming η gives (i).

(ii) Away from 0 each of U (meromorphic, with finitely many nodes in any compact set not containing 0), the triangular and diagonal factors in (49)–(50), F, $\tilde F$ and D_W is analytic in each region up to its boundary, except for the poles of U and of $\kappa_\pm$ at the nodes, which cancel in R (Step 1 of §5.7). Near $4c$ the only singular factors are $\tilde F \sim (4c-z)^{-1/2}$ and $D_W \sim (4c-z)^{1/2}$, and they occur only in the product $\tilde F D_W$, whose square $(\tilde F D_W)^2 = C_n z^{\alpha} r_n \omega$ is bounded above and below on $U(4c,\varepsilon)$ (Lemma 6.6(vi)(b)). At the remaining vertices ($4c \pm ih_0$, $n^p+\delta' \pm ih_0$, $n^p+\delta'$) all factors are analytic and bounded. At ∞, $Q \to I$ by Lemma 6.7. (iii) follows from the same description and Lemma 5.7. □

Corollary C.4 (Q is an admissible solution)**.** *For each fixed $n \ge n_0$, $f := Q_+ - Q_- \in L^2(\Sigma)$, $Q_\pm = I + \mathcal{C}_\pm f$, and $Q = I + \mathcal{C}f$ off Σ. Thus $Q_\pm \in I + \partial\mathcal{C}(L^2(\Sigma))$ in the sense of T3, and the same holds for Q^{-1}.*

Proof. For fixed n, Σ is bounded, $|Q_\pm|$ is bounded away from 0, and $|Q_\pm(z)| \le C|z|^{-(1+|\alpha|)/4}$ near 0 by Proposition C.3 with $\eta = (1-|\alpha|)/4$. Since $(1+|\alpha|)/4 < \frac12$, $f \in L^2(\Sigma)$. Put $H := Q - I - \mathcal{C}f$ on $\mathbb{C}\setminus\Sigma$.

H has no jump. On each open arc of Σ, $Q_\pm$ are real-analytic (each region's formula for Q continues analytically across the arc, the poles at the nodes having been removed), so f is locally Hölder and $\mathcal{C}f$ has continuous boundary values with $\mathcal{C}_+ f - \mathcal{C}_- f = f$ (Sokhotski–Plemelj). Hence $H_+ = H_-$ on open arcs, and H is analytic across them by Morera's theorem. So H is analytic in $\mathbb{C}$ minus the finitely many vertices.

The vertices are removable. Let z_0 be a vertex. By Cauchy–Schwarz and $|\Sigma \cap U(z,\rho)| \le C\rho$, $|\mathcal{C}f(z)| \le \|f\|_2 (\int_\Sigma |s-z|^{-2}\,|\mathrm{d}s|)^{1/2} \le C\|f\|_2 \operatorname{dist}(z,\Sigma)^{-1/2}$. Near z_0, Σ consists of finitely many C^2 arcs, so $\iint_{\rho<|z-z_0|<2\rho} \operatorname{dist}(z,\Sigma)^{-1/2}\,\mathrm{d}A = O(\rho^{3/2})$, while $\iint_{\rho<|z-z_0|<2\rho} |Q-I|\,\mathrm{d}A = O(\rho^{2-(1+|\alpha|)/4})$. Hence $\iint_{\rho<|z-z_0|<2\rho} |H|\,\mathrm{d}A = o(\rho)$. Choosing $r \in (\rho, 2\rho)$ with $\oint_{|z-z_0|=r} |H|\,|\mathrm{d}z| \le \rho^{-1} \iint_{\rho<|z-z_0|<2\rho} |H|\,\mathrm{d}A$, the Laurent coefficients satisfy $|c_{-k}| \le \frac{1}{2\pi} r^{k-1} \oint_{|z-z_0|=r} |H|\,|\mathrm{d}z| = o(\rho^{k-1})$, so $c_{-k} = 0$ for $k \ge 1$.

Liouville. H is entire and tends to 0 at ∞ (both $Q-I$ and $\mathcal{C}f$ are $O(1/z)$, Σ being bounded), so $H \equiv 0$. The boundary values give $Q_\pm = I + \mathcal{C}_\pm f$. The argument for Q^{-1} is identical. □

This is the content of (F7). For η in (F7) any value in $(0, \frac{1-|\alpha|}{2})$ makes the boundary values of Q square integrable at 0; this is the place where $|\alpha| < 1$ enters the a priori bound.

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